# Waves in Thermoelastic and Multiphysics Continua: Generalized Heat Conduction, Coupled Fields and Size Effects

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**Abstract**

A solid that conducts heat, deforms and carries further fields, such as electric polarization, magnetic induction, diffusing species or microstructural degrees of freedom, is governed by one member of a family of coupled models; the literature presents them one member at a time. This review organises the family around a single heat-flux template with three lags and one memory term. It shows how the classical, Lord–Shulman, Green–Lindsay, Green–Naghdi, dual-phase-lag, three-phase-lag, Moore–Gibson–Thompson, fractional and memory-dependent theories arise, or fail to arise, as parameter choices, and records which limits are regular and which are singular; one widely repeated stability statement for the dual-phase-lag model is shown to depend on the order of the Taylor truncation. For linear homogeneous media a dispersion polynomial in $K = k^2$ is derived for the rational heat laws and verified symbolically; delays, fractional powers and memory kernels make the relation transcendental or multivalued, and the cases where this happens are identified. The polynomial is used to compare phase speed, attenuation and thermoelastic damping across the theories. Transient problems, Rayleigh and Lamb waves, reflection and interface energy partition, piezoelectric, magneto-thermoelastic, diffusive and microstructural couplings, and nonlocal and gradient size effects are treated in turn, followed by solution methods with a benchmark, applications, a comparative synthesis with a pitfalls checklist and a research agenda. Damping in flexure is validated against exact solutions. All quantitative figures are generated by accompanying scripts, and key identities are checked symbolically or numerically.

**Keywords:** generalized thermoelasticity; second sound; dual-phase-lag; thermoelastic waves; fractional heat conduction; multiphysics coupling.

## 1. Introduction

Fourier's law makes the heat flux proportional to the temperature gradient at the same instant. Under ordinary conditions this is an excellent description of conduction in solids. Combined

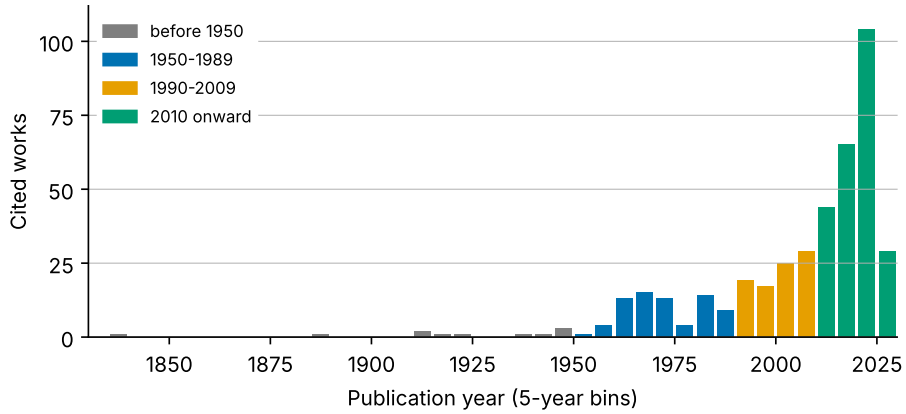



**Figure 1:** Publication years of the works cited in this review, in five-year bins and coloured by era. The few early bars are the foundational papers; 332 of the 416 cited works date from 1990 onward and 133 from 2020 onward, and the last bin covers only 2025–2026. The count is of cited works, not a bibliometric survey of the field.

with energy balance it yields a parabolic equation, and that equation carries a property which is physically uncomfortable: a temperature disturbance applied at one point changes the temperature everywhere else at the same instant, however small the change may be.

For slow processes in bulk matter the difference between this instantaneous response and what a real, finite-speed carrier of heat would do is immeasurably small. It becomes measurable, and sometimes dominant, when the heating or loading is very fast (femtosecond to nanosecond laser pulses), when the structure is very small or very cold so that phonon mean free paths approach the structure size, when the medium is strongly heterogeneous, or when the observed quantity is a high-frequency elastic wave whose period is comparable to a thermal relaxation time.

Thermoelasticity couples the thermal field to deformation. Heating produces thermal stress through thermal expansion; deformation changes the temperature through the dilatation term in the energy balance. The classical coupled theory of Biot [1] builds on the thermomechanical stress–strain law of Duhamel and Neumann [2] and on the early dynamic solutions of Danilovskaya [3] and Chadwick and Sneddon [4, 5], and it inherits the infinite thermal signal speed. The extensions that remove it are called *generalized* or *non-classical* thermoelasticity [6–10]; they now form one of the largest strands of continuum mechanics, with a very large body of theoretical work. Two further developments widened the field. Devices exploit the coupling of deformation and temperature to additional physical fields, above all electric polarization (piezoelectricity and pyroelectricity), but also magnetic induction, diffusing species, fluid-filled pores and microstructural kinematics [11–14]. At small scales, separately, the local stress–strain relation itself fails to describe dispersion, and nonlocal and gradient enrichments are used instead [15–18].

The literature that results is large and still growing. Figure 1 shows the publication years of the 416 works cited here; 332 of them appeared after 1990 and 133 after 2020, which is the period in which the number of named heat-conduction models for thermoelastic waves multiplied.

Good reviews of generalized thermoelasticity already exist [6–9, 19, 20]. What they do not supply is a treatment for a reader who wants to *use* the theories on wave problems and to compare them reliably. Three observations fixed the organisation of this review.

1. **Proliferation without a common language.** The number of named heat-conduction mod-

els for thermoelastic waves has grown very large over three decades, and many of them are combinations (two-temperature fractional Lord–Shulman, three-phase-lag with memory, nonlocal Moore–Gibson–Thompson, and so on). Each paper brings its own constants and notation. Section 3.2.4 introduces one heat-flux function $G(s)$ in the Laplace domain that carries every model of the three-lag-plus-memory class (Green–Lindsay and Guyer–Krumhansl do not pass through it, and are treated separately). A new combination within the class is then a new choice of $G$.

2. **Unreliable folklore about limits and stability.** Papers repeat several statements without re-deriving them: which parameter limits reduce one model to another, which parameter ranges are stable, how the wave branches should be labelled. These statements are re-derived here and checked numerically. One widely repeated claim, that dual-phase-lag thermoelasticity needs $\tau_T \geq \tau_q/2$ to be stable, depends on the order of the Taylor expansion that defines the model (Section 4.3).
3. **Figures that cannot be compared.** Published dispersion and response curves use different nondimensionalisations, parameter sets and branch conventions, so that the visual impression of "the effect of the fractional order" or "the effect of nonlocality" is hard to calibrate. Each figure here states its own scaling (frequency in units of $\omega_*$, or lengths in units of a thermal wavelength), and the material-independent groups that control it are listed in the nomenclature.

This review covers the following ground.

- One heat-flux template that carries the classical, Lord–Shulman, Green–Naghdi, dual-phase-lag, three-phase-lag, Moore–Gibson–Thompson, fractional and memory-dependent theories, with a record of which limits are regular and which are singular (Sections 3–5).
- A dispersion polynomial for the coupled problem, and the comparison of phase speed, attenuation and thermoelastic damping that follows from it, with transient, surface, guided and interface waves (Section 6).
- Coupling to piezoelectric, magnetic, diffusive and microstructural fields, and nonlocal and gradient size effects (Sections 5 and 7).
- Solution methods, benchmarks, applications, experimental evidence, and a synthesis with a pitfalls checklist, a decision guide and research gaps (Sections 8–11).

The aim of this review is that a reader who wants to apply these theories to a wave problem can choose a model, know where it fails, and report results in a form that other studies can be compared with.

# 2. Review Scope, Evidence Protocol and Classification

## 2.1 Contributions and organisation

No new experiments are reported. The contributions are:

- a unified heat-flux template, a table of *exact* reductions and singular limits, and a taxonomy that places the main models in relation to one another (Sections 3.2.4–5.1);
- a coupled dispersion polynomial valid for the whole template, verified symbolically, with comparative dispersion, damping and speed results (Sections 4.1–6.1);
- benchmark transient problems, the heat pulse and the thermal shock of a half-space, each with a Laplace-domain closed form and a numerical inversion (Section 6.4);
- thermoelastic Rayleigh waves, reflection and interface energy partition, each with limit

checks (Sections 6.7–6.10);
- size effects set against lattice dispersion, and the principal multiphysics couplings (Sections 5.3–7.1);
- a kinetic basis for the Cattaneo and Guyer–Krumhansl laws, with the dispersion of the latter (Section 3.4), and a quantitative test of how well Taylor-truncated lag laws represent the delay law they approximate (Section 4.4);
- flexural thermoelastic damping, including a plate (Lamb-wave) computation validated against the Rayleigh–Lamb equation and the Lifshitz–Roukes solution, resonant modes of a bar, anisotropy in cubic crystals, free-surface reflection and piezoelectric surface waves (Sections 6.2, 6.3, 6.6, 6.8, 6.9 and 7.2);
- a discussion of solution methods with finite-difference and inversion benchmarks, experimental evidence and parameter identification, worked examples, application regimes, reporting standards, a comparative synthesis with a pitfalls checklist and a decision guide, and a research agenda (Sections 8.1 to 8.3, 9.1 to 9.3, 10.1 and 11.1 and Appendix L).

Section 3.1 gives the historical and literature background, and Section 3.2 derives the thermomechanical foundations the remaining sections rely on. A reader whose question is simply which model to choose can start at Section 10.1.

## 2.2 Scope and conventions

This review treats *linear* wave propagation in homogeneous solids about a uniform reference state at temperature $T_0$ unless stated otherwise. Nonlinear thermoelasticity, large deformation, radiative transport and chemically reacting media lie outside the scope of this review. The following notation is used throughout.

The Nomenclature section after the declarations collects the principal symbols; indices follow the Einstein summation convention. The strain tensor always carries two indices ($\varepsilon_{ij}$) so that it cannot be confused with the scalar coupling $\varepsilon$. Plane waves are $\exp[\mathrm{i}(kx-\omega t)]$ with $\mathrm{Im}\,k \geq 0$ for spatial decay in the propagation direction; a "branch" of the dispersion relation is a root $k(\omega)$ followed by continuity in $\omega$.

## 2.3 Reproducibility

Every figure in this review that displays numerical results comes from Python scripts that accompany the manuscript. The identities used repeatedly (the coupled dispersion polynomial, the Debye form of weak-coupling damping, the Green–Naghdi type-II wave speeds, the reductions of Table 4) are checked either symbolically or against independent numerical roots in those scripts (Appendix D). Where a quantity depends on a choice of model variant, the form of a memory-dependent derivative for instance, the choice is stated next to the result.

Table 1 collects the contributions a reader can cite this review for. Each row names the place where the contribution is delivered, so that the claim can be checked rather than believed, and the evidence column names only what this paper actually contains.

**Table 1:** What this review contributes, where it is delivered, and what supports it.

| # | Contribution | Delivered in | Evidence in this paper |
|---|---|---|---|
| C1 | One heat-law template and its stepwise reductions, so that LS, GL, GN-II/III, DPL, TPL, MGT, MDD and fractional models are compared as members of one family rather than as competing names. | Section 3.2, Section 4.2, Section 4.3, Section 5.1 | (14) and the reduction table; reductions checked in reduction check |
| C2 | A positive-definite availability functional with its flux, the dissipation identity it satisfies, and the explicit statement that it is not the total-energy flux — together with the exact Eulerian total-energy identity and its first-order reduction. | Section 3.2, Section 6.10 | (16), (17), (18); net-flux balance at welded interfaces (Section 6.10) |
| C3 | A family-comparative synthesis with a decision guide: what each theory predicts, what it costs, and under which conditions two families may legitimately be compared. | Section 10.1 | comparison tables in Section 10.1; four worked examples (a lag law, nanobeam damping, interface partition, a heat pulse) in Section 8.3 |
| C4 | An original five-axis taxonomy that places any candidate model, hybrids included, on one set of coordinates, with an explicit dissimilarity that says when two studies are comparable at all. | Section 10.2 | axis definitions, the dissimilarity (81), and the assignments in Table 16 |
| C5 | A per-equation verification register: every registered equation carries a status from a finite vocabulary, so that derived, primary-source-checked, unverified and open are distinguishable. | Appendix J | Table 22; entries at PRIMARY-SOURCE-CHECKED carry the printed page and equation |
| C6 | Fourteen executable benchmarks with reference solutions and stated tolerances, each a code verification rather than a physical validation. | Appendix I, Appendix D | Appendix I (14 rows), the scripts of Appendix D, and the parameter register Appendix H |
| C7 | A stated evidence protocol and a set of reporting standards, so that a reader can discount each statement by the rule it fails and a future author can make a result comparable. | Section 2.4, Appendix L | the six rules, and the reporting checklist |

C5 needs one caution, because it is the row a reader is most likely to over-read. A register entry records the status of a check, not the importance or the validity of an equation for a given material. Mechanical correctness does not make a constitutive assumption true.

## 2.4 Evidence protocol and how to discount this review

A review is only as useful as the reader's ability to tell what it has checked from what it has merely repeated. The protocol is stated here, so that any statement can be discounted by the rule it fails.

This is a structured, critical integrative review and not a systematic review: no database search with a fixed protocol, screening flow or eligibility register was run, and the reference list is not a census of the field. Works were assembled from the author's own library, by following citations backwards and forwards from the primary papers of each theory, and by adding topics where a gap in coverage was identified; the classified catalogue of Appendix E was organised by title keywords and is not a full-text appraisal. Coverage is therefore selective, and the choice of works reflects the author's judgement.

1. **Derivation and attribution are separated.** A statement derived here is presented as a derivation and carries an equation identifier; a statement taken from a source is presented as attribution even where the source's formulation is reproduced exactly. The two are never merged into one unmarked sentence. The register in Appendix J records which is which.
2. **Every registered equation carries a status** from a fixed vocabulary, and a status records the check performed, not a rank of importance (Table 22).
3. **A secondary source is never promoted to a primary one.** Where the primary text was not available the text says so and the register records the weaker status. The absence of the primary text is not evidence for the claim.
4. **Bibliographic identifiers are verified before they are printed.** A DOI printed in the reference list has been checked against a bibliographic record for the same work — author, title, journal, volume, pages — to the level recorded in the repository file `refs_catalogue_check.csv` (R0–R3), and not inferred from a citation in another paper. Works that predate DOI assignment say so in the entry instead of carrying a plausible-looking identifier.
5. **Numbers that can be recomputed are given with what is needed to recompute them.** A benchmark value is presented with its specification, reference solution and tolerance (Appendix I); a value quoted from the literature is presented as quoted, with its conditions, and not as an independent confirmation.
6. **Errors are recorded without personal characterisation.** Where a material error is conclusively established it is recorded plainly; where the evidence establishes a difference but not an error, it is recorded as a difference. No allegation is made against a publication, and no model-specific discrepancy is presented as a mathematical contradiction without demonstration.

The protocol has limits, and they are part of it. Not every cited work was read page by page; coverage of the literature is deliberate rather than exhaustive; and the register documents checks performed for this version, not checks that exist somewhere in principle. For these reasons the register reports coverage instead of asserting completeness.

**Summary**

This review organises the generalized thermoelasticity literature around one heat-flux template with three lags and one memory term. For linear homogeneous media and rational (truncated-lag) heat laws a dispersion polynomial is derived and checked symbolically against the field equations; exact delays, fractional powers and memory kernels give transcendental or multivalued relations and are treated separately. Verified benchmarks are added. Scope: linear waves about a uniform reference state, isotropic and anisotropic solids,

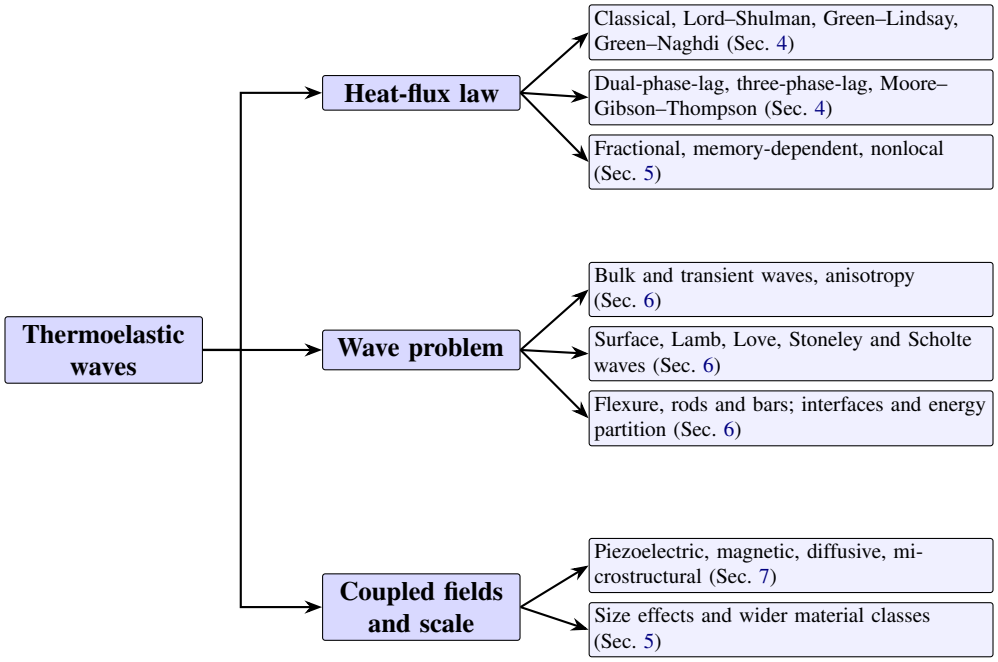



**Figure 2:** Classification of the field used to organise this review, with the sections in which each branch is treated.

plane-wave and guided-wave problems. Contributions: correction to the dual-phase-lag (DPL) stability condition, GN-III front-speed clarification, net-flux-vs-mode-flux check at interfaces, reporting standards. Not covered: nonlinear effects, radiative/reactive heat transfer, full bounded-domain well-posedness literature.

## 2.5 Classification of the field and structure of the review

The thermoelastic-wave literature can be sorted along three independent axes: which heat-flux law is used, which wave problem is solved, and which further field is coupled in. Figure 2 shows how the sections of this review follow those axes; the same classification underlies the catalogue of Appendix E and the taxonomy of Section 10.2. A reader who knows the heat law of a paper and the wave problem it treats can locate the corresponding section directly.

# 3. Background

## 3.1 Historical development of the theories reviewed

### 3.1.1 A short history

**Origins (1830s–1950s).** Duhamel's memoir of 1837 [2] established the stress–strain–temperature relation that still bears his name (with Neumann's later contribution): the stress depends on strain and on the temperature increment through an expansion coefficient. Dynamic coupling came much later. Biot [1] showed that the classical thermoelastic equations follow from the thermodynamics of irreversible processes with a Rayleigh-type dissipation function. Danilovskaya [3] solved the thermal shock of an elastic half-space in the uncoupled

approximation. Chadwick and Sneddon [4] analysed plane waves in the coupled theory, Chadwick's chapter [5] became the standard reference for the dynamical theory, and compact textbook accounts followed [21–23]. Three results from that period still organise the subject: the coupled longitudinal wave is attenuated and dispersed, shear waves decouple in isotropic media, and the thermal disturbance is a diffusive wave. Zener's earlier analysis of thermoelastic internal friction in vibrating reeds [24] had already found the same relaxation behaviour from a different direction.

**Finite-speed heat conduction (1940s–1970s).** The conceptual starting point is Cattaneo's 1948 note [25] and Vernotte's independent discussion [26], which add a relaxation term to Fourier's law and so make the heat equation hyperbolic (both are summarized in the review of Chandrasekharaiah [6], who also records the second-sound experiments mentioned below). Experimental support came from low-temperature solids, in the form of second sound in solid helium and in sodium fluoride [27, 28], and a kinetic theory of phonon hydrodynamics supplied the physical context in which heat actually propagates as a wave [29–31]. Lord and Shulman [32] then built a heat law of the Cattaneo (Maxwell–Cattaneo) form into a complete thermoelastic theory, and Green and Lindsay [33] proposed a different extension with temperature-rate terms in the constitutive relations; the literature later called the two coefficients of that extension relaxation times. The relation of both theories to thermodynamics drew extensive discussion, reviewed in [6, 34, 35].

**Energy-based theories (1990s).** Green and Naghdi [36–38] set out a family of three theories (types I, II, III) on an entropy balance rather than an entropy inequality for the heat flux, with the thermal displacement playing the role of a potential. Type II is nondissipative and carries undamped thermal waves; type III contains classical damping as well as thermal waves. Uniqueness and stability theory developed around them [39].

**Lagging models (1995–2010).** Tzou [40, 41] separated the heat flux and the temperature gradient by delay times, which gave the dual-phase-lag (DPL) model; Roy Choudhuri [42] added a third lag, the one associated with the thermal displacement. Both spread quickly, because Taylor expansion of the lag equation gives a differential equation of finite order whose parameters can be fitted to data. Stability and thermodynamic consistency of those truncations have since been studied model by model [43–46], each paper for its own truncation and with its own method.

**Nonlocal, fractional and memory-dependent extensions (1970s–present).** Eringen's nonlocal elasticity [15, 16, 47] and its thermoelastic extension [48] predate the generalized heat theories, and they converge with them in micro- and nanosystems; gradient elasticity [17, 18, 49, 50] is the other main enrichment. Fractional calculus entered heat conduction through the Caputo derivative [51], grew into fractional thermoelasticity [52–58], and was joined by the memory-dependent derivative of Wang and Li [59, 60]. Two-temperature theories [61, 62] and their hyperbolic variants [63–65] separate the conductive from the thermodynamic temperature.

**Mathematical thermoelasticity of third order (2010s).** The Moore–Gibson–Thompson (MGT) equation comes from the acoustics of a gas with relaxation [66]. It was studied systematically as an evolution problem [67–70] and then brought into thermoelasticity by Quintanilla [71, 72], which produced a model that fits the template of Section 3.2.4.

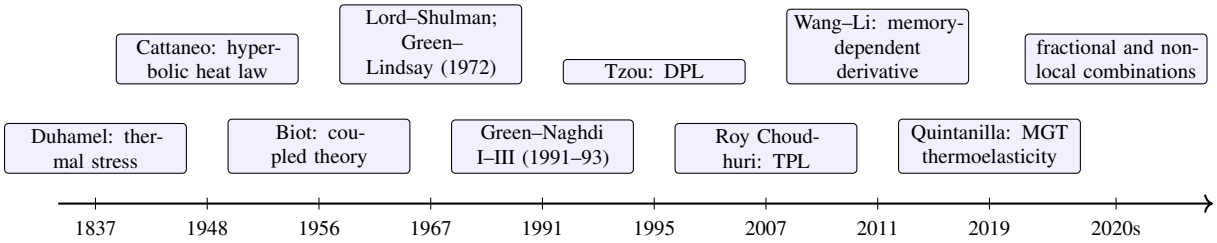



**Figure 3:** Milestones in the theory of thermoelastic waves. Dates are those of the cited original publications (Cattaneo 1948, Vernotte 1958, Biot 1956, Lord–Shulman 1967, Green–Lindsay 1972, Green–Naghdi 1991–1993, Tzou 1995, Roy Choudhuri 2007, Wang–Li 2011, Quintanilla 2019).

**Multiphysics and structure (1960s–present).** Micropolar and microcontinuum theories [13, 73, 74], materials with voids [75–77], thermopiezoelectricity [11, 12, 78], and thermoelastic diffusion and magneto-thermoelasticity extended the mechanical content, usually with the heat law kept as an independent module.

### 3.1.2 A map of the contemporary literature

Three largely independent axes sort the recent literature on wave problems in thermoelastic and multiphysics media: the *heat-flux law*, the *constitutive enrichment* (nonlocal, gradient, microstructural, multiphysics), and the *problem type* (plane waves, surface waves, reflection and transmission, transient response). A typical paper chooses one entry on each axis and computes dispersion curves or response histories. Table 2 lists representative works from the reference list of this review by problem type. The sorting is editorial, and many papers appear in more than one row.

### 3.1.3 Recurrent observations from the literature

Four patterns in these streams shape the rest of the review.

- **The heat law and the elastic enrichment are treated as independent modules.** Most interface and surface-wave papers combine one of several heat laws with one of several enrichments, so the dispersion relations differ only through $G(s)$ and through the elastic operator. That modularity is what makes a unified treatment possible, and it is also why a limit-checking discipline matters.
- **Energy ratios and amplitude ratios dominate the reflection literature.** The interface papers cited above report energy ratios, whose sum must equal one in a lossless setting. A sum different from one is therefore a diagnostic of dissipation, of an error in the flux definition, or of both; Section 6.10 discusses this check in detail.
- **Parameter values are rarely tied to measurements.** Lags and fractional orders are usually assigned convenient values, so many figures demonstrate a model rather than a material.
- **The thermodynamic status of the Taylor-expanded models is delicate.**

**Summary**

The historical line runs Fourier (parabolic) → Cattaneo/vernotte (flux relaxation) → Lord–Shulman → Green–Lindsay → Green–Naghdi types I–III → dual-phase-lag → three-phase-lag → Moore–Gibson–Thompson → fractional and memory-dependent

**Table 2:** Representative literature by problem type and constitutive enrichment (selection from the reference list; classification by the titles and stated subjects of the works).

| Problem type | Representative works |
|---|---|
| Plane waves, stability, dispersion | Prasad–Kumar [63]; Tiwari–Kumar (nonlocal TPL) [79]; van der Merwe et al. (modal comparison of heat laws) [46]; Sarkar et al. (nonlocal type II) [80]. |
| Surface waves | Biswas (porous nonlocal, orthotropic; piezothermoelastic layer) [81, 82]; Tung (nonlocal piezoelastic Rayleigh) [83]; Gupta et al. (nonlocal piezo-semiconductor Rayleigh wave) [84]; Aldandani et al. [85]; Ivanov–Savova (energy flux of surface waves) [86]. |
| Reflection at free or insulated boundaries | Das et al. [87]; Kalkal et al. (nonlocal micropolar with rotation) [88]; Singh–Guha (piezothermoelastic fibre-reinforced) [89]; Yadav et al. [90]; Gupta et al. [91]; Singh et al. (flexoelectric) [92]; Jiao et al. (flexomagnetic) [93]. |
| Interfaces and energy partition | Barak et al. [94–97]; Gupta–Kumar [98, 99]; Kumar et al. [100–107]; Fu–Wei (micropolar imperfect interface) [108]; Liu et al. (graded piezoelectric) [109]. |
| Transient response, rods, bodies | Singh–Pal [110, 111]; Biswas [112]; Sur et al. [113, 114]; Bayones et al. [115]; Li et al. (laser pulse, bilayer) [116]; Abouelregal [117–119]; Lata et al. [120]. |
| Damping in resonators | Yang et al. (DPL damping in nonlocal nanoplates) [121]; Kumar et al. (couple stress plates) [122]. |
| Fractional and memory models | Povstenko [52, 54–56]; Sherief et al. [57]; Ezzat–El-Karamany [58]; Wang–Li [59, 60, 123]; Yu et al. [124]; Bachher–Sarkar [125]. |
| Size effects | Eringen [15, 16]; Aifantis [17]; Askes–Aifantis [18, 50]; Maranganti–Sharma [126, 127]; Lazar–Agiasofitou [128]; Zang et al. [129]; Li et al. [130]. |
| Variational and uniqueness theory | Marotti de Sciarra [131]; Srivastava–Mukhopadhyay [132]; Chandrasekharaiah [39]; Chiriţă et al. [44, 45]. |

laws. Each step adds one modelling ingredient (relaxation time, second temperature, thermal displacement, lag on temperature gradient, inertia term, memory kernel). Recurrent pitfalls: unmeasured lag parameters, Taylor truncation passed off as exact, mode-flux sums mistaken for energy conservation, GN-III confused with a finite-speed theory.

The papers of Chiriţă and co-workers [44, 45] examine thermodynamic compatibility and continuous dependence of the time-differential lag models, and the stability computation reported in Section 4.3 shows how strongly the truncation order matters.

## 3.2 Thermomechanical foundations

This section collects the balance laws, the thermodynamic structure of linear thermoelasticity, the reasons Fourier's law fails for fast processes, and the heat-flux template that organises the rest of the review. The presentation is self-contained, so later sections can cite equation numbers instead of rederiving them.

### 3.2.1 Balance laws for small disturbances

Let a body occupy a region $\Omega$ and let $\boldsymbol{u}(\boldsymbol{x},t)$ be the displacement from a reference state at uniform temperature $T_0$ and zero stress. For small displacement gradients the strain is $\varepsilon_{ij} =$

$\tfrac{1}{2}(u_{i,j}+u_{j,i})$. The local forms of the balance of linear momentum and of energy are

$$\rho\,\ddot{u}_i = \sigma_{ij,j} + \rho f_i, \tag{1}$$

$$\rho\,\dot{e} = \sigma_{ij}\dot{\varepsilon}_{ij} - q_{i,i} + \rho r, \tag{2}$$

where $\rho$ is the (reference) density, $f_i$ the body force per unit mass, $e$ the specific internal energy, $q_i$ the heat flux and $r$ the heat supply per unit mass. Balance of angular momentum makes the stress symmetric when no couple stresses act. The second law, in the Clausius–Duhem form used by Coleman and Noll [133],

$$\rho\,\dot{\eta} \;\geq\; \frac{\rho r}{T} - \left(\frac{q_i}{T}\right)_{,i}, \tag{3}$$

with specific entropy $\eta$ and absolute temperature $T$, restricts the constitutive relations. Eliminating $r$ between (2) and (3) and introducing the Helmholtz free energy $\psi = e - T\eta$ gives

$$-\rho\left(\dot{\psi} + \eta\dot{T}\right) + \sigma_{ij}\dot{\varepsilon}_{ij} - \frac{q_i T_{,i}}{T} \;\geq\; 0. \tag{4}$$

For a material with $\psi = \psi(\varepsilon_{ij}, T)$, (4) must hold for arbitrary $\dot{\varepsilon}_{ij}$ and $\dot{T}$, so the coefficients of those rates vanish,

$$\sigma_{ij} = \rho\,\frac{\partial\psi}{\partial\varepsilon_{ij}}, \qquad \eta = -\frac{\partial\psi}{\partial T}, \tag{5}$$

and the remaining term gives the *heat-conduction inequality*

$$q_i T_{,i} \;\leq\; 0. \tag{6}$$

Fourier's law $q_i = -k_{ij}T_{,j}$ with positive-semidefinite $k_{ij}$ satisfies (6) identically, as does any law whose flux is, to leading order, opposed to the temperature gradient. Here lies the difficulty with lagged and relaxed laws (Section 3.2.3).

### 3.2.2 Linear thermoelasticity

Expand $\rho\psi$ to second order about $(\varepsilon_{ij}, T) = (0, T_0)$, with $\theta = T - T_0$:

$$\rho\psi = \tfrac{1}{2}C_{ijkl}\varepsilon_{ij}\varepsilon_{kl} - \beta_{ij}\varepsilon_{ij}\theta - \frac{\rho c}{2T_0}\theta^2, \tag{7}$$

where $C_{ijkl}$ are the isothermal elastic moduli, $\beta_{ij}$ the thermal-stress tensor and $c$ the specific heat at constant strain. The constant and linear terms in $\theta$ are dropped, since they only fix the reference values of the energy and the entropy. Equations (5) give

$$\sigma_{ij} = C_{ijkl}\varepsilon_{kl} - \beta_{ij}\theta, \qquad \rho\eta = \beta_{ij}\varepsilon_{ij} + \frac{\rho c}{T_0}\theta. \tag{8}$$

The first of these is the Duhamel–Neumann relation. For an isotropic solid $C_{ijkl} = \lambda\,\delta_{ij}\delta_{kl} + \mu(\delta_{ik}\delta_{jl} + \delta_{il}\delta_{jk})$ and $\beta_{ij} = \beta\,\delta_{ij}$ with $\beta = (3\lambda + 2\mu)\alpha_T$, because free thermal expansion $\varepsilon_{ij} = \alpha_T\,\theta\,\delta_{ij}$ must produce zero stress: $\sigma_{ij} = (3\lambda+2\mu)\alpha_T\,\theta\,\delta_{ij} - \beta\,\theta\,\delta_{ij} = 0$. The energy balance $\rho T\dot{\eta} = -q_{i,i} + \rho r$, which is the entropy form of (2) once the stress power is accounted for by the free energy, linearised about $T_0$ with the second of (8), gives

$$\rho c\,\dot{\theta} + T_0\,\beta_{ij}\dot{\varepsilon}_{ij} = -q_{i,i} + \rho r. \tag{9}$$

Together with (1), (8) and a heat-flux law, (9) closes the system. Each coefficient has a physical reading. The product $\rho c$ is the heat capacity per unit volume at constant strain; $T_0\beta^2/(\rho c)$ is the difference between the adiabatic and isothermal longitudinal moduli,

$$\lambda_{\mathrm{ad}} + 2\mu_{\mathrm{ad}} = \lambda + 2\mu + \frac{T_0\beta^2}{\rho c}, \qquad \text{equivalently} \qquad c_{\mathrm{ad}}^2 = c_1^2(1+\varepsilon), \quad \varepsilon = \frac{\beta^2 T_0}{\rho^2 c\, c_1^2}. \tag{10}$$

Table 3 gives the coupling parameter $\varepsilon$ and the characteristic frequency $\omega_* = \rho c c_1^2/k$ for representative solids. The coupling is of order $10^{-2}$ for common metals and far smaller for low-expansion materials. The characteristic frequency lies well above the ultrasonic range for bulk solids ($10^{10}$–$10^{12}$ Hz) and falls into the megahertz–gigahertz range only when waves are confined to micro-scale structures (Section 9.1).

**Table 3:** Thermoelastic coupling $\varepsilon$ and characteristic frequency $f_* = \omega_*/2\pi$ computed from rounded handbook-type values (300 K) of density, specific heat, conductivity, expansion coefficient, Young's modulus and Poisson ratio; the reader should replace them by data for the specimen at hand.

| Material | $c_1$ (m/s) | $\varepsilon$ | $f_* = \omega_*/2\pi$ (Hz) | $\alpha = k/\rho c$ (m$^2$/s) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Aluminium | 6198 | 0.027 | $6.3 \times 10^{10}$ | $9.8 \times 10^{-5}$ |
| Copper | 4540 | 0.019 | $2.8 \times 10^{10}$ | $1.2 \times 10^{-4}$ |
| Silicon | 8854 | 0.00056 | $1.4 \times 10^{11}$ | $9.2 \times 10^{-5}$ |
| Steel (carbon) | 5778 | 0.0097 | $4.1 \times 10^{11}$ | $1.3 \times 10^{-5}$ |
| Fused silica | 5972 | 7.2e-06 | $6.6 \times 10^{12}$ | $8.6 \times 10^{-7}$ |

### 3.2.3 Beyond Fourier's law

**Why Fourier's law is parabolic.** Inserting $q_i = -kT_{,i}$ in (9) with constant coefficients and no coupling gives $\rho c\,\dot\theta = k\nabla^2\theta$. The fundamental solution is a Gaussian, nonzero at every distance for every positive time, so the signal speed is unbounded. Because that Gaussian decays so rapidly, the infinite speed has no observable consequence for slow processes. For processes on the time scale of the carrier relaxation it does.

**Relaxation of the flux.** A natural modification, due to Cattaneo and Vernotte [25, 26], lets the flux relax to its Fourier value with relaxation time $\tau_0$:

$$q_i + \tau_0 \dot q_i = -k\,\theta_{,i}. \tag{11}$$

With (9) and no coupling, $k\nabla^2\theta = \rho c(\dot\theta + \tau_0\ddot\theta)$, a damped wave equation with front speed $c_T = \sqrt{k/(\rho c\tau_0)}$. In kinetic terms $\tau_0$ is the mean time between momentum-destroying collisions of the heat carriers, and $c_T$ is of the order of the carrier speed divided by $\sqrt{3}$ in three dimensions. Phonon hydrodynamics admits a different, "second sound", regime in which normal (momentum-conserving) collisions dominate [29–31].

**Thermodynamic compatibility via extended irreversible thermodynamics.** The Cattaneo law does not follow from (3) with a free energy that depends only on $(\varepsilon_{ij}, T)$: the flux itself

must enter the state space. Extended irreversible thermodynamics does that [134–136], with an entropy that depends also on $q_i$. In one dimension, without deformation, take

$$\eta = \eta_{\mathrm{eq}}(e) - \frac{\tau_0}{2\rho k T^2}\, q^2, \qquad \rho \dot{e} = -q_{,x} \tag{12}$$

and an entropy flux $q/T$. Then

$$\rho \dot{\eta} + \left(\frac{q}{T}\right)_{,x} = -\frac{q}{kT^2}\left(\tau_0 \dot{q} + k T_{,x}\right), \tag{13}$$

and for the Cattaneo law the bracket equals $-q$, so the entropy production is $q^2/(kT^2) \geq 0$. This is the minimal sense in which the relaxed law is thermodynamically admissible: the entropy carries a quadratic correction in the flux. That correction is of second order in the disturbance, which is why the linear theory does not feel it. In lagged models the corresponding entropy functional must be built model by model, and for the time-differential three-phase-lag model thermodynamic principles impose restrictions on the delay times and, in the high-order case, on the conductivities [44, 137].

**Thermal displacement and the Green–Naghdi route.** Green and Naghdi [36, 38] take instead an entropy *balance* with an entropy flux, and postulate constitutive relations in terms of the *thermal displacement* $v$, $\dot{v} = \theta$ (so $v = \int \theta \, \mathrm{d}t$). The flux $q_i$ may depend on $\theta_{,i}$ and $v_{,i}$; type II ($q_i = -k^* v_{,i}$) conserves energy, and type III adds Fourier dissipation. In wave problems $v$ is the natural field, since $\hat{v} = \hat{\theta}/s$.

**Green–Lindsay: rates in the stress and entropy.** Green and Lindsay [33] keep a single temperature but let the free energy and the stress depend on $\dot{\theta}$, so that the entropy and stress relations carry temperature-rate terms; the original paper expresses this through constitutive coefficients and does not name a relaxation time. The relaxation times $\tau_0, \tau_1$ used in this review are the notation of the later literature for those rate coefficients, and the heat flux is taken in its Fourier form, as is usual for the isotropic case. Solutions of the original theory can show discontinuities at wave fronts that some authors regard as unphysical, and a modification with a strain-rate term has been proposed to remove them [138]. Section 4.2 returns to this theory.

### 3.2.4 The heat-flux template

Linear wave problems with constant coefficients depend on the heat-flux law only through its Laplace-domain relation between flux and temperature gradient. The family is therefore defined

$$q_i + \tau_q \dot{q}_i = -k\left(\theta_{,i} + \tau_T \dot{\theta}_{,i}\right) - k^*\left(v_{,i} + \tau_v \dot{v}_{,i}\right), \qquad \dot{v} = \theta, \tag{14}$$

and note that after Laplace transformation with zero initial data

$$\hat{q}_i = -G(s)\, \hat{\theta}_{,i}, \qquad G(s) = \frac{k(1+\tau_T s) + k^*(1+\tau_v s)/s}{1+\tau_q s}. \tag{15}$$

Table 4 lists the parameter choices that reproduce the models expressible in the template. Green–Lindsay theory (Section 4.2.3) changes the energy and constitutive equations and so is not a row; for fractional and memory-dependent models $G(s)$ keeps the same structure with $s$ replaced by non-integer powers or by kernel transforms (Section 5.1).

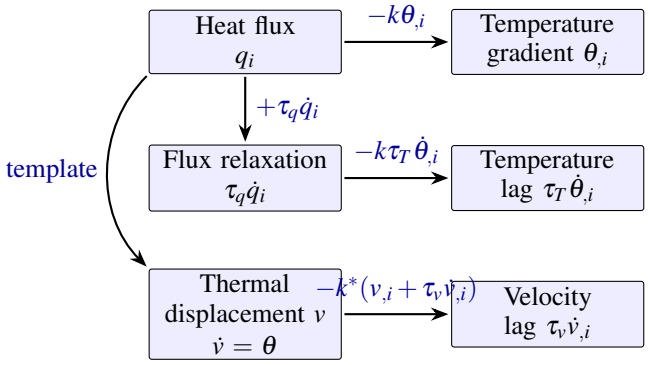



**Figure 4:** Original schematic; the setting follows [1]: the heat-flux template couples the flux to temperature gradients through relaxation and lags. Each theory sets some terms to zero.

**Table 4:** Heat-flux theories as parameter choices in the template (14). All entries use the energy balance (9).

| Theory | $k$ | $k^*$ | $\tau_q$ | $\tau_T$ | $\tau_v$ | Source |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Classical (Fourier) | $k$ | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | [1] |
| Lord–Shulman (Cattaneo) | $k$ | 0 | $\tau_0$ | 0 | 0 | [25, 26, 32] |
| Dual-phase-lag (DPL), 1st order | $k$ | 0 | $\tau_q$ | $\tau_T$ | 0 | [40, 41] |
| Green–Naghdi II | 0 | $k^*$ | 0 | 0 | 0 | [38] |
| Green–Naghdi III | $k$ | $k^*$ | 0 | 0 | 0 | [36] |
| Three-phase-lag (TPL) | $k$ | $k^*$ | $\tau_q$ | $\tau_T$ | $\tau_v$ | [42] |
| MGT (flux form) | $k$ | $k^*$ | $\tau_q$ | 0 | 0 | [71] |

**Exact reductions and singular limits.** The function $G(s)$ decides which reductions are regular. The following was verified symbolically (reduction check).

- **DPL → Lord–Shulman:** $\tau_T \to 0$ with $\tau_q = \tau_0$ fixed and $k^* = 0$. Letting $\tau_q \to 0$ with $\tau_T$ fixed gives instead $G = k(1+\tau_T s)$, a Fourier law with a temperature-rate term (Kelvin–Voigt-like conduction), not Cattaneo.
- **TPL → DPL:** $k^* \to 0$. For $k^* \neq 0$ the function $G(s) \sim k^*/s$ as $s \to 0$, so the low-frequency and long-time response changes qualitatively.
- **TPL → classical:** $k^* \to 0$ and all three lags $\to 0$.
- **GN-II:** $k = 0$, all lags zero, $G = k^* s$; **GN-III:** all lags zero, $G = k + k^* s$.
- **Large-$s$ behaviour.** $G(\infty) = 0$ for Lord–Shulman (hyperbolic behaviour, finite thermal speed $c_T$); $G(\infty) = k\tau_T/\tau_q$ for DPL, which is diffusive again at high frequency with effective conductivity $k\tau_T/\tau_q$.
- **Fractional orders:** the endpoint $\alpha \to 2$ of the Caputo family is second order in time and is not Fourier's law (Section 5.1).

### 3.2.5 Energy balance and energy flux

For the Lord–Shulman model without body forces and heat supply, multiply (1) by $\dot{u}_i$ and (9) by $\theta/T_0$, and use (11):

$$\frac{\partial \mathscr{E}}{\partial t} + P_{i,i} = -\frac{q_i q_i}{kT_0}, \qquad \mathscr{E} = \tfrac{1}{2}\rho \dot{u}_i \dot{u}_i + \tfrac{1}{2} C_{ijkl}\varepsilon_{ij}\varepsilon_{kl} + \frac{\rho c}{2T_0}\theta^2 + \frac{\tau_0}{2kT_0} q_i q_i, \tag{16}$$

$$P_i = -\sigma_{ij}\dot{u}_j + \frac{\theta\, q_i}{T_0}. \tag{17}$$

Here $\mathscr{E}$ is positive definite, $P_i$ is the flux associated with it, and the right-hand side is the dissipation. This quadratic (availability-type) energy and its flux $P_i$ are what linear wave theory means by "energy flux". They differ from the flux $q_i - \sigma_{ij}\dot{u}_j$ of the *total* internal energy, whose heat-flux part is first order in the disturbance and averages to zero over a period. For the classical theory the same procedure gives (16) without the last term in $\mathscr{E}$. For other members of the template an energy functional exists under parameter conditions that must be stated model by model: for Green–Naghdi type II the functional is conserved; for the first-order DPL and TPL truncations none is constructed here. Stability of the one-dimensional DPL problem was obtained by a spectral argument [43], and thermodynamic compatibility and continuous dependence of the time-differential TPL model are treated in [44]. Section 6.10 uses (17) for interface energy partition.

**The exact total-energy flux, and the reduced form.** The availability flux (17) satisfies a dissipation identity, and it is the flux used for the interface energy partition in Section 6.10. There it is the net flux across the interface, and not the sum of per-mode fractions, that is conserved. It is *not* the flux of total energy, and the difference matters whenever a fixed control volume is meant rather than a material element. Add the mechanical power balance to the internal-energy balance, convert the material derivative with mass conservation, and write $\mathscr{E}_{\mathrm{tot}} = \rho\left(\frac{1}{2}\dot{v}_i\dot{u}_i + e\right)$ for the total energy per unit volume. The balances are read here as spatial balances, with $\rho$, $\sigma_{ij}$ and $q_i$ the current density, Cauchy stress and spatial heat flux; they coincide with the referential quantities of the linearised theory used elsewhere in this review only to first order in the disturbance, and the advection term below is of higher order. The result is the identity

$$\frac{\partial \mathscr{E}_{\mathrm{tot}}}{\partial t} + \frac{\partial}{\partial x_j}\left(q_j - \sigma_{ji}\dot{u}_i + \mathscr{E}_{\mathrm{tot}}\dot{u}_j\right) = \rho f_i \dot{u}_i + \rho r, \tag{18}$$

so that with no body force and no heat supply the outward-positive Eulerian flux is

$$F_j = q_j - \sigma_{ji}\dot{u}_i + \mathscr{E}_{\mathrm{tot}}\dot{u}_j, \qquad \frac{\partial \mathscr{E}_{\mathrm{tot}}}{\partial t} + \frac{\partial F_j}{\partial x_j} = 0. \tag{19}$$

Three contributions appear: conduction $q_j$, stress power $-\sigma_{ji}\dot{u}_i$, and advection of total energy $\mathscr{E}_{\mathrm{tot}}\dot{u}_j$. The first two alone make the reduced flux $J_j = q_j - \sigma_{ji}\dot{u}_i$ that most of the literature uses, and that first-order small-amplitude wave calculations use; $J_j$ is the first-order reduction of $F_j$ under the stated small-motion assumptions, not an exact fixed-volume flux.

None of this displaces (17). The two objects answer different questions. $P_i$ is the flux tied to a positive-definite availability functional whose balance carries the dissipation on the right-hand side, and it is the flux whose net balance across a welded interface is exact in Section 6.10. $F_j$ is the conserved flux of total energy in a fixed frame. A comparison of one generalized model's energy transport with another's means something only once it is stated which of the two is being compared, and the reduced notation common in the literature leaves that open.

**Summary**

The balance laws (1)–(9), the Coleman–Noll relations (5) and the conduction inequality (6) close the system once a heat-flux law is supplied. Fourier's law is parabolic; relaxed and lagged laws give finite-speed thermal waves. The template (14) reduces to classical, Lord–Shulman (LS), dual-phase-lag (DPL), three-phase-lag (TPL), GN-II/III and MGT by

setting its parameters, but the endpoint $\tau_q \to 0$ with $\tau_T$ fixed is singular (Kelvin–Voigt-like conduction, not Cattaneo). Among these members, only GN-II has a positive-definite energy functional that is conserved exactly in the stated ideal case; the others dissipate it for nonzero coefficients.

## 3.3 Mathematical preliminaries

A small set of tools recurs in the later sections. They are collected here with the conventions of this review, so that every statement about branches, damping and dispersion rests on a single definition.

### 3.3.1 Fourier–Laplace conventions

Fields depend on $\exp[\mathrm{i}(kx-\omega t)]$ and the Laplace variable is $s=-\mathrm{i}\omega$, so that $\partial_t \to s$ and $\partial_x \to \mathrm{i}k$. For a causal response, one that vanishes before the excitation, the transfer functions $G(s)$ and the resulting $k(\omega)$ are analytic in the upper half of the complex $\omega$-plane ($\operatorname{Re} s > 0$). Two consequences are used below. The wave number of the uncoupled thermal branch follows from $k^2 = -\rho c\, s/G(s)$. The appropriate root is the one whose spatial amplitude does not grow, $\operatorname{Im} k \geq 0$, with $\operatorname{Re} k > 0$ for propagation in $+x$.

### 3.3.2 Branches and the choice of root

For the rational heat laws treated in this review, in a linear homogeneous medium, the dispersion relation is a polynomial in $K = k^2$ with coefficients that depend on $s$; for exact delays, fractional powers or hereditary kernels those coefficients are transcendental or multivalued functions of $s$, and the rules below apply with the corresponding branch cuts. Each root $K_j(s)$ therefore gives two wave numbers $\pm\sqrt{K_j}$. Three rules are adopted: (i) for each $K_j$, take the square root with $\operatorname{Im} k \geq 0$; (ii) a "branch" is a $k(\omega)$ followed continuously in $\omega$, because the labels "elastic-type" and "thermal-type" mean something only away from hybridisation, where roots approach each other; (iii) near hybridisation, which in the Lord–Shulman model occurs for $\tau\omega_* \approx 1$, tracking by continuity on a sufficiently fine frequency grid is necessary, and selecting the root nearest an expected value fails. Both failures occurred while producing the figures of this review.

### 3.3.3 Spatial and temporal damping

Loss admits two measures. For real $\omega$ and complex $k$, $Q_x^{-1} = 2\operatorname{Im} k/\operatorname{Re} k$; for real $k$ and complex $\omega$, $Q_t^{-1} = 2|\operatorname{Im}\omega|/|\operatorname{Re}\omega|$. At weak damping the two are related by the group-to-phase velocity ratio, $Q_t^{-1} \simeq (v_g/v_p)\, Q_x^{-1}$. In the clamped-bar example of Section 6.6 the classical peak $Q_t^{-1} = 0.0488$ at $\varepsilon = 0.1$ compares with the Debye value $\varepsilon/2 = 0.05$ of the spatial measure. The difference is a few percent, of the order $\varepsilon$ that the relation predicts. Resonator experiments measure $Q_t$ and wave-propagation experiments $Q_x$, and the two should not be compared without the conversion.

### 3.3.4 Causality and the sum rule

A causal response obeys the Kramers–Kronig relations, which tie dispersion to loss: a medium with a loss peak must show a change of speed. At weak damping the relation takes the form of a sum rule,

$$\int_0^\infty Q_x^{-1}\, d\ln\omega = \pi\,\frac{v_0 - v_\infty}{\bar{v}}, \tag{20}$$

where $v_0$ and $v_\infty$ are the phase speeds at zero and infinite frequency and $\bar{v}$ is their mean. For the Debye form $Q^{-1} = \varepsilon x/(1+x^2)$ the left side is $\pi\varepsilon/2$ and the right side is $\pi(\sqrt{1+\varepsilon}-1)/\left[(\sqrt{1+\varepsilon}+1)/2\right] \approx \pi\varepsilon/2$, consistent with the adiabatic and isothermal speeds of Section 4.1. Equation (20) was checked numerically on the exact coupled classical dispersion relation (Kramers–Kronig check). At $\varepsilon = 0.01$ the integral is $1.562994\times10^{-2}$ against $1.562991\times10^{-2}$ on the right; at $\varepsilon = 0.001$ the two sides are $1.570009\times10^{-3}$ and $1.570011\times10^{-3}$. The rule is therefore a practical consistency test on any computed or measured loss curve: a model that predicts a loss peak without a corresponding speed change, or the reverse, either violates causality or has been truncated inconsistently.

### 3.3.5 Support of the solution and finite signal speed

The Laplace transform of a solution supported in $x \le ct$ decays as $e^{-sx/c}$ for $\operatorname{Re} s \to \infty$. The converse also holds: a transfer function with $k(s) \sim s/c$ at large $s$ implies a front travelling at $c$. That is the origin of the criterion used in Section 4.2: finite signal speed requires $sG(s)$ to tend to a finite, non-zero limit. Models with $k_w \sim \sqrt{s}$ at large $s$ (classical, DPL, TPL, GN-III, and the Guyer–Krumhansl law of Section 3.4) have no front, and a transient problem for them has a solution that is nonzero everywhere immediately after the excitation, however small.

### 3.3.6 Complex roots of the delay law

When $G$ contains an exponential, as in the exact delay law of Section 4.4, $k^2 = -\rho c\, s/G(s)$ is an entire function times $s$ and has infinitely many branches. Truncations replace it by a rational function with finitely many roots. Roots of the delay law that the truncation does not contain, and spurious roots that it introduces, plausibly explain why truncated and exact laws differ at $\omega\tau \gtrsim 1$, but this has to be checked for each truncation.

**Summary**

The Laplace/Fourier convention ($s = -\mathrm{i}\omega$, $\operatorname{Im} k \ge 0$ for decay) fixes branch choices once and for all. Damping, attenuation and quality factor are $Q^{-1} = 2\operatorname{Im} k/\operatorname{Re} k$ for spatial problems and $2|\operatorname{Im}\omega|/\operatorname{Re}\omega$ for temporal problems. Causality follows from analyticity in the upper half-plane; support properties (finite front) are read from the large-$s$ behaviour of $G(s)$. The exact delay law has infinitely many branches; truncations keep finitely many and can introduce spurious roots.

### 3.3.7 Admissibility of a heat law

A heat law can be wrong in several ways, and the tests are not interchangeable. *Conservation* is built into the balance laws and says nothing about the constitutive law. *Thermodynamic admissibility* asks whether the law is compatible with the second law; for materials with internal

state variables the Clausius–Duhem inequality restricts the response functions [139], and for heat conduction with memory it restricts the relaxation functions, not merely the signs of coefficients [140]. *Causality* asks that the response vanish before the excitation, which for the transfer function means analyticity for $\operatorname{Re} s > 0$. *Stability* asks that no mode grow in time. *Finite speed* is a property of the high-frequency limit and stands independent of the others. A model can pass one test and fail another.

For the template of Section 3.2 in a linear, homogeneous medium, two necessary conditions follow from the transfer function $G(s) = \left[k(1+\tau_T s)+k^*(1+\tau_v s)/s\right]/(1+\tau_q s)$ of the uncoupled thermal mode. Both are derived here and verified with admissibility check.

**Mean dissipation.** For a harmonic temperature gradient the time-averaged product $-q\,\theta_{,x}$ is proportional to $\operatorname{Re} G(i\omega)$, and

$$\operatorname{Re} G(i\omega) = \frac{k + k^*(\tau_v - \tau_q) + k\,\tau_q\tau_T\,\omega^2}{1+\tau_q^2\omega^2}. \tag{21}$$

A heat flux that on average removes entropy-producing gradients, with the entropy flux taken as $q/T_0$, needs $\operatorname{Re} G \geq 0$ at every frequency. For $\tau_q, \tau_T \geq 0$ this reduces to

$$k + k^*(\tau_v - \tau_q) \;\geq\; 0. \tag{22}$$

The Green–Naghdi type-II law ($k = 0$, all lags zero) gives $\operatorname{Re} G = 0$ at every frequency: it is lossless, which agrees with the statement of Green and Naghdi that this theory involves no dissipation of energy and permits harmonic waves without damping [38].

**Temporal stability.** For a real wave number $\kappa$, put $K = \kappa^2$. The modes $e^{st}$ of the uncoupled thermal equation solve

$$\rho c\,\tau_q s^3 + (\rho c + Kk\tau_T)s^2 + K(k + k^*\tau_v)s + Kk^* = 0. \tag{23}$$

The Routh–Hurwitz conditions for all roots in the open left half-plane are equivalent to

$$\rho c\left[k + k^*(\tau_v - \tau_q)\right] + Kk\tau_T\,(k + k^*\tau_v) > 0, \tag{24}$$

so that for $\tau_T \geq 0$ stability at all wave numbers requires the same inequality (22) as the dissipation test. The strict statement applies for $K > 0$, $\tau_q > 0$ and $k^* > 0$. For $k^* = 0$ the cubic has a factor $s$ that comes from the thermal-displacement variable ($\dot{v} = \theta$) and not from the temperature equation, so the test applies to the remaining quadratic factor; $K = 0$ is the uniform, conserved mode ($s = 0$); and for $\tau_q = 0$ the degree drops and the quadratic test replaces the cubic one. Equation (24) was confirmed against the numerically computed roots of (23) for 20 000 random parameter sets, with no disagreement.

These tests are necessary, not sufficient. A mode-by-mode check says nothing about the coupled problem, about energy-flux postulates other than $q/T_0$, or about well-posedness of initial-boundary-value problems. The entropy flux in the Green–Naghdi theories is a separate quantity with the heat flux equal to the temperature times that flux; for type II it follows from the free-energy potential rather than from a Fourier law, and in linearized type I it agrees with $q/T_0$ to first order [38]. For a law with memory the second law constrains the relaxation functions themselves: the initial values of the energy and heat-flux relaxation functions are non-negative, the

**Table 5:** Admissibility of the template models for the uncoupled thermal mode (derived here; $\tau_q, \tau_T, \tau_v \geq 0$). "Finite speed" refers to the high-frequency limit of the uncoupled mode.

| Model | Parameter choice | Dissipation and stability | Comment |
|---|---|---|---|
| Fourier | all lags $= 0$, $k^* = 0$ | $\mathrm{Re}\,G = k > 0$; stable | Infinite speed. |
| Lord–Shulman | $k^* = 0$, $\tau_T = 0$ | $\mathrm{Re}\,G = k/(1+\tau_q^2\omega^2) > 0$; stable | Finite speed $\sqrt{k/(\rho c\,\tau_q)}$. |
| Dual-phase-lag | $k^* = 0$ | $\mathrm{Re}\,G > 0$ for $\tau_T \geq 0$; stable | No finite front in the first-order law (diffusive at high frequency). |
| Green–Naghdi II | $k = 0$, lags $= 0$ | $\mathrm{Re}\,G = 0$; marginal (purely oscillatory) | Lossless, finite speed. |
| Green–Naghdi III | lags $= 0$ | $\mathrm{Re}\,G = k > 0$; stable | Diffusive at high frequency, no finite front. |
| Moore–Gibson–Thompson | $\tau_T = \tau_v = 0$ | stable iff $k \geq k^*\tau_q$ (marginal at equality) | Finite speed; not admissible if $k^*\tau_q > k$, in line with the instability for $k < k^*\tau_q$ and the exponential stability for $k - \tau k^* > 0$ in Quintanilla [71]. |
| Three-phase-lag | general | stable iff (22) (for $\tau_T \geq 0$) | Parameters must be chosen within this region. |

initial slope of the heat-flux relaxation function is non-positive, and the equilibrium conductivity is non-negative [140]. A Kramers–Kronig check of the kind in Section 3.3 does not establish admissibility. Inequality (22) is also a parameter restriction that fitted values must respect, and reported phase-lag values should be checked against it before they are used as evidence for a model.

## 3.4 Kinetic origin of the hyperbolic and Guyer–Krumhansl laws

Formal structure usually justifies the lag models of Section 4.3. Their physical meaning comes from the kinetic theory of phonons, and this section summarises how the two most-used laws arise there. Standard results of phonon hydrodynamics are stated at the level of structure; coefficient values depend on the dispersion model and should be taken from the original derivations.

### 3.4.1 Relaxation-time closure and the Cattaneo law

Write the linearised phonon Boltzmann equation for the deviation $n'$ from equilibrium with a single relaxation time $\tau_R$ for momentum-destroying (resistive) scattering. Take the first moment, with the energy flux $q$ as the moment variable, and close it at first order by taking the second moment proportional to the temperature gradient:

$$\tau_R \dot{q} + q = -k\nabla\theta, \qquad k = \tfrac{1}{3} c_v v_{\mathrm{g}}^2 \tau_R, \tag{25}$$

where $v_{\mathrm{g}}$ is the phonon group speed. This is the Cattaneo law with $\tau_q = \tau_R$, valid when the closure holds, that is, when the phonon mean free path is small compared with the wavelength, so that $\omega\tau_R \ll 1$ and $\ell_{\mathrm{mfp}} k \ll 1$. Beyond that the closure fails, and the finite speed $\sqrt{k/(c_v\tau_R)} = v/\sqrt{3}$ should not be expected to describe a ballistic front. Two sources treat this regime directly. Chen [141] derives ballistic–diffusive equations from the Boltzmann equation

in the relaxation-time approximation by splitting the distribution function into a part that originates at the boundaries and a part that originates inside the domain, and presents them as a better approximation than the Fourier law or the Cattaneo equation when the sample size or the pulse duration is comparable to the carrier mean free path or relaxation time. Dreyer and Struchtrup [142] review heat-pulse experiments in dielectric solids at low temperature and explain them, including the competition of ballistic phonons, second sound and ordinary conduction, within extended thermodynamics of phonons.

### 3.4.2 Normal scattering and the Guyer–Krumhansl law

If momentum-conserving (normal) collisions with time $\tau_N$ dominate over resistive ones, $\tau_N \ll \tau_R$, the expansion to the next order yields the Guyer–Krumhansl equation

$$\tau_R \dot{q} + q = -k\nabla\theta + \ell^2\left(\nabla^2 q + 2\nabla\nabla\cdot q\right), \tag{26}$$

with a length $\ell$ of order $v_g\sqrt{\tau_N\tau_R}$ up to a model-dependent numerical factor ($1/5$ in a common Debye-type derivation). In one dimension the bracket becomes $3q_{,xx}$. Together with $c_v\dot{\theta} = -q_{,x}$ the uncoupled dispersion relation is

$$k_w^2 = -\frac{c_v s\,(1+\tau_R s)}{k + 3\ell^2 c_v s}, \qquad s = -i\omega. \tag{27}$$

Law Eq. (26) is not of the form $\hat{q} = -G(s)\hat{\theta}_{,x}$ with $G$ independent of $k_w$: the Laplacian term makes the response wavenumber dependent. It therefore lies outside the template of Section 3.2 and is treated separately in Section 5.3. The practical consequence is that size effects and relaxation effects cannot be separated by choosing different $G(s)$.

### 3.4.3 Dispersion of the Guyer–Krumhansl law

Figure 5 (Guyer–Krumhansl figure) compares the uncoupled thermal branch for the Fourier, Cattaneo and Guyer–Krumhansl laws, in units with $\chi = k/c_v = 1$ and $\tau_R = 1$. Read the numbers at $\omega\tau_R = 0.1,\ 1,\ 10,\ 100$:

- Fourier: phase speed $0.45,\ 1.41,\ 4.48,\ 14.1$ (in units of $\sqrt{\chi/\tau_R}$), growing as $\sqrt{\omega}$, and attenuation $\mathrm{Im}\,k_w = 0.22,\ 0.71,\ 2.2,\ 7.1$.
- Cattaneo ($\ell = 0$): $0.43,\ 0.91,\ 1.00,\ 1.00$. The speed saturates at $\sqrt{\chi/\tau_R}$ and the attenuation at $1/(2\sqrt{\chi\tau_R}) = 0.5$.
- Guyer–Krumhansl with $\ell^2 = 0.05$: $0.43,\ 0.95,\ 1.57,\ 5.3$ and attenuation $0.22,\ 0.53,\ 3.9,\ 18$; with $\ell^2 = 0.3$: $0.45,\ 1.34,\ 4.2,\ 13.4$ and attenuation $0.22,\ 0.71,\ 2.3,\ 7.4$.

At low frequency the three laws coincide with diffusion. At high frequency the Cattaneo law approaches a finite front, whereas the Guyer–Krumhansl law returns to diffusive behaviour: from Eq. (27), $k_w^2 \to i\omega\tau_R/(3\ell^2)$ for $\omega\to\infty$, so both $\mathrm{Re}\,k_w$ and $\mathrm{Im}\,k_w$ grow as $\sqrt{\omega}$ and the phase speed grows as $\sqrt{6\ell^2\omega/\tau_R}$ (confirmed numerically to 0.2%). The linear Guyer–Krumhansl law therefore has no finite signal speed in this uncoupled form. Its role is to represent non-local (Knudsen-type) corrections at intermediate frequencies, not to enforce a front.

### 3.4.4 What this means for model choice

Three consequences follow. (i) A lag law states how the flux relaxes; if the heat-carrier mean free path is comparable to the sample, the Guyer–Krumhansl structure or a full kinetic model

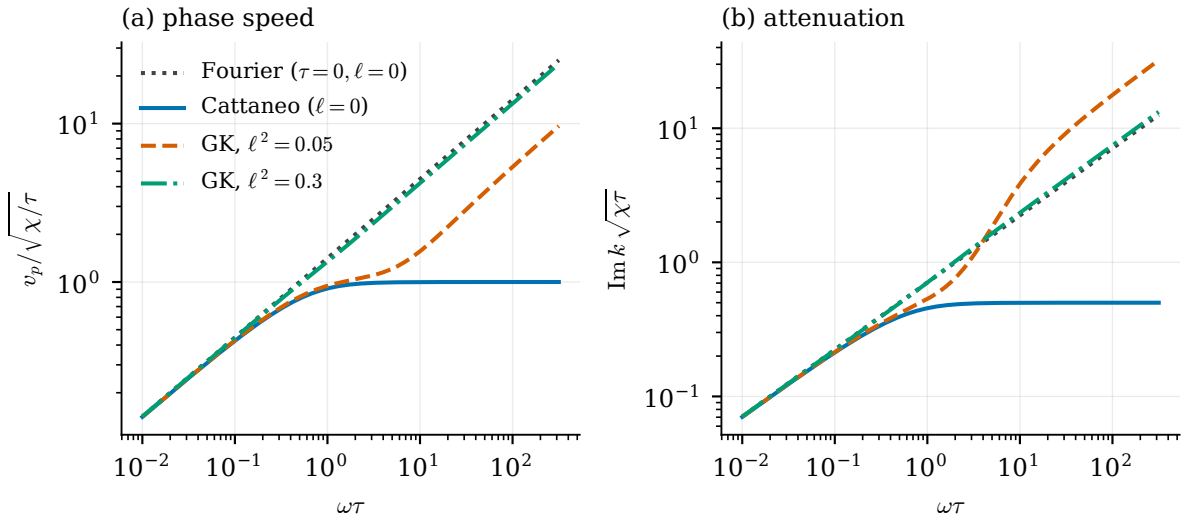



**Figure 5:** Thermal branch for Fourier, Cattaneo and Guyer–Krumhansl laws ($\chi = \tau_R = 1$): (a) phase speed, (b) attenuation. The dispersion relation is Eq. (27).

is the physical starting point. (ii) Parameters $\tau_q$, $\tau_T$ obtained by fitting a lag law to transient data are effective and need not equal a microscopic relaxation time. (iii) A lag law with $\tau_q$ of the order of $10^{-12}$ s describes phonon relaxation only if a closure of the type above holds at the wavelengths and frequencies of interest.

**Summary**

The kinetic closure gives the Guyer–Krumhansl equation, in which momentum-conserving normal collisions produce a spatial nonlocality of the flux. A lag law is an effective closure, not a microscopic statement: fitted $\tau_q, \tau_T$ need not equal microscopic relaxation times. When the phonon mean free path is comparable to the sample size, kinetic/GK or a full Boltzmann treatment is the physical starting point rather than a pure lag law.

## 3.5 Effective modulus, causality and Kramers–Kronig relations

A wave measurement does not return $k(\omega)$ for a heat law. It returns a complex wavenumber that the experimenter reads as a frequency-dependent modulus. That reading is made explicit for the one-dimensional coupled problem, and what causality does and does not imply is stated.

### 3.5.1 The effective modulus is the root of a quadratic

Define $m(s) = \omega^2/K = -s^2/K$, the squared complex phase speed of the elastic-type branch ($K = k^2$). Substituting $K = -s^2/m$ in (33), with $R = \rho c$ the volumetric heat capacity and $\beta^2 T_0$ the coupling, and dividing by $s^3$ gives

$$\rho R\, m^2 - \left[\rho R\, c_1^2 + \rho\, G(s)\, s + \beta^2 T_0\right] m + \rho c_1^2\, G(s)\, s = 0. \tag{28}$$

The effective longitudinal modulus is $M(s) = \rho\, m(s)$, with $m$ the root that tends to $c_1^2$ for $\beta \to 0$. Equation (28) contains the heat law only through the product $G(s)\, s$, which is the statement of

Section 9.3.5 in a different form; it is equivalent to (33) and was checked against the numerical roots of the latter for the classical, Lord–Shulman, dual-phase-lag, Green–Naghdi III and Moore–Gibson–Thompson parameter sets (modulus check, agreement to $10^{-10}$).

Three limits follow directly.

- *Weak coupling.* To first order in $\beta^2 T_0$, $m = c_1^2 + \beta^2 T_0\, c_1^2 / \left[\rho\,(R c_1^2 - G s)\right]$. For Fourier conduction ($G = k$) this is a single Debye term, $m = c_1^2\left[1 + \varepsilon/(1 + \mathrm{i}\omega/\omega_*)\right]$, the weak-coupling form behind the loss peak of Section 4.1.
- *Fourier, exact.* Because $Gs \to 0$ as $s \to 0$ and $Gs \to \infty$ as $s \to \infty$, the elastic-type root tends to the adiabatic value $c_1^2 + \beta^2 T_0/(\rho R)$ at low frequency and to $c_1^2$ at high frequency, as Section 4.1 states.
- *Lord–Shulman, high frequency.* With $Gs \to k/\tau_0$ the two roots of (28) are those of the front relation (37) with $\tau^\dagger = \tau_0$ (verified numerically in the same script), so the finite thermal front enters the modulus as a finite high-frequency limit.

A standard linear solid has a modulus that is a rational function of $s$; $M(s)$ here is an *algebraic* function, a root of a quadratic, with branch points where the discriminant of (28) vanishes. The single Debye form is therefore a weak-coupling approximation, not the exact thermoelastic modulus.

### 3.5.2 What causality implies

The response of the bar to a force applied at $t = 0$ vanishes for $t < 0$ if the transfer function is analytic for $\mathrm{Re}\, s > 0$. For the elastic-type root this requires that the discriminant of (28) has no zero there, and that the admissibility conditions of Section 3.3.7 hold so that $G$ itself is regular. The first condition was tested on a grid of $60 \times 201$ points in $0.001 \le \mathrm{Re}\, s \le 100$, $|\mathrm{Im}\, s| \le 50$ for the five parameter sets above, and no zero of the discriminant was found; the smallest normalised value exceeded $10^{-6}$. That is a numerical test on a bounded region, not a proof. Where analyticity holds, the real and imaginary parts of $M$ are related by the Kramers–Kronig integrals, and the loss integrates to the dispersion step, the sum rule (20), with $c_0, c_\infty$ in the place of $v_0, v_\infty$ and $\bar{c}$ the mean of the two speeds. The relation is confirmed for the classical coupled wave (Kramers–Kronig check, deviation below $10^{-5}$). The sum rule was checked for the classical model only; for the other heat laws it should hold under the same analyticity condition, but it has not been verified here.

**Consequence for fitting.** Analyticity makes a measured attenuation spectrum and a measured velocity spectrum dependent on each other. A lag model fitted separately to the two, with different parameters resulting, is inconsistent with a causal linear response, unless the data are noisy; Section 9.3.5 shows which parameter combinations the pair can determine at all.

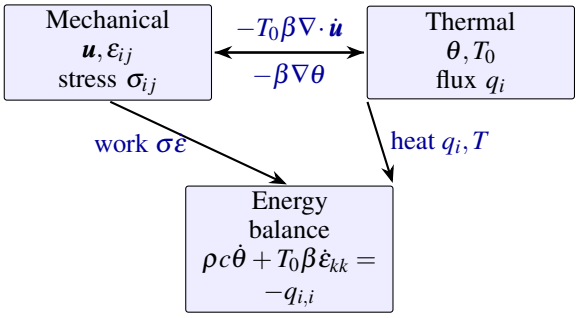



**Figure 6:** Original schematic; the setting follows [1]: classical coupled thermoelasticity – mechanical and thermal fields are linked by the thermal body force and dilatation heating, the two terms sharing $\beta$.

# 4. The theories as parameter choices of one template

## 4.1 Classical coupled thermoelasticity

### 4.1.1 Field equations

For an isotropic solid with Fourier conduction $q_i = -k\theta_{,i}$, (1), (8) and (9) give the Navier-type system

$$\rho\ddot{\boldsymbol{u}} = \mu\nabla^2\boldsymbol{u} + (\lambda+\mu)\nabla(\nabla\cdot\boldsymbol{u}) - \beta\nabla\theta + \rho\boldsymbol{f}, \tag{29}$$

$$\rho c\,\dot{\theta} = k\nabla^2\theta - T_0\beta\,\nabla\cdot\dot{\boldsymbol{u}} + \rho r. \tag{30}$$

The two coupling terms carry the whole thermodynamic content: the thermal body force $-\beta\nabla\theta$ in (29) and the dilatation heating $-T_0\beta\nabla\cdot\dot{\boldsymbol{u}}$ in (30). Their product, $T_0\beta^2$, is what appears in the single coupling constant $\varepsilon$ of (10), and the reciprocal structure, the same $\beta$ in both terms, follows from the existence of the free energy (7). A sign or factor error in either term breaks that reciprocity and is a common source of unphysical results; in the dispersion checks of Appendix B a symbolic comparison with the field equations is exactly what detects it.

**Helmholtz decomposition.** Writing $\boldsymbol{u} = \nabla\phi + \nabla\times\boldsymbol{\psi}$ with $\nabla\cdot\boldsymbol{\psi} = 0$ decouples the problem in an unbounded isotropic body:

$$\rho\ddot{\phi} = (\lambda+2\mu)\nabla^2\phi - \beta\theta, \qquad \rho c\dot{\theta} = k\nabla^2\theta - T_0\beta\nabla^2\dot{\phi}, \qquad \rho\ddot{\boldsymbol{\psi}} = \mu\nabla^2\boldsymbol{\psi}. \tag{31}$$

The shear potential $\boldsymbol{\psi}$ obeys an uncoupled wave equation with speed $c_2 = \sqrt{\mu/\rho}$: in an unbounded isotropic medium, thermoelastic coupling neither attenuates nor disperses transverse waves. Only the dilatational potential couples to temperature. At boundaries and interfaces the boundary conditions couple shear and dilatational motion again, which is why surface waves and reflected shear waves feel the thermal coupling (Sections 6.7 and 6.10).

### 4.1.2 Uniqueness and energy

Multiply (29) by $\dot{u}_i$ and (30) by $\theta/T_0$, then integrate. The result is the energy identity (16) without the flux-relaxation term, with dissipation $\int k|\nabla\theta|^2/T_0\,\mathrm{d}V \geq 0$. Two consequences follow: solutions of the initial–boundary value problem are unique under standard boundary conditions (Dirichlet, Neumann or Robin on each of the mechanical and thermal parts), and they

depend continuously on the data. Variational formulations and reciprocity theorems are available [22, 23], mixed variational formulations exist for the Green–Naghdi type-II model [131], and for the generalized theories these identities are where well-posedness proofs begin [39, 71].

### 4.1.3 Longitudinal plane waves

For one-dimensional dilatational motion, $\boldsymbol{u} = u(x,t)\boldsymbol{e}_x$, equations (29)–(30) reduce to

$$\rho\ddot{u} = (\lambda + 2\mu)u_{,xx} - \beta\theta_{,x}, \qquad \rho c\,\dot{\theta} + T_0\beta\,\dot{u}_{,x} = -q_{,x}. \tag{32}$$

Introduce $\hat{q} = -G(s)\hat{\theta}_{,x}$, so that $G = k$ for the classical theory, and seek solutions $\propto \exp[\mathrm{i}(kx - \omega t)]$. The characteristic equation is quadratic in $K = k^2$:

$$\left(\rho c_1^2 K - \rho\omega^2\right)\left(s\rho c + G(s)K\right) + \beta^2 T_0\, s\, K = 0, \qquad s = -\mathrm{i}\omega. \tag{33}$$

Equation (33) holds for every member of the template of Section 3.2.4; Appendix B gives a derivation and the symbolic check against the field equations. Two branches result: an *elastic-type* branch with $k \approx \omega/c_1$ at weak coupling, and a *thermal-type* branch with $k^2 \approx -s\rho c/G(s)$. They are called types rather than "waves", because the classical thermal branch is a diffusive wave with $\mathrm{Re}\,k = \mathrm{Im}\,k$, which attenuates by a factor $e^{-2\pi}$ per wavelength.

**Weak-coupling expansion.** Let $x = \omega/\omega_*$ with $\omega_* = \rho c c_1^2/k$. For $\varepsilon \ll 1$ and $G = k$, set $K = \omega^2/c_1^2 + \delta K$ in (33). To first order in $\varepsilon$,

$$c_1^2 K = \omega^2\left[1 + \varepsilon\,\frac{-1+\mathrm{i}x}{1+x^2}\right] \implies v_p \simeq c_1\left[1 + \frac{\varepsilon}{2(1+x^2)}\right], \qquad Q^{-1} \equiv \frac{2\,\mathrm{Im}\,k}{\mathrm{Re}\,k} \simeq \varepsilon\,\frac{x}{1+x^2}. \tag{34}$$

The phase speed interpolates between the adiabatic value $c_1(1+\varepsilon/2) \simeq c_1\sqrt{1+\varepsilon}$ at low frequency and the isothermal speed $c_1$ at high frequency, and the inverse quality factor $Q^{-1}$ takes the Debye form, with a maximum $\varepsilon/2$ at $\omega = \omega_*$. In the language of anelasticity the relaxation strength is $\varepsilon$ and the relaxation time is $1/\omega_*$. This is Zener's thermoelastic relaxation [24], derived here for a plane compressional wave rather than for a vibrating reed. The limits run in the opposite order to what one may first expect: the classical theory is *adiabatic* at low frequency and *isothermal* at high frequency, because conduction over a wavelength is efficient when the wavelength is short ($\alpha k^2 \gg \omega$) and negligible when it is long. The Debye form (34) was confirmed against the exact roots of (33): for $\varepsilon = 10^{-3}$ the exact value of $Q^{-1}/\varepsilon$ at $\omega = \omega_*$ is 0.49999984 against the predicted 0.5 (Zener-damping figure).

### 4.1.4 Thermoelastic damping

Figure 8(a) compares the exact classical $Q^{-1}$ with the Debye form for two couplings. The weak-coupling formula is accurate to within a few percent already at $\varepsilon = 0.02$, and to leading order the curve shape does not depend on $\varepsilon$. Panel (b) shows the effect of the heat-flux law at the larger coupling $\varepsilon = 0.1$. All three models share the low-frequency rise $Q^{-1} \propto \omega$ and the maximum near $\omega_*$. The generalized laws raise the maximum and lift the high-frequency tail, by a factor that depends on $\omega\tau_q$ only once that product approaches order one. The relevant parameter is $\omega_*\tau_q$. For the metals of Table 3, $\omega_* \sim 10^{11}$–$10^{12}$ rad/s, so a lag time of order a picosecond puts the product near order one at the *bulk* damping peak, and the heat law then matters; that peak

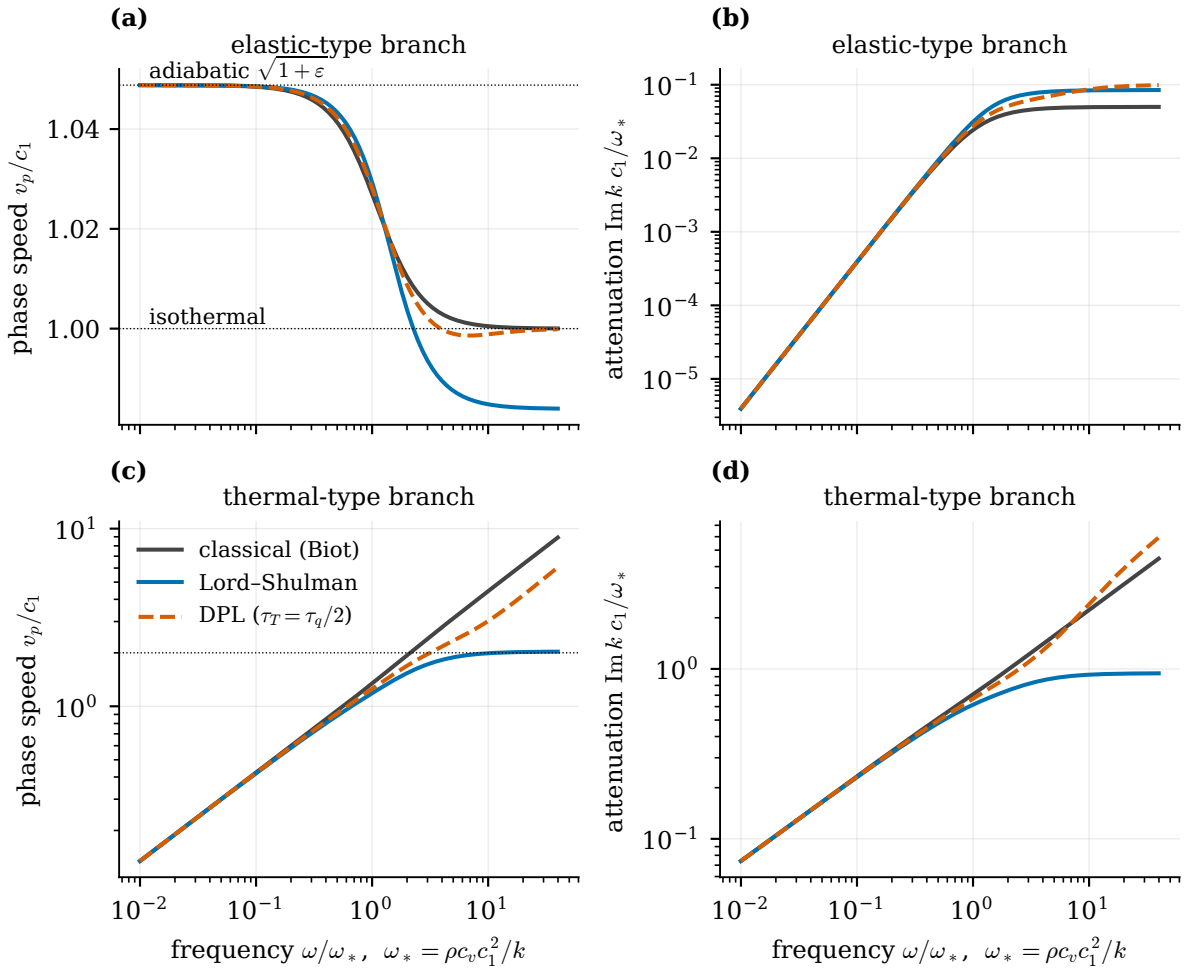



**Figure 7:** Phase speed (left) and attenuation (right) of the elastic-type (top) and thermal-type (bottom) branches for the classical, Lord–Shulman and dual-phase-lag models. Parameters: $\varepsilon = 0.1$ (larger than for metals so that dispersion is visible), $\tau_0 = \tau_q = 0.25/\omega_*$ giving $c_T = 2c_1$, and $\tau_T = \tau_q/2$ for DPL (a stable choice for the first-order model, see Section 4.3). Dotted lines: isothermal speed $c_1$, adiabatic speed $c_1\sqrt{1+\varepsilon}$, thermal speed $c_T$. Branches are followed by continuity in frequency.

lies at tens of gigahertz and is reached only in very high-frequency experiments. In micro- and nano-resonators the relevant relaxation frequency is set by the structure size rather than by $\omega_*$ (see below) and lies far below $1/\tau_q$, where Zener's classical formula suffices; lagged corrections matter instead for ultra-high-frequency nanostructures (Section 9.1).

**Relation to flexural damping.** In a thin beam of thickness $h$ vibrating in flexure the temperature varies across the thickness with a thermal relaxation time $\tau_Z \simeq h^2/(\pi^2\alpha)$ (Zener), and the damping has the same Debye form with $\omega_*$ replaced by $1/\tau_Z$ and the relaxation strength $\Delta = E\alpha_T^2 T_0/(\rho c)$, with Young's modulus $E$ [24]. Lifshitz and Roukes [143] derived the corresponding exact expression for beams and discussed its use for micro- and nano-mechanical resonators. For a silicon beam one micrometre thick, $\alpha \approx 9\times10^{-5}\,\mathrm{m}^2/\mathrm{s}$ gives a relaxation frequency of order $10^8$ Hz, inside the range of present-day resonators. Generalized and nonlocal corrections to this classical result have been studied for nanoplates, with nonlocal elasticity and dual-phase-lag conduction [121], and for plate resonators [122].

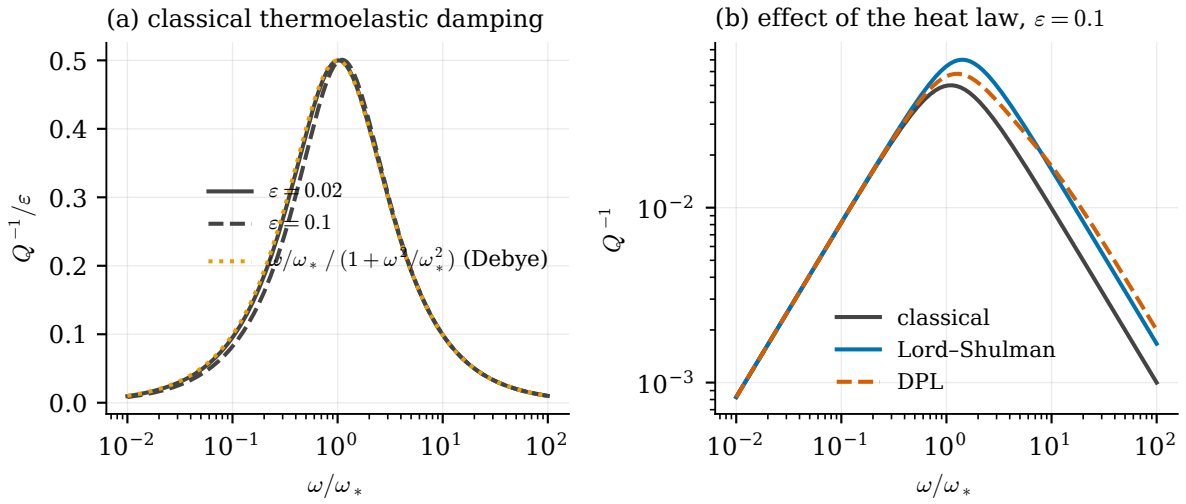



**Figure 8:** Thermoelastic damping of the elastic-type branch, $Q^{-1} = 2\,\mathrm{Im}\,k/\mathrm{Re}\,k$ against frequency. (a) Classical theory for two couplings ($\varepsilon = 0.02$ and $0.1$), normalised by $\varepsilon$, compared with the weak-coupling Debye form (34). (b) Effect of the heat law at $\varepsilon = 0.1$, with $\tau_q = 0.25/\omega_*$ and DPL $\tau_T = \tau_q/2$.

### 4.1.5 Anisotropy and other classical extensions

In anisotropic media the field equations keep their form with $C_{ijkl}$, $\beta_{ij}$ and $k_{ij}$; Dhaliwal and Sherief extended the generalized theory to anisotropic media [144]. The coupled problem no longer separates into shear and dilatational parts, but quasi-longitudinal, quasi-shear and thermal branches exist, and along symmetric directions the one-dimensional analysis above applies with the appropriate effective moduli. For orthotropic, transversely isotropic and piezoelectric crystals the Stroh formalism [145, 146] gives a systematic route to surface waves.

### 4.1.6 What the classical theory cannot describe

Three predictions of the classical theory conflict with finite-speed heat transport: the instantaneous thermal signal, the unbounded thermal phase speed (Figure 7c, black curve), and the monotonic growth of thermal attenuation with frequency. How much these matter depends on the time scale $\tau_q$ of the heat carriers and on the dimension of the structure; Section 10.1 gives the criteria.

**Summary**

Classical coupled thermoelasticity links mechanics and heat through the shared coefficient $\beta$ in (29)–(30). Shear waves are unaffected; only dilatational motion couples to temperature. The theory is parabolic: infinite thermal signal speed, diffusive thermal branch. Thermoelastic damping follows Zener's Debye form with peak $\varepsilon/2$ at $\omega = \omega_*$, adiabatic at low frequency and isothermal at high frequency.

## 4.2 Hyperbolic theories: LS, GL and GN

### 4.2.1 A common dispersion equation

For plane longitudinal motion the three classical generalized theories fit into one equation. Let $\tau_0$ denote the flux relaxation time (Lord–Shulman) or the thermal relaxation time (Green–Lindsay, in the notation of the later literature), and let $\tau^\dagger$ be the lag that multiplies the thermal-stress and dilatation coupling. Eliminating $\hat{u}$ and $\hat{\theta}$ gives

$$\left(\rho c_1^2 K + \rho s^2\right)\Big(s\rho c\,(1+\tau_0 s) + kK\Big) + \beta^2 T_0\, s K\,(1+\tau^\dagger s) = 0, \tag{35}$$

with $\tau^\dagger = 0$ and $\tau_0 = 0$ for the classical theory, $\tau^\dagger = \tau_0$ for Lord–Shulman (this is (33) multiplied by $1+\tau_0 s$), and $\tau^\dagger = \tau_1$, the second relaxation time, for Green–Lindsay. The unified form of Dhaliwal and Sherief [144] makes the same point at the level of the field equations: the theories differ in which of the two coupling terms carries a time-derivative correction.

### 4.2.2 Lord–Shulman theory

The Lord–Shulman (LS) theory joins Cattaneo's law (11) to the energy balance (9). Eliminating the flux gives the temperature equation

$$k\nabla^2\theta = (1+\tau_0\partial_t)\big(\rho c\,\dot{\theta} + T_0\beta\,\dot{\varepsilon}_{kk}\big) - (1+\tau_0\partial_t)\rho r, \tag{36}$$

so the lagged derivative acts on *both* the heat-capacity term and the dilatation-coupling term. The second of these is a modelling consequence of applying the Cattaneo law to the total heat flux, and it produces the difference from the Green–Lindsay equations.

**Wave fronts.** Take $\omega \to \infty$ in (35). The leading terms in $s$ give, with $c_T^2 = k/(\rho c\tau_0)$ and $\varepsilon = \beta^2 T_0/(\rho^2 c c_1^2)$,

$$c_{\mathrm{f}}^4 - c_{\mathrm{f}}^2\big[c_1^2(1+\varepsilon\,\tau^\dagger/\tau_0) + c_T^2\big] + c_1^2 c_T^2 = 0, \tag{37}$$

whose two roots $c_{\mathrm{f}}$ are the speeds of the two wave fronts, one elastic-type and one thermal-type, with $v_{\mathrm{e}} < v_{\mathrm{t}}$ when $c_T > c_1$ (the labels exchange for $c_T < c_1$). For LS, $\tau^\dagger = \tau_0$ and the equation is the standard high-frequency front equation of the theory; for GL it is (37) with the factor $\tau_1/\tau_0$. The front equation (37) was verified numerically against the roots of (35) at $\omega/\omega_* = 2\times 10^3$ for both theories (front-speed check). With $\varepsilon = 0.1$ and $\tau_0 = 0.25/\omega_*$ ($c_T = 2c_1$) the LS fronts are $0.9839\,c_1$ and $2.0327\,c_1$, and with $\tau_1 = 0.5/\omega_*$ (admissible, since $\tau_1 \geq \tau_0$, and giving $\tau_1/\tau_0 = 2$) the GL fronts are $0.9689\,c_1$ and $2.0643\,c_1$, in agreement with (37) to four digits. Two features deserve recording.

1. The elastic front speed is *not* the isothermal speed $c_1$, nor the adiabatic speed. Interaction with the thermal front displaces it, and the two speeds repel one another: their product is $c_1 c_T$ and the sum of their squares is $c_1^2(1+\varepsilon)+c_T^2$. When $c_T = c_1$ the degeneracy is lifted by an amount proportional to $\sqrt{\varepsilon}$, $v^2 = c_1^2[2+\varepsilon \pm \sqrt{\varepsilon(4+\varepsilon)}]/2 \approx c_1^2(1\pm\sqrt{\varepsilon})$.
2. The leading front speeds depend only on the high-frequency terms, so they are independent of $k$ except through $c_T$.

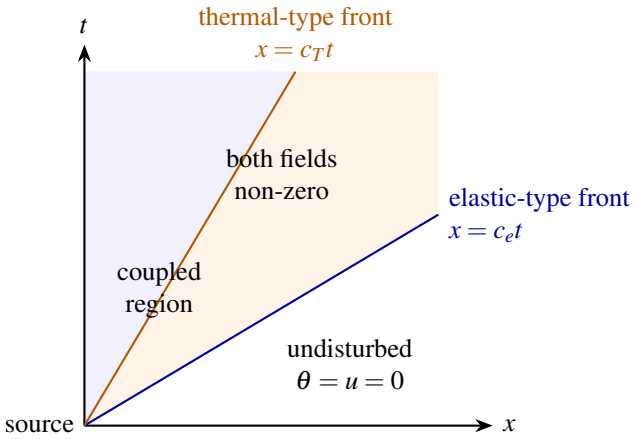



**Figure 9:** Original schematic; the setting follows [32]: two wave fronts in hyperbolic thermoelasticity – elastic-type and thermal-type fronts repel in speed; the thermal front carries a damped tail.

**Discontinuities and well-posedness.** The system is hyperbolic, so initial data with a jump produce solutions whose jumps travel along the fronts and decay exponentially along the propagation path; the heat-pulse problem of Section 6.4 shows this. The system is well posed for $\tau_0 > 0$, and energy decays in bounded bodies under standard boundary conditions by the energy identity (16). Existence of generalized solutions was established for one relaxation time by [147] and for two by [148], and domain-of-influence results appear in [149]. The thermodynamic foundation via the Clausius–Duhem inequality is due to [150].

**Interpretation.** Two modelling questions matter: the physical size of $\tau_0$, and whether Cattaneo's law with a single exponential relaxation describes the frequency range of interest. Joseph and Preziosi [34, 35] review the evidence for and against. Large relaxation times have been reported for nonhomogeneous materials [151, 152], though the interpretation of such measurements is debated. For solids the strongest evidence of wave-like heat propagation remains second sound at cryogenic temperatures [27, 28], where the governing regime is the Guyer–Krumhansl hydrodynamic one [30] rather than the simple Cattaneo law.

### 4.2.3 Green–Lindsay theory

The Green–Lindsay (GL) theory [33] has the constitutive relations

$$\sigma_{ij} = C_{ijkl}\varepsilon_{kl} - \beta_{ij}\big(\theta + \tau_1\dot{\theta}\big), \qquad k\theta_{,ii} = \rho c\big(\dot{\theta} + \tau_0\ddot{\theta}\big) + T_0\beta_{ij}\dot{\varepsilon}_{ij}, \tag{38}$$

with $\tau_1 \geq \tau_0 > 0$. In the notation of Green and Lindsay [33], $\tau_1$ is the coefficient $\alpha$ of $\dot{\theta}$ in the stress relation and $\tau_0 = h/d$ is the ratio of the coefficients of $\ddot{\theta}$ and $\dot{\theta}$ in the energy equation, and their restrictions $d\alpha - h \geq 0$, $h > 0$ (Eqs. (4.14) and (4.16) of that paper) give the ordering stated. Heat conduction is Fourier's here, so the theory does not fit the flux template (14): the finite thermal speed comes from the inertia term $\tau_0\ddot{\theta}$ instead. Substitution in plane waves gives (35) with $\tau^{\dagger} = \tau_1$. Three differences from LS matter. First, the thermal equation is not of Cattaneo type, so its relation to kinetic arguments is less direct. Second, the entropy depends on the temperature rate, which puts a thermal-displacement-like quantity into the constitutive structure and makes care necessary in reading $\tau_0$ and $\tau_1$ as independent material constants. Third, solutions of the original theory can contain discontinuities that some authors consider

unphysical, and a modification with a strain-rate term was proposed to remove them [138]. Wave fronts follow (37) with $\tau^\dagger = \tau_1$, and one consequence distinguishes GL from LS: at the wave fronts the coupling is stronger than in LS by the factor $\tau_1/\tau_0 \geq 1$, because the temperature-rate term in the stress carries $\tau_1$ while the thermal inertia carries $\tau_0$ and the strain-rate coupling in the energy equation carries no relaxation time.

### 4.2.4 Green–Naghdi types I, II and III

The Green–Naghdi (GN) theories [36–38] postulate an entropy balance with the thermal displacement $v$ ($\dot{v} = \theta$) as a primary field. In the template the three types are

$$\text{I: } q_i = -k\theta_{,i}; \qquad \text{II: } q_i = -k^* v_{,i}; \qquad \text{III: } q_i = -k\theta_{,i} - k^* v_{,i}, \tag{39}$$

with $G = k$, $k^*/s$ and $k + k^*/s$, respectively. Their uncoupled thermal equations are, with $\rho c = 1$ for brevity,

$$\text{II: } \ddot{\theta} = c_*^2 \nabla^2 \theta, \quad c_*^2 = k^*/\rho c; \qquad \text{III: } \ddot{\theta} = c_*^2 \nabla^2 \theta + \alpha \nabla^2 \dot{\theta}. \tag{40}$$

**Type II.** Thermal disturbances propagate as undamped waves of speed $c_*$, and with coupling the two fronts satisfy (37) with $c_T \to c_*$ and $\tau^\dagger/\tau_0 \to 1$. Here the relation is *exact at every frequency*, not merely asymptotically: the roots of the quadratic (33) with $G = k^*/s$ are non-dispersive, with $v^4 - v^2[c_1^2(1+\varepsilon) + c_*^2] + c_1^2 c_*^2 = 0$ at every $\omega$. This was confirmed numerically for $\varepsilon = 0.1$ and $c_* = c_1$: the exact speeds $0.854309 c_1$ and $1.170537 c_1$ are the same at $\omega/\omega_* = 0.5$, 2 and 10, and agree with the formula. The theory conserves energy, so there is no thermoelastic damping at all; it is the only member of the family with that property and therefore the benchmark for energy-based checks.

**Type III.** The type III equation is a damped wave equation with a Kelvin–Voigt-type damping term $\alpha \nabla^2 \dot{\theta}$. Two consequences deserve emphasis. At *low* frequency $G \simeq k^*/s$ and the thermal branch has the type-II speed $c_*$; at *high* frequency $G \to k$ and the branch becomes diffusive, so its phase speed is unbounded (Figure 11, magenta curve), exactly as in the classical theory. Type III is thus wave-like at low frequencies and diffusive at high frequencies, in contrast to LS, and its thermal signals have no finite propagation speed in the strict sense, since the strongly damped wave equation has a parabolic smoothing effect. In practice type III describes weakly damped thermal waves at moderate frequencies; it is not an "improved Cattaneo law". Statements in the literature that type III has a finite thermal wave speed should be read as referring to the undamped limit.

**Uniqueness and stability.** Chandrasekharaiah proved uniqueness for type II [39], complete solutions for type II were given by [153], and the theory without energy dissipation for anisotropic and micropolar media was developed in [154–157]. Stability and decay results for type III belong to the mathematical theory of thermoelasticity [158]. Type II has drawn attention as a conservative reference model, and combined with nonlocal elasticity it has been analysed for wave dispersion [80].

### 4.2.5 What each attribution was checked against

An attribution is a claim about a source, and it can be checked or merely repeated. The table below records, for the attributions in this paper that were checked at page level, what the check consisted of and, just as important, what it does not cover. Statements absent from the table were not checked at page level and are presented as reproduced, which is the weaker claim.

**Table 6:** Page-level provenance for attributions made in this paper. 'Covers' names the statement the check supports; 'does not cover' names the part of the paper that the check leaves standing on the secondary literature.

| Statement | Checked against | Covers / does not cover |
|---|---|---|
| Biot heat-conduction equation, (9) | Biot (1956), printed p. 242, Eqs. (3.3)–(3.4) | Covers the linear isotropic Fourier form with constant coefficients in a source-free body. Does not cover coupled boundary-value solutions, anisotropy, or temperature-dependent properties. |
| Green–Lindsay stress and entropy, (38) | Green and Lindsay (1972), primary text | Covers the temperature-rate dependent stress and entropy, the absence of a relaxation term on the strain-rate coupling, and the ordering of the two lags. Does not cover the existence theory of the initial-boundary-value problem. |
| Green–Naghdi type II, in Section 4.2 | Green and Naghdi (1993), Eq. (3.16) integrated once | Covers the source-free form with a zero integration constant. Does not cover type III, nor the entropy flux component relation, which is left open in the register. |
| Three-phase-lag law, (45) | Roy Choudhuri (2007), Eqs. (3)–(4) | Covers the first-order three-lag statement with its thermal-displacement-gradient term. Does not cover second-order truncations. |
| DPL stability ordering $\tau_T > \tau_q/2$ | Quintanilla (2003) | Covers a spectral (eigenvalue) stability statement for the linearized problem. Does *not* rest on an energy functional, and says nothing about the nonlinear or finite-amplitude case. |
| Thermoelastic damping of the reed | Zener (1937) | Covers the attribution of the damping mechanism to Zener's reed calculation. Does not cover the plate and flexural extensions derived in Appendix B, which are re-derived here. |
| Second stiffness value in the piezothermoelastic bar example | The material data as stated with the example | The value is *not* quoted from the earlier piezoelectric literature; the example states its own data, and the register marks the constitutive relation (74) UNVERIFIED. |

The last two rows show a deliberate pattern. Where a number could be borrowed from a source whose equation was not checked, the number is either generated from stated data or omitted. A borrowed number with an unchecked equation behind it is the commonest way a review propagates an error it did not commit.

**Summary**

For linear homogeneous media, LS, GL and GN are covered by the one dispersion equation (35); they differ in which coupling term carries a time-derivative correction. LS has finite thermal speed $c_T$ from flux relaxation; GL has it from thermal inertia $\tau_0\ddot{\theta}$; GN-II is non-dispersive and energy-conserving; GN-III is wave-like at low frequency but diffusive at high frequency and has no finite front speed in the strict sense. Front speeds obey (37) and repel when $c_T \approx c_1$.

## 4.3 Lagging and third-order models: DPL, TPL and MGT

### 4.3.1 The lag idea and its Taylor truncations

The dual-phase-lag (DPL) model [40, 41] states that the temperature gradient at time $t+\tau_T$ drives the heat flux at time $t+\tau_q$:

$$q_i(\boldsymbol{x}, t+\tau_q) = -k\,\theta_{,i}(\boldsymbol{x}, t+\tau_T). \tag{41}$$

A differential equation needs a Taylor expansion of both sides, and the truncation order is a modelling decision rather than a detail. Three variants are in use:

$$\text{(i) first order in both:} \quad q_i + \tau_q \dot{q}_i = -k\big(\theta_{,i} + \tau_T \dot{\theta}_{,i}\big), \tag{42}$$

$$\text{(ii) second order in } \tau_q\text{, first in } \tau_T: \quad q_i + \tau_q \dot{q}_i + \tfrac{1}{2}\tau_q^2 \ddot{q}_i = -k\big(\theta_{,i} + \tau_T \dot{\theta}_{,i}\big), \tag{43}$$

$$\text{(iii) second order in both:} \quad q_i + \tau_q \dot{q}_i + \tfrac{1}{2}\tau_q^2 \ddot{q}_i = -k\big(\theta_{,i} + \tau_T \dot{\theta}_{,i} + \tfrac{1}{2}\tau_T^2 \ddot{\theta}_{,i}\big). \tag{44}$$

Version (i) is the member of the template of Section 3.2.4. Versions (ii) and (iii) have higher-order $G(s)$: for (ii), $G(s) = k(1+\tau_T s)/(1+\tau_q s + \tau_q^2 s^2/2)$.

**Why the truncation order matters for stability.** Quintanilla [43] derived the condition $\tau_T > \tau_q/2$ (exponential stability, with instability for $\tau_T < \tau_q/2$) by a spectral argument, for the version in which the flux is expanded to second order in $\tau_q$ and the gradient to first order in $\tau_T$, that is, variant (ii); the exponential rate itself rests on the semigroup established in the companion heat-conduction paper [159]. The threshold is $\tau_q/2$ only for this variant: with first-order expansions in both lags the relevant threshold is $\tau_T = \tau_q$, where the equation changes type [10, 160], and with second-order expansions in both it becomes $\tau_T = (2-\sqrt{3})\,\tau_q$ [161]. The literature often quotes it as *the* stability condition of DPL thermoelasticity. Related stability results for the same model appear in [159, 161, 162], and [163] discusses unphysical effects of the model. The claim was checked by computing, for the coupled one-dimensional problem with real wavenumber, the largest real part of the temporal roots $s$ of the characteristic polynomial, and maximising it over $k$. For the first-order version (i) the largest growth rate is negative for every $\tau_T > 0$ tested ($\tau_T/\tau_q$ from 0.05 to 1.2, wavenumbers up to $10^3 c_1^{-1}\tau_q^{-1}$, $\varepsilon = 0.1$); for the second-order version (ii) it is positive when $\tau_T < \tau_q/2$, vanishes at $\tau_T = \tau_q/2$ and is negative above (Figure 10; stability figure). The high-wavenumber growth rate saturates, at $\tau_q \operatorname{Re} s = 0.571$ for $\tau_T/\tau_q = 0.3$

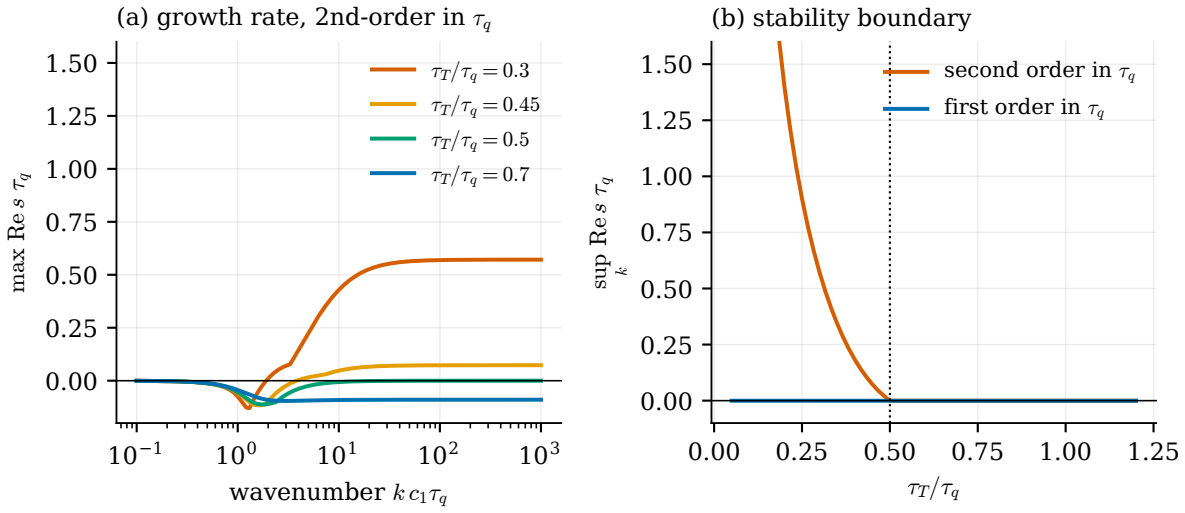



**Figure 10:** Temporal growth rate of the coupled one-dimensional DPL problem ($\varepsilon = 0.1$, $\tau_q = 1$ in units where $c_1 = \omega_* = 1$). (a) Maximum real part of the temporal roots against wavenumber for the second-order-in-$\tau_q$ truncation (43): for $\tau_T/\tau_q < 1/2$ the growth rate tends to a positive constant at large $k$; for $\tau_T/\tau_q \geq 1/2$ it is non-positive. (b) The supremum over $k$ against $\tau_T/\tau_q$ for the two truncations; the first-order version (42) (blue) has no instability.

for instance, so the instability is a *mode-independent exponential growth at short wavelengths*: an ill-posedness of the model, not a slow instability of a few modes.

The consequence for the literature is practical. A paper that uses the first-order version and states that it "imposes" $\tau_T \geq \tau_q/2$ for stability is applying a condition that belongs to another model. A paper that uses the second-order version with $\tau_T < \tau_q/2$ is computing solutions of an ill-posed problem, and its numerical results are dominated by the growing high-wavenumber modes. Thermodynamic and continuous-dependence analyses of the time-differential lag models [44, 45] and modal comparisons with the Fourier and Cattaneo laws [46] approach the same issue from a different angle. Tzou's own derivation of the model uses the first-order expansion [160], and for it the time-differential law is hyperbolic when $\tau_q > \tau_T$ and elliptic when $\tau_q < \tau_T$ [10]; this is a statement about the type of the equation, not about stability. First-order truncation is valid only when $\tau_q$ and $\tau_T$ are small compared with the time scale of the phenomenon ($\omega\tau \ll 1$), a condition not met in the frequency range where the lag models are claimed to differ from Fourier's law; Section 10.1 returns to this.

### 4.3.2 Dispersion and the shape of the lag response

For version (i), $G(s) = k(1 + \tau_T s)/(1 + \tau_q s)$ has two limits, $G(0) = k$ and $G(\infty) = k\tau_T/\tau_q$. The thermal branch is therefore diffusive at both ends, with effective diffusivities $\alpha$ at low and $\alpha\tau_T/\tau_q$ at high frequency, and wave-like only at intermediate frequency when $\tau_T < \tau_q$ (Figure 11). The familiar statement that "$\tau_T < \tau_q$ means wave-like conduction and $\tau_T > \tau_q$ means diffusive conduction" is correct only in the sense of that intermediate regime. When $\tau_T = \tau_q$, $G(s) \equiv k$ and DPL collapses to Fourier's law, whatever the common value of the lags. When $\tau_T > \tau_q$ the effective conductivity increases with frequency.

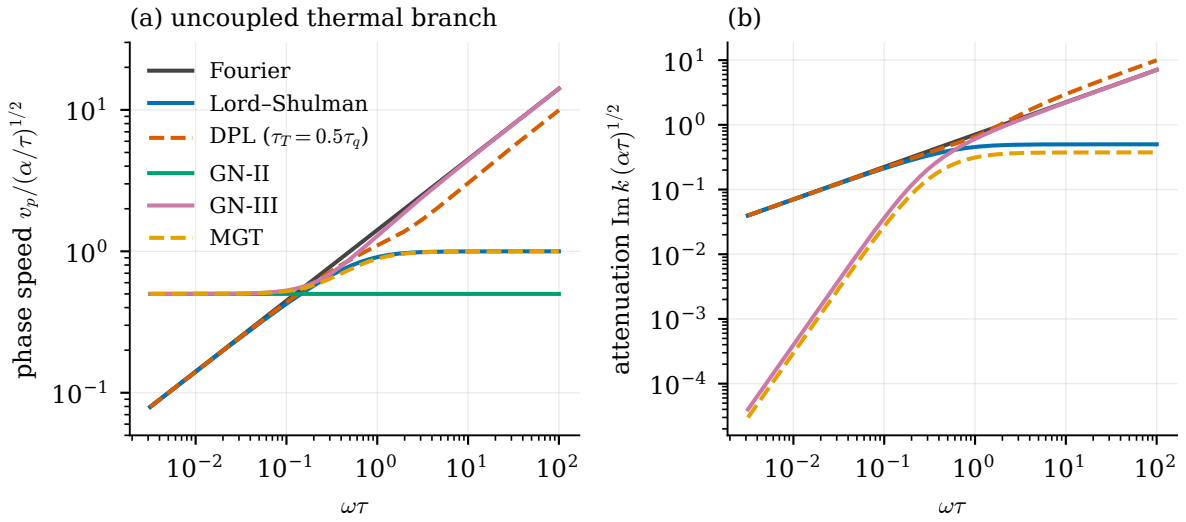



**Figure 11:** Uncoupled thermal branch for the models of the template with $\rho c = 1$, $k = 1$, $\tau = 1$ (and $k^* = 0.25$ where relevant): (a) phase speed, (b) attenuation. Fourier and GN-III become diffusive at high frequency (unbounded speed); LS saturates at $c_T$; DPL is diffusive at both ends; MGT is wave-like at both ends, with speed $c_* = \sqrt{k^*/\rho c}$ at low frequency and $c_T = \sqrt{k/\rho c\tau}$ at high frequency; GN-II is non-dispersive.

### 4.3.3 Three-phase-lag model

The three-phase-lag (TPL) model of Roy Choudhuri [42] adds a thermal-displacement term to the DPL law,

$$q_i + \tau_q \dot{q}_i = -\left[k\left(\theta_{,i} + \tau_T \dot{\theta}_{,i}\right) + k^*\left(v_{,i} + \tau_v \dot{v}_{,i}\right)\right], \qquad \dot{v} = \theta, \tag{45}$$

which is the template itself. Applications often truncate the lag equations to higher order, introducing more constants [118, 119]. Because TPL contains GN-III as the special case $\tau_q = \tau_T = \tau_v = 0$, it inherits the type-III behaviour at low frequency ($G \sim k^*/s$) unless $k^* = 0$. For $\tau_q > 0$ and $\tau_T > 0$, $G(\infty) = k\tau_T/\tau_q$, so the high-frequency limit is diffusive as in DPL. Thermodynamic compatibility and continuous dependence of the TPL model are studied in [44]. For plane waves, the nonlocal TPL dispersion was studied in [79], combinations with memory-dependent derivatives in [110–112], and combinations with magnetic fields and nonlocal elasticity in [115].

End effects of three-phase-lag heat conduction were studied by [164], with stability conditions in [165], and a well-posed formulation of the three-dual-phase-lag heat conduction equation appears in [166]. [167] analysed dual-phase-lag conduction and ignition of a solid, and [168] gave analytical solutions for nonhomogeneous DPL problems.

### 4.3.4 Moore–Gibson–Thompson thermoelasticity

The Moore–Gibson–Thompson (MGT) equation is a third-order-in-time linear model from the acoustics of relaxing gases [66]. It has been studied as an abstract evolution equation with memory and in the critical regime [67–70]. Quintanilla [71] introduced a thermoelastic theory with the flux law

$$\tau \dot{q}_i + q_i = -k\theta_{,i} - k^* v_{,i}, \tag{46}$$

**Table 7:** Properties of the uncoupled thermal branch in the template models (verified from $G(s)$ and by the scripts listed in Appendix D).

| Model | Low-$\omega$ thermal speed | High-$\omega$ thermal speed | Finite signal speed | Dissipative |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Classical | $\propto \sqrt{\omega}$ | $\propto \sqrt{\omega}$ | no | yes |
| Lord–Shulman | $\propto \sqrt{\omega}$ | $\to c_T$ | yes | yes |
| DPL (1st order) | $\propto \sqrt{\omega}$ | $\propto \sqrt{\omega}$ $(\alpha\tau_T/\tau_q)$ | no (strict) | yes |
| GN II | $c_*$ | $c_*$ | yes | no |
| GN III | $c_*$ | $\propto \sqrt{\omega}$ | no (strict) | yes |
| TPL ($k^* \neq 0$) | $c_*$ | $\propto \sqrt{\omega}$ if $\tau_T > 0$ | no (strict) | yes |
| MGT | $c_*$ | $\to c_T$ | yes | yes |

which is the Green–Naghdi III law with a relaxation of the flux, the template with $\tau_q = \tau$, $\tau_T = \tau_v = 0$. The uncoupled thermal equation is third order in time,

$$\tau\,\dddot{\theta} + \ddot{\theta} = c_*^2\nabla^2\theta + \alpha\nabla^2\dot{\theta} \quad (\rho c = 1)\,. \tag{47}$$

Its structure explains the dispersion of Figure 11: $G(s) = (k + k^*/s)/(1+\tau s)$ gives $G \simeq k^*/s$ at low frequency (wave speed $c_*$) and $G \simeq k/(\tau s)$ at high frequency (wave speed $c_T = \sqrt{k/\rho c\tau}$). The model therefore has finite signal speed at high frequency, in contrast to GN-III, and a low-frequency regime of undamped-type thermal waves. [72] analyses the decay of radial solutions of MGT thermoelasticity. Wave-dispersion questions remain open, among them the sign conditions that guarantee decay for the full coupled system with all parameters positive and the behaviour of the thermal front at finite $\tau$; applications to piezo-semiconductors have appeared, with a fractional MGT model [84] and with fractional, nonlocal (Klein–Gordon) and three-phase-lag ingredients [85].

### 4.3.5 Hyperbolic two-temperature models

Two-temperature theories [61, 62] distinguish the conductive temperature $\varphi$ from the dynamic temperature $\theta$. In the form commonly used the two are linked by $\theta = \varphi - a\nabla^2\varphi$ with $a \geq 0$ a length-squared constant (Youssef states the difference as proportional to the heat supply), and hyperbolic versions combine this with LS or GN heat laws [63, 64] or with two relaxation times [65]. In plane waves the two temperatures differ by the factor $1 + ak^2$, so a wavenumber dependence enters the dispersion relation through $a$; in its effect on high-wavenumber behaviour it plays a role comparable to a nonlocal length scale. Stability and the characterization of plane waves in the hyperbolic two-temperature theory are in [63].

### 4.3.6 Summary of the template models

Table 7 compiles the qualitative properties verified in Sections 4.2–4.3. Table 7 is more discriminating than the common statement that "all generalized theories have finite thermal speed". A thermal front with finite speed requires $sG(s)$ to tend to a finite nonzero limit as $s \to \infty$, so that $K \simeq -s\rho c/G \propto \omega^2$. That holds for LS, MGT and GN-II, and fails for the classical law, DPL, TPL and GN-III in the first-order template.

**Summary**

DPL adds $\tau_T \dot{\theta}_{,i}$ to Fourier's law; for the first-order truncation no unstable root was found in the numerical sweep of Fig. 10 (and the uncoupled thermal mode is stable for all positive lags by (24)), and the widely quoted $\tau_T \geq \tau_q/2$ condition belongs to a specific Taylor truncation, not to the template. TPL adds $\tau_v$; $G(s) \sim k^*/s$ as $s \to 0$ for $k^* \neq 0$, so low-frequency response differs qualitatively. MGT adds $\tau_R \ddot{q}_i$ and is third order in time. Finite thermal speed requires $sG(s) \to$ finite nonzero as $s \to \infty$: holds for LS, MGT, GN-II; fails for classical, DPL, TPL, GN-III (first-order template).

## 4.4 Fidelity of Taylor-truncated lag models

Section 4.3 treats the dual-phase-lag (DPL) law through Taylor truncations of the shifted fluxes. That is a modelling choice, not an identity, and its consequences deserve a quantitative look. Here the truncations are compared with the *exact* delay law on the uncoupled thermal branch.

### 4.4.1 Setting

Take $\tau_T = 0$ in the DPL law, $q(t+\tau_q) = -k\,\theta_{,x}(t)$. In the Laplace/Fourier representation the exact delay gives $G(s) = k\,e^{-\tau_q s}$, the first-order truncation gives $G = k/(1+\tau_q s)$ (Cattaneo), and the second-order truncation gives $G = k/(1+\tau_q s+\tau_q^2 s^2/2)$. With $s = -i\omega$ the thermal branch satisfies $k_w^2 = -\rho c\, s/G(s)$, where $k_w$ is the wavenumber. All three differ only through $G$, so they coincide as $\omega\tau_q \to 0$.

### 4.4.2 Numerical comparison

Figure 12 shows phase speed and attenuation for the three laws, computed by lag-truncation figure. The relative error in $k_w$ against the exact delay is

| $\omega\tau_q$ | 0.05 | 0.1 | 0.3 | 1.0 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| first order | $6\times10^{-4}$ | $2.5\times10^{-3}$ | $2.2\times10^{-2}$ | 0.22 |
| second order | $1\times10^{-5}$ | $8\times10^{-5}$ | $2.2\times10^{-3}$ | 0.08 |

Both truncations are accurate for $\omega\tau_q \lesssim 0.3$ and lose accuracy at $\omega\tau_q \sim 1$, which is exactly where lagging effects are claimed to matter. Conclusions drawn at $\omega\tau_q \gtrsim 1$ from a truncated law therefore describe the truncated model, not the delay law.

### 4.4.3 Sign change of attenuation in the exact delay law

For the exact delay the principal root is $k_w = \sqrt{\rho c\,\omega/k}\; e^{i(\pi/4-\omega\tau_q/2)}$, so $\mathrm{Im}\,k_w < 0$ once $\omega\tau_q > \pi/2$; this was checked numerically: $\mathrm{Im}\,k_w > 0$ at $\omega\tau_q = 1$, $= 0$ at $\pi/2$, $< 0$ at 2. Choosing $\mathrm{Re}\,k_w > 0$ then gives spatial growth, and choosing decay gives a negative phase speed. The cause is that $\mathrm{Re}\,G(-\mathrm{i}\omega) = k\cos(\omega\tau_q)$ becomes negative for $\omega\tau_q > \pi/2$: the exact delay law is causal but not passive over its whole frequency range, so it is a formal comparison law and not a physically admissible reference at high frequency without a restricted band. The truncations avoid this behaviour, but only because they discard the high-frequency part of the delay, and

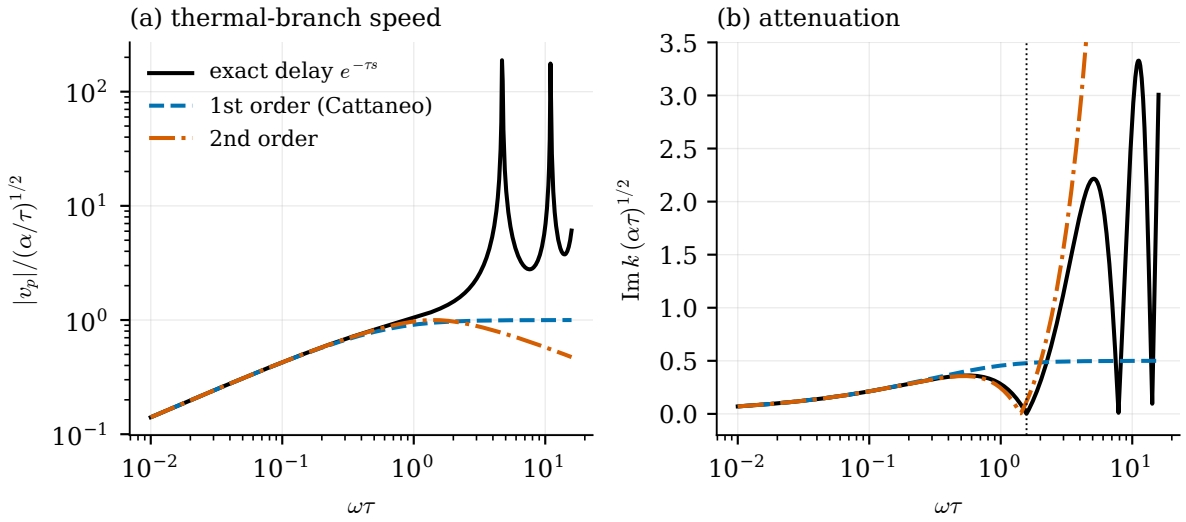



**Figure 12:** Thermal branch for the exact delay $e^{-\tau s}$, first-order and second-order truncations: (a) speed, (b) attenuation. Roots are taken with $\mathrm{Im}\,k \geq 0$, so the real part of $k$ of the delay law can be negative at higher $\omega\tau$ and the spikes of $|v_p|$ mark zeros of $\mathrm{Re}\,k$. The dotted line marks $\omega\tau = \pi/2$, where the attenuation of the principal root of the delay law changes sign.

their own admissibility must be assessed separately. Two cautions follow: be careful when a delay law is used beyond $\omega\tau_q \approx \pi/2$, and state in any application which truncation is used.

#### 4.4.4 Practical rule

(i) Report the truncation order together with $\tau_q, \tau_T$. (ii) Check $\omega\tau_q \lesssim 0.3$ before trusting a truncated law as an approximation of the delay law. (iii) Do not read agreement between two truncated laws at $\omega\tau_q \sim 1$ as confirmation of the delay model.

**Summary**

The exact delay law $\tau_q\dot{q}(t) + q(t) = -k\theta_{,i}(t - \tau_T)$ has infinitely many branches because $G(s)$ contains an exponential. Taylor truncation replaces it by a rational function with finitely many roots. Truncated and exact laws agree only for $\omega\tau_q \lesssim 0.3$; above that, spurious and missing roots make the truncation unreliable. Always report the truncation order together with the lag values.

# 5. Beyond rational heat laws: fractional, memory, size and further classes

## 5.1 Fractional and memory-dependent models

### 5.1.1 Motivation

Fractional and memory-dependent derivatives replace the local-in-time structure of Cattaneo's and Tzou's laws by an operator that weights the past, so that the response at time $t$ depends on the history of the gradient or of the flux. The literature cites three motivations: anomalous (sub- or super-diffusive) heat transport in heterogeneous and porous media, relaxation spectra that are

not single-exponential, and the wish to interpolate between diffusive and wave-like conduction with a single parameter.

### 5.1.2 Caputo-fractional heat conduction

The Caputo derivative of order $\alpha > 0$ with $m-1 < \alpha < m$, $m$ integer, is [51, 169]; at an integer order $\alpha = m$ it is defined as the ordinary derivative $f^{(m)}$, which is also the limit of the formula below

$$ {}^{C}D^{\alpha} f(t) = \frac{1}{\Gamma(m-\alpha)} \int_0^t (t-\xi)^{m-\alpha-1} f^{(m)}(\xi)\,\mathrm{d}\xi, \qquad \mathscr{L}\{{}^{C}D^{\alpha} f\} = s^{\alpha}\hat{f} - \sum_{j=0}^{m-1} s^{\alpha-1-j} f^{(j)}(0). \tag{48} $$

The Laplace rule in (48) is the reason the Caputo definition is favoured: initial conditions keep their usual physical meaning. Two families of fractional heat-conduction models are in common use.

1. *Time-fractional heat equation* [52–54]: $\rho c\, {}^{C}D^{\alpha}\theta = k\nabla^2\theta$ with $0 < \alpha \le 2$, interpolating between the diffusion equation ($\alpha = 1$) and a wave-like equation ($\alpha = 2$), with subdiffusion for $\alpha < 1$ and diffusion–wave behaviour for $1 < \alpha < 2$.
2. *Fractional Cattaneo-type law* [55, 57]; Ezzat [58] use a modified Riemann–Liouville derivative instead of the Caputo derivative written here: $q_i + \tau^{\alpha}\, {}^{C}D^{\alpha} q_i = -k\theta_{,i}$, with $G(s) = k/(1+(\tau s)^{\alpha})$ in the Laplace domain.

Variants are numerous: fractional DPL and TPL, with fractional orders on one or both sides of the lag equation. Reviews and critical discussions of the logic of fractional thermoelasticity are given in [52–54, 56, 124], and the underlying fractional calculus in [170].

**The diffusion–wave equation.** For the first family with prescribed boundary temperature $\theta_0$ on the half-line $x > 0$ and zero initial data, the Laplace-domain solution is $\hat{\theta} = (\theta_0/s)\exp(-x s^{\alpha/2}/\sqrt{a})$, $a = k/\rho c$, where $a$ is a fractional diffusivity with units $\mathrm{m}^2\,\mathrm{s}^{-\alpha}$ (equivalently $a = k/\rho c$ times a reference time to the power $\alpha - 1$), so that $k$ keeps its ordinary units only for $\alpha = 1$. For $\alpha = 1$ this inverts to $\theta_0 \operatorname{erfc}(x/2\sqrt{at})$, which was reproduced numerically with Talbot inversion to eight digits (0.4795001 at $x/\sqrt{at} = 1$). For $\alpha = 2$ it gives the step $\theta_0 H(t - x/\sqrt{a})$: a pure wave, without dispersion or damping. For $\alpha < 1$ the solution is a stretched Mittag-Leffler-type decay with heavy tails; the Mittag-Leffler functions involved are treated in 171, and see also 172. Figure 13(a) displays the family. Two cautions apply. The endpoint $\alpha = 2$ is *not* Fourier's law but an undamped wave equation, and for $1 < \alpha < 2$ the equation needs two initial conditions, one of which ($\dot{\theta}(0) = 0$) is chosen by convention.

### 5.1.3 Memory-dependent derivative

The memory-dependent derivative (MDD) of Wang and Li [59] is defined for a delay (memory) window $\tau > 0$ by

$$ D_{\tau} f(t) = \frac{1}{\tau} \int_{t-\tau}^{t} \mathscr{M}(t-\xi)\, f'(\xi)\,\mathrm{d}\xi, \qquad \mathscr{M}(u) = 1 - \frac{2b\,u}{\tau} + \frac{a\,u^2}{\tau^2}, \tag{49} $$

with $a, b$ constants. Popular choices are $a = b = 1$ ($K = (1-u/\tau)^2$), $a = 0, b = \tfrac{1}{2}$ ($K = 1 - u/\tau$) and $a = b = 0$ ($K = 1$) (Figure 13b). The operator differs from the fractional derivative in having

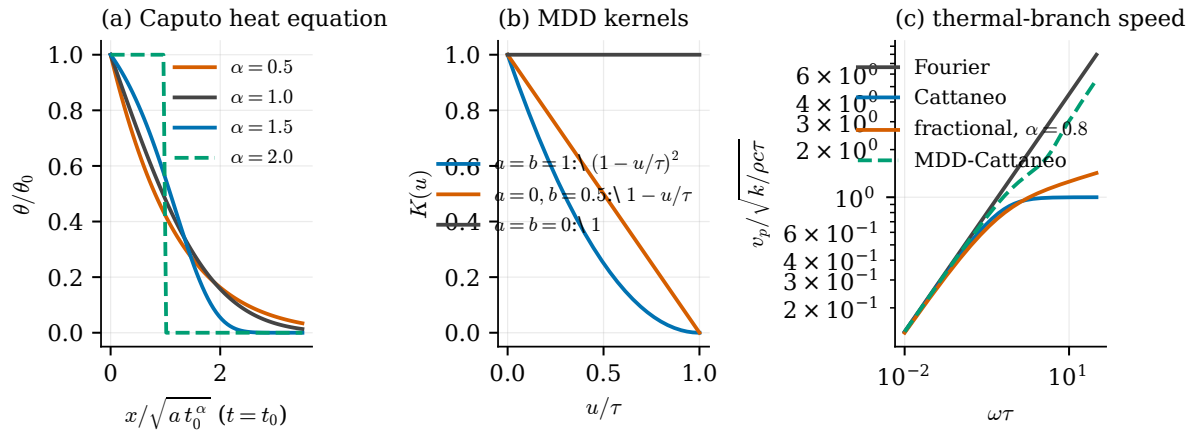



**Figure 13:** (a) Caputo time-fractional heat equation, boundary temperature step, profiles at $t = t_0$ for $\alpha = 0.5, 1, 1.5, 2$ (Talbot inversion; the case $\alpha = 2$ is the exact step front). (b) Kernels of the memory-dependent derivative (49). (c) Phase speed of the uncoupled thermal branch for Fourier, Cattaneo, fractional Cattaneo with $\alpha = 0.8$ and MDD-Cattaneo ($a = b = 1$), normalised by the Cattaneo wave speed.

a finite window, a bounded kernel, and a clear time-domain meaning as a weighted average of the rate over the last $\tau$ time units; Wang and Li's comparison with the fractional derivative [60, 123] discusses how the two relate. MDD versions of the lag models replace the first-order derivatives in (42) or (45) by $D_\tau$ [110–113, 117, 173–176], memory-dependent heat conduction in a Lord–Shulman-type formulation is treated in [177], and higher-order memory-driven heat transfer in nano-beams in [114].

**Laplace transform of the MDD.** Because $f'$ vanishes for negative arguments, (49) is a convolution of $f'$ with $\mathscr{M}(u)\mathbf{1}_{[0,\tau]}(u)/\tau$, so, with zero prehistory,

$$\mathscr{L}\{D_\tau f\} = \kappa(s)\big[s\hat{f} - f(0^+)\big] = s\,\kappa(s)\,\hat{f} \quad \text{for } f(0^+) = 0, \qquad \kappa(s) = \frac{1}{\tau}\int_0^\tau \mathscr{M}(u)\,e^{-su}\,\mathrm{d}u. \tag{50}$$

For the kernel $K = (1 - u/\tau)^2$, $\kappa(0) = \frac{1}{3}$ and $s\kappa(s) \to K(0)/\tau = 1/\tau$ as $s \to \infty$. An MDD version of Cattaneo's law, $q_i + \tau D_\tau q_i = -k\theta_{,i}$, therefore has $G(s) = k/\big(1 + \tau s\kappa(s)\big)$, which tends to $k/2$ (not to zero!) at high frequency: the thermal branch of this particular MDD-Cattaneo law becomes *diffusive* at high frequency with half the low-frequency diffusivity, in contrast to the ordinary Cattaneo law, for which $G \to 0$ and the speed saturates (Figure 13c, green dashed curve versus blue). The reason is that a bounded kernel with $K(0) = 1$ makes $\tau D_\tau$ a time-local multiple of the identity at high frequency, which acts as a constant added to the denominator rather than as a derivative. The property is model-specific: a kernel with $K(0) = 0$ would give $\tau s\kappa(s) \to 0$ and hence $G \to k$ (Fourier behaviour) at high frequency, and other MDD formulations of the lag laws behave differently. The consequence for wave fronts must therefore be checked for the variant at hand.

Memory-dependent derivative modelling was introduced by [59]. MDD-based generalized thermoelasticity was developed by [178], electro-thermoelasticity with MDD heat transfer by [179], and DPL thermoelasticity with MDD by [180]. [181] treated time-fractional radial heat conduction in a sphere, [182] presented thermoelasticity and generalized thermoelasticity as wave hierarchies, and [183] gave a theory of generalized thermoelasticity with memory-dependent derivatives. The time-fractional dual-phase-lag heat conduction equation was formulated by

[184]. Fractional order generalized thermoelasticity was developed by [185] with its variational principle in [186], and [187] introduced a fractional order theory of Cattaneo-type thermoelasticity using new fractional derivatives.

### 5.1.4 Position of these models in the template

For fractional and MDD models $G(s)$ is not rational, but the dispersion relation (33) is still quadratic in $K$ with $G(s)$ evaluated at complex $s = -\mathrm{i}\omega$ on principal branches, so the analysis of Section 4.1.3 carries over verbatim; only the closed-form front-speed analysis and the transform inversion change. Energy functionals, uniqueness and thermodynamic admissibility are less developed for these models than for the template models, and their thermodynamic admissibility has been discussed with differing conclusions. One practical concern is that the extra order or memory parameter can be tuned to fit a single dataset without independent confirmation. The reinterpretation of fractional thermoelasticity in terms of anomalous heat conduction [124] and the thermodynamic consistency analyses of time-differential lag models [44, 45] provide the context in which one should choose among them.

**Summary**

Fractional (Caputo) and memory-dependent derivative laws replace $s$ in $G(s)$ by non-integer powers or kernel transforms, so the dispersion relation stays quadratic in $K$ but roots are complex and front analysis changes. Thermodynamic admissibility, energy functionals and uniqueness are less developed than for the template models. The extra parameter can be fitted to one dataset without independent confirmation—a fitting constant is not a material property.

## 5.2 Coupled fractional dispersion

The memory models of Section 5.1 are usually analysed on the heat equation alone. Here a fractional Cattaneo law, $q + \tau^\alpha D^\alpha q = -k\,\theta_{,x}$ with a Caputo derivative $D^\alpha$ and $0 < \alpha \le 1$, is inserted into the coupled longitudinal problem of Section 4.1. In the Laplace representation $G(s) = k/[1 + (\tau s)^\alpha]$, and the polynomial of Eq. (35) is used unchanged, with the principal branch $(-i\omega)^\alpha = \omega^\alpha e^{-i\pi\alpha/2}$.

Figure 14 (coupled-fractional figure) shows phase speed and loss for the elastic-like branch, tracked by continuity in $\omega$, for $\varepsilon = 0.1$ and $\tau\omega_* = 0.25$, chosen so that the thermal front speed is twice $c_1$ and the branches do not hybridise degenerately. Four numbers can be read off:

- At low frequency all models give the adiabatic speed $c_1\sqrt{1+\varepsilon} = 1.0488\,c_1$.
- The classical Debye peak is $Q^{-1} = 0.0501 \approx \varepsilon/2$ at $\omega/\omega_* \approx 1.1$.
- The lagging and fractional models shift and raise the peak: 0.0701 at $\omega/\omega_* = 1.42$ for $\alpha = 1$, 0.0741 at 1.58 for $\alpha = 0.8$ and 0.0728 at 1.75 for $\alpha = 0.6$.
- At the top of the plotted range $v_p/c_1 = 0.984, 0.993, 0.997$ for $\alpha = 1, 0.8, 0.6$, and 1.000 for the classical model.

The message is qualitative as well as quantitative: the fractional order moves the position and height of the loss peak by amounts comparable to the Cattaneo–classical difference, so it is no small correction. These numbers belong to this parameter set; a different $\tau\omega_*$ changes them, and the figure should be reproduced for the material at hand.

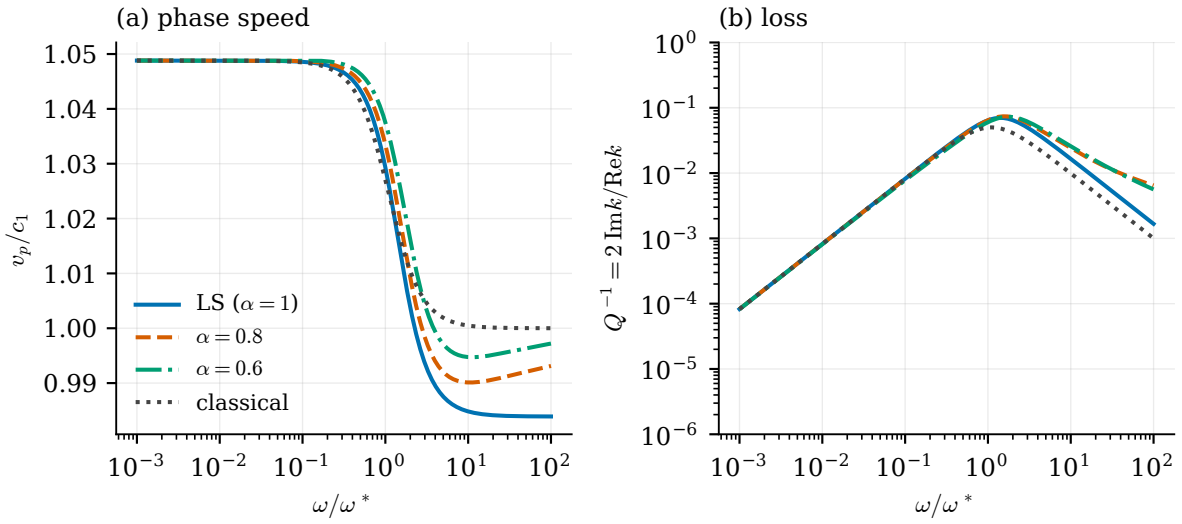



**Figure 14:** Coupled longitudinal wave with a fractional Cattaneo law: (a) phase speed, (b) loss $Q^{-1}$ for $\alpha = 1, 0.8, 0.6$ and the classical model ($\varepsilon = 0.1$, $\tau\omega_* = 0.25$).

**Summary**

For fractional Cattaneo conduction $G(s) = k/[1 + (\tau s)^\alpha]$, the dispersion polynomial (33) still applies with complex $s$. The endpoint $\alpha \to 2$ is second order in time, not Fourier's law; $\alpha = 1$ gives Cattaneo, and $\tau \to 0$ gives the classical law. Phase speed and loss interpolate between Cattaneo ($\alpha = 1$) and increasingly wave-like behaviour as $\alpha$ increases toward 2, but only the endpoint $\alpha = 1$ is Cattaneo conduction with its finite front. For $\alpha \neq 1$, $G(s) \sim k(\tau s)^{-\alpha}$ at large $s$, so $k_w \sim s^{(1+\alpha)/2}$ is not linear in $s$ and there is no sharp front in the Cattaneo sense unless a finite-speed kernel is used.

## 5.3 Size effects: nonlocal and gradient models

### 5.3.1 Why local elasticity fails at small wavelengths

Local elasticity predicts $\omega = c\,k$ at every wavelength. A crystal is a lattice: its acoustic branch bends over and reaches zero group velocity at the zone boundary. For a monatomic chain with nearest-neighbour spring constant $\kappa_s$, mass $m$ and spacing $a$, the exact relation is $\omega = 2\sqrt{\kappa_s/m}\,|\sin(ka/2)| = c_0 k\,\mathrm{sinc}(ka/2)$ with $c_0 = a\sqrt{\kappa_s/m}$ [188], which at small $k$ gives $\omega \simeq c_0 k\,[1 - (ka)^2/24]$. Nonlocal and gradient models add one length scale and so capture the leading deviation from local behaviour within continuum mechanics. Maranganti and Sharma [127] estimate the scales at which classical elasticity fails for various materials and show that size effects can generate electromechanical coupling even in non-piezoelectric solids [126]. Micropolar thermoelasticity without energy dissipation was formulated by Ciarletta [156] and Quintanilla [157]; strain gradient and higher-order nonlocal formulations appear in [189–191].

### 5.3.2 Eringen's nonlocal elasticity

In the integral model the stress at $\boldsymbol{x}$ is a weighted average of the local stress over a neighbourhood, $\sigma_{ij}(\boldsymbol{x}) = \int \alpha(|\boldsymbol{x} - \boldsymbol{x}'|)\, C_{ijkl}\varepsilon_{kl}(\boldsymbol{x}')\,\mathrm{d}V'$, with a kernel $\alpha$ normalised to unity. For the

exponential kernel in one dimension, $\alpha(|x|) = e^{-|x|/\ell}/(2\ell)$, the integral equation is equivalent to the differential equation

$$\left(1 - \xi^2 \partial_x^2\right)\sigma = \rho c_1^2 \varepsilon, \qquad \xi = \ell, \tag{51}$$

(because $\alpha$ is the Green's function of $1 - \ell^2\partial_x^2$), and in three dimensions with the Yukawa-type kernel $e^{-r/\ell}/(4\pi\ell^2 r)$ the equation $(1 - \xi^2\nabla^2)\sigma_{ij} = C_{ijkl}\varepsilon_{kl}$ [15, 16, 47]. Substituting in the momentum balance gives

$$\omega^2 = \frac{c_0^2 k^2}{1 + \xi^2 k^2}, \qquad v_g = \frac{c_0}{(1 + \xi^2 k^2)^{3/2}}, \tag{52}$$

where $\xi = e_0 a$ in Eringen's notation ($e_0$ a dimensionless material constant and $a$ an internal characteristic length). Equation (52) is the rational analogue of the lattice relation: $\omega$ is bounded by $c_0/\xi$ and the group velocity decays to zero at large $k$.

**Calibration against the lattice.** Matching (52) to the chain at the zone boundary $k = \pi/a$, where $\omega = 2c_0/a$, requires $(\xi/a)^2 = \frac{1}{4} - 1/\pi^2$, that is $\xi/a = 0.3856$, which reproduces the $e_0 \approx 0.39$ quoted by Eringen [16] and explains why that value is common. Matching the long-wavelength curvature instead requires $\xi^2 = a^2/12$ ($\xi = 0.289a$). The two calibrations differ by about a third in $\xi$ and by a factor near 1.8 in $\xi^2$, so any prediction that depends on $\xi$ depends on the calibration target (Figure 15). At the zone boundary the Eringen group velocity is $0.26c_0$, where the chain has $v_g = 0$.

### 5.3.3 Strain-gradient elasticity

Aifantis-type gradient elasticity adds the gradient of the strain [17, 49],

$$\sigma = c\,(\varepsilon - \ell^2 \varepsilon_{,xx}), \qquad \omega^2 = c_0^2 k^2 (1 + \ell^2 k^2), \qquad v_g = c_0 \frac{1 + 2\ell^2 k^2}{\sqrt{1 + \ell^2 k^2}}. \tag{53}$$

For $\ell^2 > 0$ both phase and group velocity *increase* with $k$, the opposite of lattice dispersion. The lattice curvature needs $\ell^2 = -a^2/12 < 0$, which gives $\omega^2 = c_0^2 k^2 (1 - a^2 k^2/12)$ and an instability ($\omega^2 < 0$) beyond $k = \sqrt{12}/a$. That lies outside the Brillouin zone, but it warns that the pure gradient model with the lattice sign is not well posed at high wavenumber. The dispersive-stabilised versions, with a gradient of inertia as well as of strain [18, 50], interpolate between (52) and (53): with strain-gradient length $\ell_s$ and inertia-gradient length $\ell_d$, $\omega^2 = c_0^2 k^2 (1 + \ell_s^2 k^2)/(1 + \ell_d^2 k^2)$, which remains stable and reproduces the lattice shape for $\ell_d > \ell_s$ (the Eringen form is the case $\ell_s = 0$).

### 5.3.4 Other enrichments

Couple-stress theory [192], micropolar theory [13, 73], flexoelectricity and surface elasticity add length scales through different mechanisms. The Klein–Gordon-type nonlocal elasticity [128] (a Helmholtz-type operator acting on the displacement rather than the stress) has been used with piezo-thermoelastic media [193]. Nonlocal variational principles are discussed in [194]. The physical ingredients differ, yet in plane-wave dispersion most enrichments reduce to a rational function of $k^2$ multiplying the local stiffness or the inertia; choosing among them is largely a question of which feature of the lattice or microstructure one wants to represent.

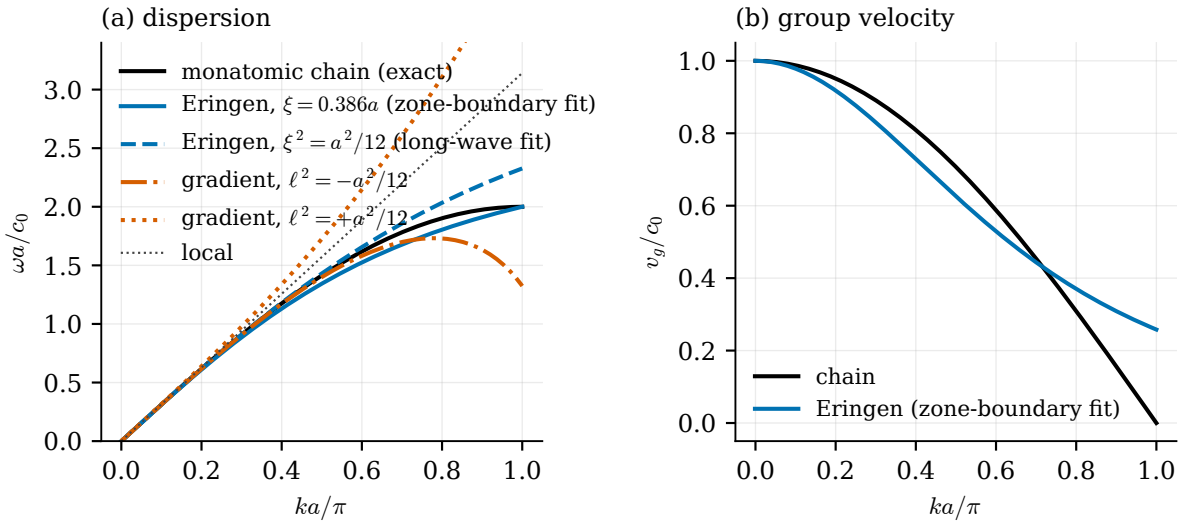



**Figure 15:** Nonlocal and gradient dispersion compared with the exact monatomic chain. (a) Dispersion: Eringen with two calibrations (zone-boundary and long-wavelength), gradient with positive and negative length-squared, and the local model. (b) Group velocity of the chain and of the Eringen model with the zone-boundary calibration.

### 5.3.5 Nonlocal thermoelasticity

Eringen [48] extended nonlocality to thermoelasticity. Two forms of the constitutive relation are in use in recent papers:

$$\text{(A)} \quad (1-\xi^2\partial_x^2)\,\sigma = \rho c_1^2\,\varepsilon - \beta\,\theta, \tag{54}$$

$$\text{(B)} \quad (1-\xi^2\partial_x^2)\,(\sigma+\beta\,\theta) = \rho c_1^2\,\varepsilon, \tag{55}$$

that is, whether the thermal stress is smoothed with the elastic stress (B) or not (A). The two forms give different dispersion polynomials: with $K = k^2$, (A) is $\left[\rho(c_1^2+\xi^2 s^2)K + \rho s^2\right](s\rho c + GK) + \beta^2 T_0 s K = 0$, and (B) adds the factor $(1+\xi^2 K)$ to the last term. Both reduce to the local relation (33) as $\xi \to 0$ and to the nonlocal elastic relation (52) as $\varepsilon \to 0$; both limits were confirmed numerically. Figure 17 compares the elastic-type branch. In the classical theory with $\varepsilon = 0.1$ and $\xi = 0.3c_1/\omega_*$ (elastic cut-off at $\omega = 3.3\omega_*$), the main effect on the phase speed is the nonlocal dispersion itself: the speed falls steadily with frequency, to about $0.3c_1$ at 95 % of the cut-off, and the two forms give almost the same speed. The damping differs: form (A) stays close to the local curve (its maximum is about 15 % larger and slightly shifted) whereas form (B), whose thermal coupling is multiplied by $1+\xi^2 K$ and thus grows with wavenumber, shows a damping that increases steeply on approaching the cut-off, reaching $Q^{-1} \approx 0.3$. The difference arises entirely from the high-wavenumber coupling. A paper reporting nonlocal thermoelastic damping or dispersion therefore has to state which form it uses; the literature on nonlocal thermoelastic waves uses various forms [79, 80, 88, 120, 125, 130, 195].

### 5.3.6 Nonlocality in the heat flux

The Guyer–Krumhansl equation [29, 30] adds spatial derivatives of the flux,

$$q_i + \tau_R \dot{q}_i = -k\theta_{,i} + \ell_{GK}^2\left(\nabla^2 q_i + 2\,q_{j,ji}\right), \tag{56}$$

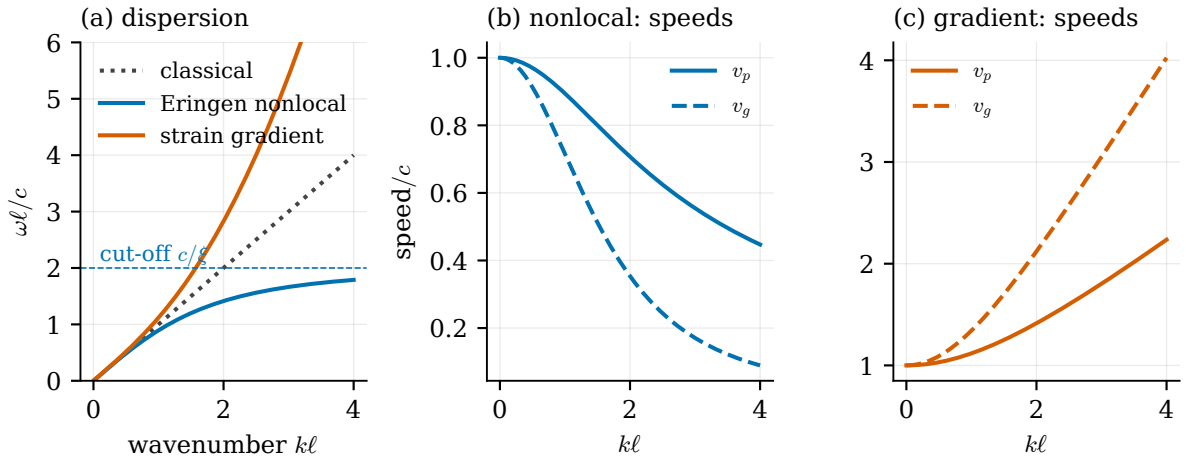



**Figure 16:** Generic size-effect dispersion for $\xi = \ell = 0.5$ in units of the characteristic length. (a) Frequency against wavenumber: the Eringen model saturates at $c_0/\xi$, the gradient model rises faster than linearly. (b,c) Phase and group speeds.

and describes heat in the hydrodynamic phonon regime, where momentum-conserving collisions dominate. In one dimension the extra term is $3\ell_{GK}^2 q_{,xx}$ and $G(s,k) = k/(1+\tau_R s + 3\ell_{GK}^2 k^2)$ depends on the wavenumber, so the dispersion polynomial is no longer quadratic in $K$ but retains its structure. For low-temperature crystals, ballistic and size-dependent conduction in nanostructures are modelled with this and related equations; the combination with elastic nonlocality remains little explored (Section 11.1).

Size-dependent effects on interaction of surface waves in micropolar thermoelastic medium with dual pore connectivity were analysed by [196]. Shock-induced nonlocal coupled thermoelasticity analysis with energy dissipation in a MEMS/NEMS beam resonator was presented by [197]. Boundary integral equations formulation for fractional order thermoelasticity was developed by [198]; harmonic plane wave propagation under fractional order thermoelasticity was analysed by [199].

### 5.3.7 Caveats

For bounded bodies the differential nonlocal model produces well-known inconsistencies, in some bending problems with particular boundary conditions for instance, which the infinite-medium plane-wave analysis above does not show. The length scales are phenomenological, and whether the calibration target is the zone boundary, another lattice feature or an experimental dispersion has a leading effect on quantitative predictions.

**Summary**

Nonlocal and gradient elasticity add one length to capture the lattice deviation from $\omega = ck$. Eringen's model saturates at $c_0/\xi$ (matching the zone boundary gives $\xi/a \approx 0.39$); gradient elasticity speeds up with $k$ unless stabilised by inertia gradients. Calibration matters: zone-boundary vs long-wavelength calibration changes $\xi$ by $\sim$30%. Nonlocal thermoelasticity has two forms (A) and (B) that differ in how the thermal stress is smoothed and give different damping near cut-off.

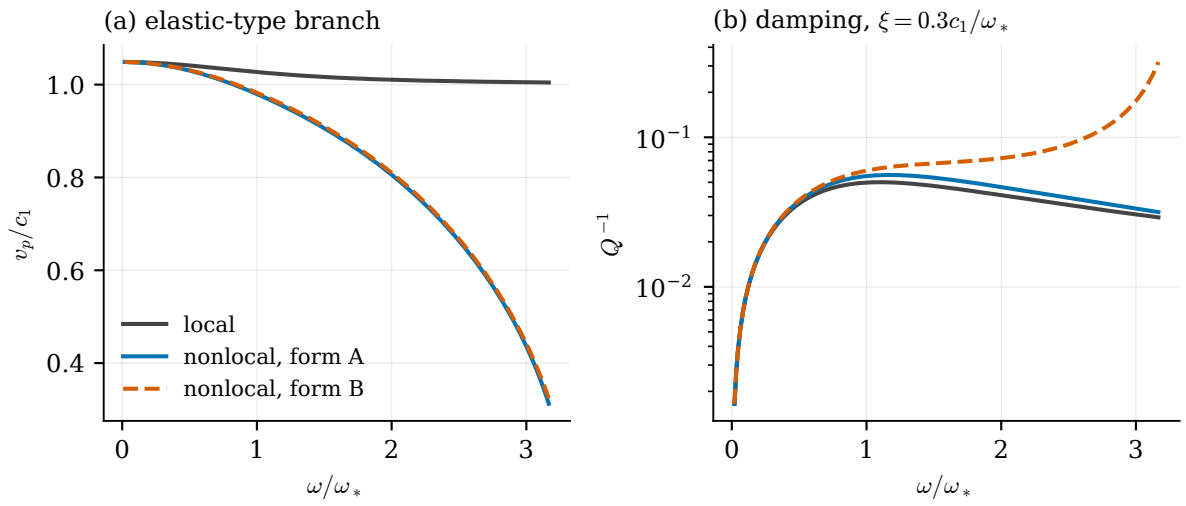



**Figure 17:** Elastic-type branch of the nonlocal classical thermoelastic problem ($\varepsilon = 0.1$, $\xi = 0.3c_1/\omega_*$, frequency up to 95% of the elastic cut-off $c_1/\xi$): phase speed (a) and damping (b) for the local model and the two nonlocal forms.

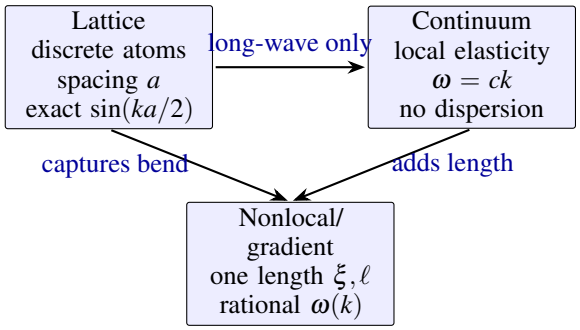



**Figure 18:** Original schematic; the setting follows [15, 188]: size effects bridge discrete lattice dispersion and local continuum via one nonlocal or gradient length.

## 5.4 Wider material classes: where the template reaches and where it stops

The preceding sections follow one construction: a heat-flux kernel $G(s)$ multiplies the Fourier flux, and an effective modulus $m(s)$ carries the elastic side. This section places the other material classes in the literature relative to that construction. It is a map, not a derivation. The references listed here were matched to bibliographic records (authors, venue, volume, pages, DOI), but their equations were not re-derived in this review; statements below describe what each work is about and make no claim about its internal results. A class is called *inside* the template if it enters through $G(s)$ or through a frequency-dependent modulus, and *outside* if it changes the elastic operator, the list of fields, or the geometry.

### 5.4.1 Couple-stress, strain-gradient and microstructured continua

Higher-grade elasticity introduces an internal length into the elastic operator. The couple-stress theory was set out by Toupin [200, 201], microstructure by Mindlin [202] and the second gradient of strain by Mindlin [203]; a multipolar formulation is due to Green and Rivlin [204]. Plasticity-oriented gradient theories [205], a couple-stress-based gradient theory [206] and mea-

surements interpreted with gradient elasticity [207] show how the same internal length is fixed in different ways in different communities. Thermal extensions include thermo-microstretch solids [208], thermoelastic damping of strain-gradient microplates [209], Lord–Shulman thermoelasticity of microstructures [210], nonlocal strain-gradient porous thermoelasticity [211], Moore–Gibson–Thompson thermoelasticity under thermal shock [212] and wave reflection at an interface with couple stress [213]. Wave problems in second-gradient media with damage [214] and in pantographic metamaterials [215] are recent examples from the mechanics side; gradient elasticity has also been used to remove dislocation singularities [216, 217].

*Status relative to the template.* The elastic energy of these theories contains strain or rotation gradients, so the modulus acquires a wavenumber dependence [200, 202, 203]; this was read in the primary papers. That the kernel $G(s)$ itself is left unmodified is a structural statement and not a result of those papers: the isothermal papers contain no temperature, while the thermal versions of couple-stress and multipolar theory [200, 204] carry their own heat equation and heat-flux law, which would have to be inserted into the kernel construction case by case. The length scale in this literature is normally fitted, and different enrichments can reproduce the same size effect; an internal length should therefore be quoted together with the experiment that fixed it, as in Section 5.3.

### 5.4.2 Phononic crystals and acoustic and thermal metamaterials

Two mechanisms are usually distinguished. Bragg scattering in periodic composites was studied through the band structure of elastic and acoustic waves [218, 219] (the latter reports gaps that are not complete and treats transverse polarization only); local resonance gives gaps at wavelengths far larger than the lattice period [220], where the negative effective modulus near the resonance is the explanation offered in that paper, and surface-wave versions have been proposed [221]. Book-length treatments are [222, 223]; the former defines the two gap mechanisms and prints a dynamic mass density for local resonance, the latter devotes a chapter to locally resonant crystals. Broad overviews are available [224–230], as are topological edge-wave designs [231]. Studies that bring temperature or damping into such structures include thermal tuning of Lamb-wave band structure [232], enlargement of a locally resonant Lamb-wave gap [233], the influence of damping on transmission loss [234] and a phononic-crystal strip for resonator quality factor [235]. Heat-flux control is treated in the thermal diode [236] and in the review of thermal metamaterials [237].

*Status relative to the template.* A locally resonant array is commonly described by a frequency-dependent effective modulus or mass (the original sonic-crystal paper [220] uses an effective modulus; a negative-density example is given in [238]), which is formally of the same kind as $m(s)$ in Section 3.5; that is the point of contact. Coupling such an $m$ to the kernel $G(s)$ would give a thermoelastic damping estimate for a resonant array, but no reference located for this review treats that combination with the band structure included, so it is recorded as an open question in Section 11.1 and is not claimed as a result.

### 5.4.3 Piezoelectric and piezoelectric-semiconductor waves

Interaction of acoustic waves with carriers in piezoelectric semiconductors was described early [239] together with ultrasonic amplification [240], and surface-wave acoustoelectric interaction followed [241]. Nanostructure applications span piezoelectric nanogenerators [242] and nanopiezotronics [243]; analyses of carrier distribution and electric potential in

piezoelectric semiconductor structures [244], flexoelectric enhancement [245] and nonlinear thermo-deformation-polarization-carrier coupling [246] are recent. Flexoelectricity itself is reviewed in [247, 248]. Photothermal and plasma-elastic-thermal wave studies in semiconductors [249–251] form a thermoelastic branch of this field; a hyperbolic two-temperature treatment of a semiconductor with a cavity is in [252], and a nonlocal Kelvin–Voigt piezo-semiconductor with a memory-dependent heat flux, in which the flux law and the carrier equation are written together, is in [253], and temperature dependence of surface-wave characteristics has been measured [254]. Quasicrystals, with phonon and phason fields, are a further extended-field class [255–258].

*Status relative to the template.* Adding a carrier density, an electric potential or a phason field enlarges the list of unknowns and hence the dispersion polynomial, so these classes lie outside the single-kernel construction. A relaxation kernel for the heat flux has been inserted in the semiconductor models cited above [252, 253]; the early carrier-coupling papers [239, 240] contain no heat equation, and the amplification criterion belongs to [240], not to [239]. No carrier equation is derived in this review.

#### 5.4.4 Graded, porous, laminated, magnetoelectric and nano materials; tissue

Porous media go back to Biot [259]; thermoelastic waves in saturated porous media [260], micro-inertia effects [261] and nonlocal micropolar thermoelasticity [262]; the linear micropolar and microstretch thermal theory, with one temperature and one heat vector, is set out in [13] extend the picture. Functionally graded materials [263] appear in thermoelastic damping of beams and sandwich structures [264, 265], thermal vibration and stability [266] and buckling of reinforced plates [267]; temperature-dependent properties are surveyed in [268]. Laminates are treated for thermoelastic damping in [269] and multifunctional composite mechanics in [270]. Magnetoelectric and multiferroic materials are reviewed in [271, 272]. Carbon nanotubes and graphene [273, 274] motivate the nano-scale beam and plate models of Section 5.3, and laser-tissue interaction models [275, 276] connect to the non-Fourier bioheat work of Section 9.1.

*Status relative to the template.* Spatial grading, porosity and lamination mostly change coefficients or add interfaces, which the layered formulation of Section 6.11 can accommodate; porous and magnetoelectric models add fields and are outside. The classification is by model structure and was not checked against each cited paper.

#### 5.4.5 Summary map

## 6. Waves in unbounded and bounded media

## 6.1 Wave propagation in three dimensions

#### 6.1.1 Plane waves in an isotropic generalized thermoelastic solid

In an unbounded isotropic solid, with any heat-flux law of the template, (31) becomes

$$\rho\ddot{\phi} = (\lambda+2\mu)\nabla^2\phi - \beta\theta, \quad s\rho c\,\hat{\theta} + T_0\beta s\nabla^2\hat{\phi} = G(s)\nabla^2\hat{\theta}, \quad \rho\ddot{\boldsymbol{\psi}} = \mu\nabla^2\boldsymbol{\psi}, \tag{57}$$

and a plane wave in direction $\boldsymbol{n}$, $\propto \exp[\mathrm{i}(k\boldsymbol{n}\cdot\boldsymbol{x} - \omega t)]$, obeys the same characteristic equation (33) for the dilatational–thermal system. The analysis of Section 4.1.3 therefore holds for propaga-

| Class | What changes | Relative to the template |
|---|---|---|
| Couple-stress, strain gradient | elastic operator, internal length | outside ($G$ unchanged, $m$ depends on $k$) |
| Dipolar, micropolar, microstretch | extra balance laws, larger elastic block | outside |
| Phononic and metamaterial | periodic structure; resonant effective mass or modulus | contact point through $m$; band structure outside |
| Piezoelectric semiconductors | carrier and potential fields | outside; heat-flux kernel can still be inserted |
| Quasicrystals | phonon and phason fields | outside |
| Graded, laminated | coefficients, interfaces | mostly inside, via the layered formulation |
| Porous, magnetoelectric | extra fields | outside |

**Table 8:** Material classes relative to the kernel construction. Entries describe model structure and are not results taken from the cited works.

tion in any direction of an isotropic body. Shear waves keep the speed $c_2$ and feel no heat-flux law, whether the model is a member of the template, fractional or memory-dependent. For general anisotropy the quasi-longitudinal, quasi-shear and thermal branches couple through $\beta_{ij}$ and $k_{ij}$, and the characteristic equation becomes a polynomial of higher degree; Dhaliwal and Sherief's formulation [144] is the standard reference, and for numerical dispersion the Stroh formalism [145, 146] is convenient.

**Counting branches.** In an isotropic medium a bulk plane-wave problem has 2 branches from the dilatational–thermal pair $+2$ shear polarisations when $G$ is rational of low degree; the polynomial in $K$ has degree 2 only for a $G$ of the template's kind. For the second-order lag version (ii) (43), or higher-order models, the number of thermal-type branches increases. Published dispersion curves of such models show several further branches, and genuine physical branches then have to be separated from spurious roots created by Taylor truncation.

### 6.1.2 Reflection at a free surface: structure of the problem

A plane dilatational wave incident on a plane free surface in an isotropic thermoelastic half-space generates reflected waves of three kinds: a dilatational (elastic-type) wave, a thermal-type wave (evanescent or strongly damped), and a shear-vertical (SV) wave. Boundary conditions are the traction-free conditions together with a thermal condition, either *insulated* (zero normal flux, $\partial_n\theta = 0$ for any $G$) or *isothermal* ($\theta = 0$). A $3\times 3$ linear system gives the amplitude ratios, and they have been computed for many models. The comparison of insulated and isothermal boundaries in generalized theories is a classical exercise [87], and extensions with nonlocal, micropolar, piezoelectric and rotational effects are numerous [88–91]. Those results are not tabulated. Section 6.7 gives instead the structure of the free-surface problem used for Rayleigh waves, which is the same determinant, and Section 6.10 treats the interface problem with a verified energy check.

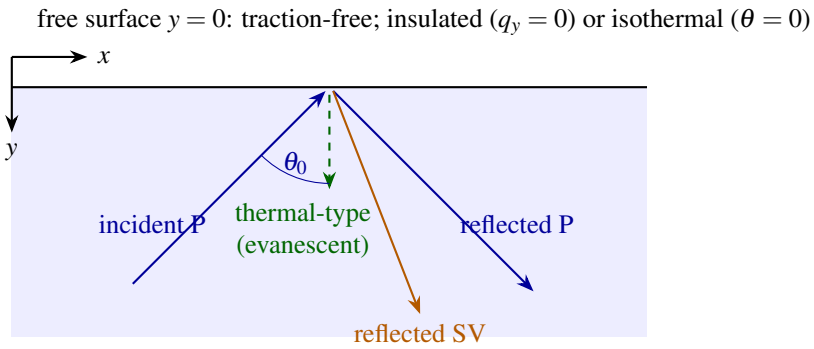



**Figure 19:** Original schematic; the setting follows [87]: reflection at a free thermoelastic surface – an incident P wave generates reflected P, reflected SV and a thermal-type (evanescent/damped) wave; thermal condition insulated or isothermal.

### 6.1.3 Waves in plates, rods and layered structures

Lateral boundary conditions couple the thermal and elastic fields in bounded waveguides and produce families of guided modes: Lamb modes in plates [277] and Pochhammer–Chree modes in rods. The thermoelastic version adds one family of thermal modes per thermal condition, and the thermal coupling perturbs the elastic dispersion curves as in Figure 7, with small speed corrections and damping that peaks where the thermal relaxation frequency of the cross-section matches the wave frequency. For thin plates and beams the flexural damping reduces to Zener's classical result (Section 4.1.4). The elastic waveguide problem has textbooks [278, 279]; for the thermoelastic waveguide with generalized laws the literature consists mainly of specific configurations [82, 117].

**Summary**

In an unbounded isotropic body plane waves split into a shear branch (speed $c_2$, unaffected by heat) and a coupled dilatational–thermal system governed by (33). Reflection at a free surface generates three reflected waves (P, SV, thermal-type), with amplitude ratios from a $3 \times 3$ system. In waveguides each thermal condition adds a family of thermal modes.

## 6.2 Anisotropy: thermal coupling of quasi-longitudinal waves in cubic crystals

The theory above is isotropic. Devices use single crystals, so the questions are how the coupling strength $\varepsilon$ depends on propagation direction and which modes it touches.

### 6.2.1 Christoffel problem with thermal coupling

For a cubic crystal the thermal expansion is isotropic, $\alpha_{ij} = \alpha_T \delta_{ij}$, so the thermal-stress tensor is $\beta_{ij} = \beta_0 \delta_{ij}$ with $\beta_0 = (c_{11} + 2c_{12})\alpha_T$, and heat conduction is scalar. For a plane wave with direction $\boldsymbol{n}$ the field equations give, in the low-frequency (adiabatic) limit $\omega \ll \omega_*$, the Christoffel equation

$$\left[\Gamma_{ik}(\boldsymbol{n}) + \tfrac{\beta_0^2 T_0}{c_v} n_i n_k - \rho v^2 \delta_{ik}\right] p_k = 0, \qquad \Gamma_{ik} = C_{ijkl} n_j n_l, \tag{58}$$

with $c_v$ the volumetric heat capacity; the high-frequency (isothermal) limit is the same equation without the thermal term. That term is a rank-one matrix along $\boldsymbol{n}$, so it couples only the polarisation component along the propagation direction and vanishes for purely transverse modes. Along the symmetry directions of a cubic crystal the coupling is therefore governed by

$$\varepsilon_{\boldsymbol{n}} = \frac{\beta_0^2 T_0}{c_v M_{\boldsymbol{n}}}, \qquad M_{[100]} = c_{11},\; M_{[110]} = \tfrac{1}{2}(c_{11}+c_{12}+2c_{44}),\; M_{[111]} = \tfrac{1}{3}(c_{11}+2c_{12}+4c_{44}), \tag{59}$$

with $M_{\boldsymbol{n}}$ the longitudinal modulus along $\boldsymbol{n}$; the quasi-longitudinal speed rises from the isothermal to the adiabatic value by the factor $\sqrt{1+\varepsilon_{\boldsymbol{n}}}$, and both transverse modes along these directions are untouched.

### 6.2.2 Numerical values

Table 9 gives the result for three cubic metals and semiconductors, from the anisotropy figure with rounded handbook values of the elastic constants, expansion coefficient, density and specific heat at $T_0 = 300\,\mathrm{K}$; a specific sample needs its own measurements. The speed shifts from the full eigenvalue problem agree with $\varepsilon_{\boldsymbol{n}}/2$ to the digits shown.

**Table 9:** Direction dependence of the thermoelastic coupling of quasi-longitudinal waves ($T_0 = 300\,\mathrm{K}$, rounded handbook inputs). $\varepsilon_{\boldsymbol{n}}$ from Eq. (59); shift is $100(v_{\mathrm{ad}}/v_{\mathrm{iso}} - 1)$.

| | [100] | | [111] | | ratio |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Crystal | $\varepsilon$ | shift (%) | $\varepsilon$ | shift (%) | $\varepsilon_{[100]}/\varepsilon_{[111]}$ |
| Cu | 0.0238 | 1.18 | 0.0169 | 0.84 | 1.41 |
| Al | 0.0325 | 1.61 | 0.0306 | 1.52 | 1.06 |
| Si | $6.5\times10^{-4}$ | 0.032 | $5.3\times10^{-4}$ | 0.026 | 1.23 |

For copper the coupling differs by 41% between [100] and [111], so the thermoelastic loss peak, proportional to $\varepsilon_{\boldsymbol{n}}$ in the weak-coupling Debye form, and the adiabatic–isothermal speed gap vary with direction by a comparable amount. Aluminium has only 6% coupling anisotropy, because its elastic anisotropy is weak; silicon has a tiny coupling at all angles, so longitudinal-wave thermoelastic loss in silicon is very small.

### 6.2.3 What changes for the heat-flux law

In non-cubic crystals anisotropic conduction makes $G$ a tensor: the template of Section 3.2 generalises to $\hat{q}_i = -G_{ij}(s)\hat{\theta}_{,j}$, and lag times may differ from axis to axis. For the cubic case used here conduction is isotropic, so only elastic and coupling anisotropy enter, and every scalar result of the preceding sections carries over with $c_1^2 \to M_{\boldsymbol{n}}/\rho$ and $\varepsilon \to \varepsilon_{\boldsymbol{n}}$ along a high-symmetry direction. Away from them the quasi-longitudinal polarisation is not along $\boldsymbol{n}$, the coupling falls by $(\boldsymbol{n}\cdot\boldsymbol{p})^2$, and a quasi-transverse mode picks up a small thermal component.

**Summary**

Anisotropy replaces scalar moduli by tensors $C_{ijkl}, \beta_{ij}, k_{ij}$; shear and dilatation no longer decouple and the Stroh formalism is the systematic tool. Along high-symmetry directions scalar results carry over with effective moduli. Away from them, quasi-longitudinal and quasi-shear modes mix, coupling weakens by $(\boldsymbol{n}\cdot\boldsymbol{p})^2$, and quasi-transverse waves acquire a

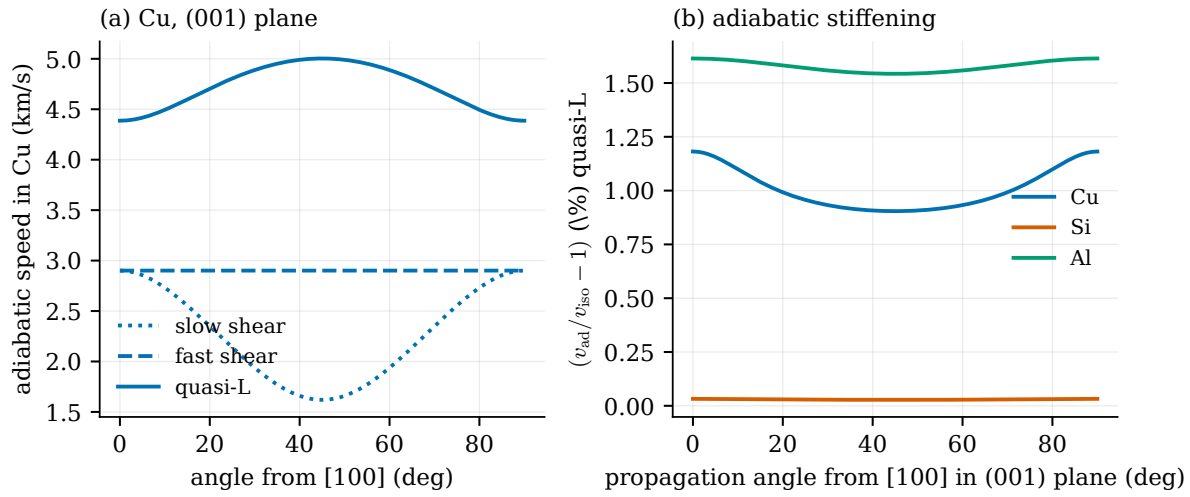



**Figure 20:** (a) Adiabatic phase speeds of the three modes of copper in the (001) plane as functions of the propagation angle from [100]. (b) Relative stiffening $v_{\mathrm{ad}}/v_{\mathrm{iso}} - 1$ of the quasi-longitudinal mode for Cu, Si and Al.

small thermal component.

## 6.3 Reflection at a thermoelastic free surface: numerical results

Section 6.1 described the structure of the free-surface problem. Here numbers and a validation are given for a plane P wave incident on an insulated traction-free surface of an isotropic thermoelastic half-space.

### 6.3.1 Method

The half-space is $y > 0$ with plane strain and the same non-dimensionalisation as in Section 6.7 ($\rho = c_1 = c_v = \omega_*^{-1} = 1$, $\nu = 0.3$, $\varepsilon = 0.1$). The tangential wavenumber $k_x = \mathrm{Re}(k_P)\sin\theta$ is real and conserved. The incident elastic-type wave has amplitude one. The reflected field carries a P wave, an SV wave and a thermal wave that decays away from the surface, and two traction conditions plus the insulation condition give a $3 \times 3$ system for the three amplitudes. Its columns are those of the Rayleigh determinant of Section 6.7, with the sign of the transverse wavenumber reversed for the incident wave (reflection figure).

### 6.3.2 Validation

At $\varepsilon = 10^{-10}$ and $\omega/\omega_* = 0.5$ the system reduces to the elastic problem. The computed displacement-amplitude coefficients then agree with the classical closed forms for a free surface,

$$R_{PP} = \frac{\sin 2\theta \sin 2\phi - \kappa^2 \cos^2 2\phi}{\sin 2\theta \sin 2\phi + \kappa^2 \cos^2 2\phi}, \qquad R_{PS} = \frac{2\kappa \sin 2\theta \cos 2\phi}{\sin 2\theta \sin 2\phi + \kappa^2 \cos^2 2\phi}, \tag{60}$$

with $\kappa = c_1/c_2$ and $\sin\phi = \kappa^{-1}\sin\theta$, to $1.5 \times 10^{-10}$ in $|R_{PP}|$ and $8 \times 10^{-11}$ in $|R_{PS}|$ over $1^\circ \le \theta \le 70^\circ$ (for example 0.6970 and 0.9283 at $30^\circ$).

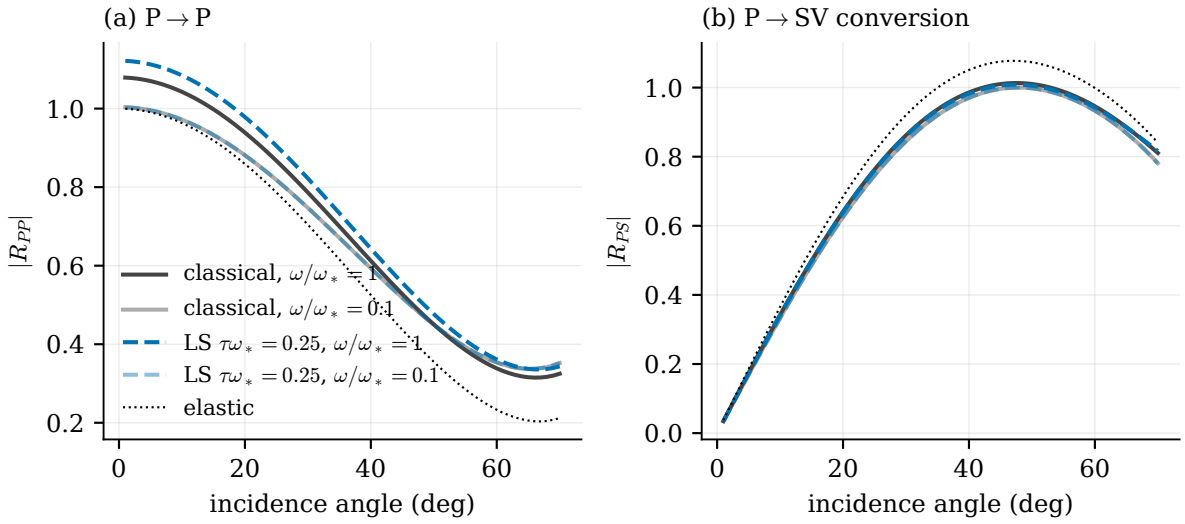



**Figure 21:** Displacement-amplitude reflection coefficients at an insulated free surface for classical and Lord–Shulman heat flux at $\omega/\omega_* = 1$ (dark) and 0.1 (light), $\varepsilon = 0.1$; the dotted line is the purely elastic result.

### 6.3.3 Results

Figure 21 compares the classical and Lord–Shulman ($\tau\omega_* = 0.25$) heat flux at $\omega/\omega_* = 0.1$ and 1.

- At $\omega/\omega_* = 0.1$ the two heat laws are indistinguishable to $10^{-4}$: $|R_{PP}| = 0.878, 0.509, 0.349$ at 20°, 45°, 60° for both. The thermal coupling changes the elastic values only at the level of $\varepsilon$.
- At $\omega/\omega_* = 1$ the classical law gives $|R_{PP}| = 0.935, 0.517, 0.333$ at the same angles and the Lord–Shulman law gives 0.975, 0.546, 0.355, i.e. differences of 4%, 5.5% and 7% between the two heat laws. The mode-converted amplitude changes by less, $|R_{PS}| = 0.648$ versus 0.647 at 20° and 1.012 versus 1.007 at 45°.

The displacement amplitude $|R_{PS}|$ exceeds one at 45°. That reflects the different displacement and energy normalisations of P and SV waves and is no gain; conclusions about energy have to come from the energy flux (Section 6.10).

### 6.3.4 Reading the result

The heat law shifts reflection by a few percent only near $\omega \sim \omega_*$, which for metals lies in the tens of GHz. At MHz frequencies a thermoelastic solid reflects as an elastic solid with the adiabatic moduli, whatever the heat law. That supports the model-selection argument of Section 10.1 and, in practice, rules out the heat-flux law as an explanation for discrepancies between reflection measurements and elastic predictions in the MHz range.

**Summary**

Reflection at a free thermoelastic surface gives three reflected waves (P, SV, thermal-type) from a $3 \times 3$ determinant. The heat law changes reflection coefficients by several percent only near $\omega \sim \omega_*$ (tens of GHz for metals). At MHz frequencies the thermoelastic solid

reflects like an elastic solid with adiabatic moduli; discrepancies in the MHz range cannot be blamed on the heat-flux law.

## 6.4 Transient problems: heat pulses and thermal shock

Steady-state dispersion analysis says how a monochromatic wave propagates. Transient problems test the *fronts*: finite speed, jumps and their decay. Two benchmarks are used, because both have closed-form Laplace-domain solutions that can be inverted numerically to any accuracy, and both serve as test cases for numerical codes (Section 8.1).

### 6.4.1 Uncoupled heat pulse in a half-space

Consider the semi-infinite rod $x>0$, initially at $\theta=0$, with prescribed boundary flux $q(0,t)=q_0H(t)$ and no coupling. For $G(s)=k(1+\tau_T s)/(1+\tau_q s)$ with $\tau_T=0$ (Lord–Shulman), $\tau_q=\tau$, the solution is

$$\hat{\theta}(x,s)=\frac{q_0\,(1+\tau s)}{k\,s\,m(s)}\,e^{-x\,m(s)},\qquad m(s)=\sqrt{\frac{s(1+\tau s)}{\alpha}}, \tag{61}$$

and $\tau=0$ recovers Fourier's solution $\theta=(q_0/k)\big[2\sqrt{\alpha t/\pi}\,e^{-x^2/4\alpha t}-x\operatorname{erfc}(x/2\sqrt{\alpha t})\big]$. The large-$s$ asymptotics $m(s)\simeq s/c_T+1/(2\ell_T)$, with $c_T=\sqrt{\alpha/\tau}$ and $\ell_T=\sqrt{\alpha\tau}=c_T\tau$, fix the front structure. The signal is exactly zero ahead of $x=c_Tt$, and at the front it jumps by

$$\big[\theta\big]_{x=c_Tt}=\frac{q_0}{\rho c\,c_T}\,e^{-x/2\ell_T}, \tag{62}$$

which decays exponentially with distance; at the boundary the temperature jumps from zero to $q_0/\rho cc_T$ at $t=0^+$, instead of growing as $\sqrt{t}$. The Cattaneo curves of Figure 22 come from numerical Talbot inversion [280] of (61), with the zero ahead of the front imposed exactly; the ripples near the front are the Gibbs-type error of the inversion at a discontinuity. At late times the two solutions coincide, the ratio at $t=40\tau$ differing from one by less than one percent, which is the sense in which the Cattaneo model is a high-frequency correction to Fourier's law.

**Boundary conditions decide the sign.** A statement that "second sound lowers the surface temperature", or raises it, means nothing without the boundary condition. With a prescribed flux the hyperbolic model gives a larger surface temperature than Fourier's law at early times in this normalisation (Figure 22); with a prescribed surface temperature it is the flux that jumps, overshooting Fourier's. Laser-heating models therefore have to state carefully how the heat input is represented [116].

### 6.4.2 Thermal shock of a coupled half-space

Next consider the half-space $x>0$ with the boundary at temperature $\theta_0H(t)$ and traction-free, coupled thermoelastic one-dimensional problem. In the Laplace domain, with fields $\propto e^{-mx}$ the characteristic equation is (33) with $K=-m^2$, giving two decay rates $m_1(s)$, $m_2(s)$ ($\operatorname{Re}m>0$). In units $\rho=c=c_1=k=T_0=1$ (so that lengths are in $c_1/\omega_*$ and time in $1/\omega_*$), with $\beta=\sqrt{\varepsilon}$, the displacement and stress amplitudes associated with a temperature amplitude $A_j$ are

$$U_j=\frac{\beta\,m_j}{s^2-m_j^2}A_j,\qquad \sigma_j=-m_jU_j-\beta A_j \tag{63}$$

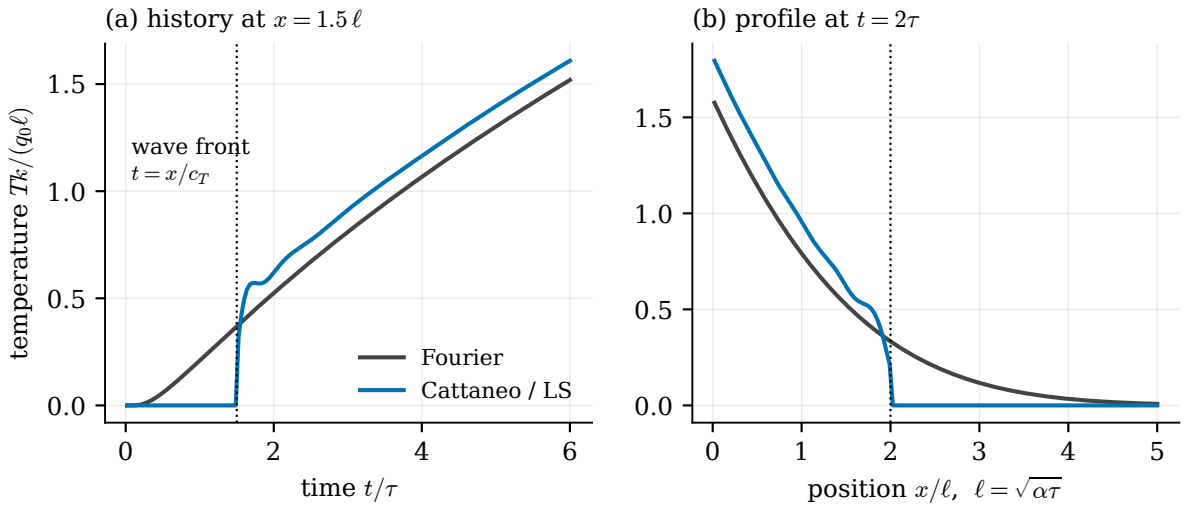



**Figure 22:** Uncoupled heat pulse from a prescribed boundary flux. Left: temperature history at $x = 1.5\ell_T$. Right: profile at $t = 2\tau$. The Lord–Shulman curve is exactly zero beyond the front (dotted); the classical solution has no front. At early times the Lord–Shulman surface temperature exceeds the classical one for this boundary condition.

and the boundary conditions $\sum_j A_j = \theta_0/s$ and $\sum_j \sigma_j(0) = 0$ fix $A_1, A_2$, the second reducing to $\sum_j A_j s^2/(s^2 - m_j^2) = 0$. The resulting transform satisfies $s\hat{\theta}(0,s) = 1$ and $\hat{\sigma}(0,s) = 0$ to machine precision; inversion is then numerical. Figure 23 shows temperature and stress at a point $x = 2c_1/\omega_*$ for the classical, Lord–Shulman and DPL laws ($\varepsilon = 0.1$, $\tau_q = 0.25/\omega_*$, DPL $\tau_T = \tau_q/2$).

Three features of the response are robust. (i) After the first elastic transit the thermal part is almost identical in all three models, because the heat laws differ only in the first moments after loading and the long-time evolution is classical diffusion. (ii) The stress is largest, and most sensitive to the heat law, at the elastic front, where Lord–Shulman gives about 20 % larger compressive peak than the classical model in this example (peak values $-0.30$ against $-0.25$, in units of $\rho c_1^2$). (iii) Before the elastic front arrives the classical solution already carries stress, since the thermal body force acts everywhere at once, whereas in Lord–Shulman the stress stays essentially zero until the thermal front arrives at $t = 1$ and then rises more steeply. The amplitudes depend on the dimensionless parameters and need recomputation before use with real materials.

Memory-dependent generalized thermoelasticity with finite wave speeds was studied by [281]; the spatial behavior of thermal signals in generalized thermoelasticity with MDD was examined by [282]. Moore–Gibson–Thompson thermoelasticity in double porous materials was analysed by [283], and the transient response of a functionally graded half-space heated by a laser pulse was computed by [284].

### 6.4.3 Lessons for laser heating and for numerical codes

Hyperbolic models are driven mainly by short-pulse laser heating in metals, and analyses of bilayers and films under pulsed heating combine fractional and memory-dependent laws [116]. For numerical codes the benchmarks above are a stringent check: a code that smears the front misses the stress peak as well. The classical statement of the thermal shock problem is due to

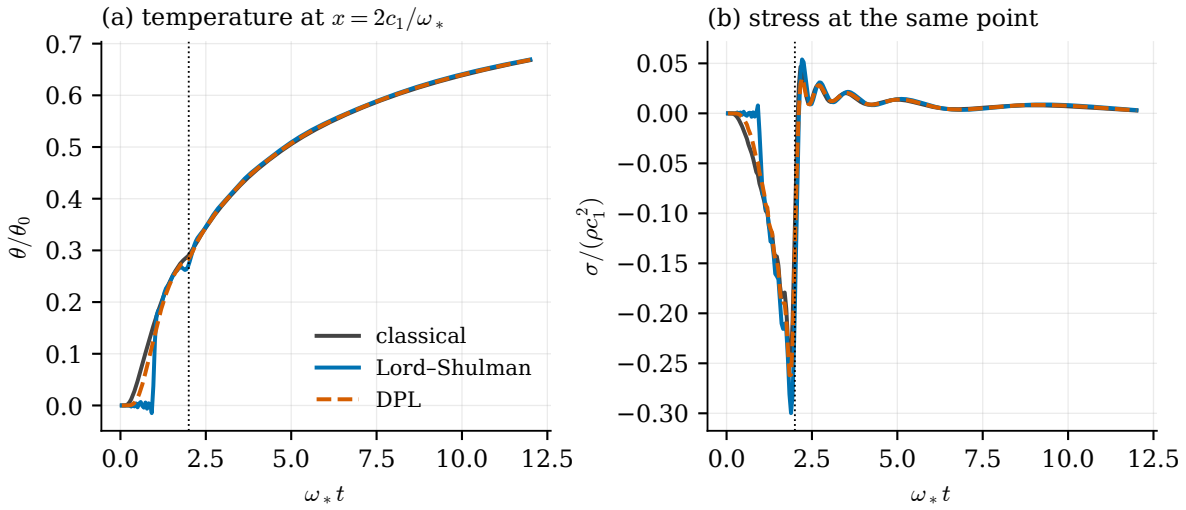



**Figure 23:** Thermal shock of a coupled half-space (boundary temperature step, traction-free surface), recorded at $x = 2c_1/\omega_*$. Dotted line: arrival of the elastic wave front ($x = c_1 t$). The Lord–Shulman thermal front reaches the point at $t = x/c_T = 1$; the stress develops a negative (compressive) pulse and jumps at the elastic front. Small oscillations are inversion error at discontinuities.

Danilovskaya [3], and thermal-shock solutions of the coupled problem are a standard test in texts [8, 21, 22].

**Summary**

The heat-pulse problem shows a finite front for hyperbolic laws (LS, MGT, GN-II) and a Gaussian tail for Fourier. The front carries a stress peak whose height is heat-law dependent (about 20% between Fourier and LS for the parameters used). Thermal shock combines the elastic front with diffusive wake; a numerical code that smears the front also misses the stress peak—the benchmark of Section 6.4 tests exactly this.

## 6.5 Thermal-wave resonance in a finite rod

The uncoupled heat law offers a small, exactly solvable example of finite size revealing hyperbolic character: the normal modes of a rod with insulated ends.

### 6.5.1 Modes of the Cattaneo equation

For a rod $0 < x < L$ with $q = 0$ at both ends, eliminating $q$ from the Cattaneo system gives $\tau\theta_{tt} + \theta_t = \chi\theta_{xx}$, with $\theta \propto \cos(k_n x)e^{st}$, $k_n = n\pi/L$, and

$$\tau s^2 + s + \chi k_n^2 = 0 \quad \Rightarrow \quad s_\pm = \frac{-1 \pm \sqrt{1 - 4\tau\chi k_n^2}}{2\tau}. \tag{64}$$

For the Fourier law ($\tau = 0$) every mode decays at the real rate $\chi k_n^2$. For $\tau > 0$ the modes with $k_n < k_c = 1/(2\sqrt{\chi\tau}) = 1/(2\ell)$, where $\ell = c_T\tau$ is the relaxation length, are overdamped with two real rates, and the modes with $k_n > k_c$ are oscillatory with frequency $\omega_n = \sqrt{\chi k_n^2/\tau - 1/(4\tau^2)}$, decaying at the common rate $1/(2\tau)$. The thermal wave therefore appears as a damped oscilla-

tion only in modes of wavelength shorter than $4\pi\ell$, and there it always decays at the rate $1/2\tau$, whatever the mode number.

### 6.5.2 Size at which oscillation is possible

The lowest mode ($n = 1$) is oscillatory if $L < 2\pi\ell$. Copper, with $\chi = 1.2 \times 10^{-4}\,\mathrm{m^2/s}$ (Table 3), gives $c_T = 1.1 \times 10^4\,\mathrm{m/s}$ and $\ell = 1.1 \times 10^{-8}\,\mathrm{m}$ at a lag $\tau = 1\,\mathrm{ps}$, so a rod shorter than 68 nm would have an oscillatory first mode; at $\tau = 10\,\mathrm{ps}$, $\ell = 3.4 \times 10^{-8}\,\mathrm{m}$ and $L < 210\,\mathrm{nm}$. Both sizes are comparable to or below the carrier mean free paths at which the continuum conduction law itself becomes questionable, which agrees with Section 9.3: the oscillatory regime of the Cattaneo law is reached only where the assumptions behind the law fail.

### 6.5.3 Relation to the coupled problem

In the coupled problem of Section 6.6 the elastic-like mode picks up damping from the thermal modes through the factor $\varepsilon$, but the conduction modes themselves are of the type above and damp out; no regime leaves heat-driven oscillations standing. That is the dissipative character of the Cattaneo law ($\mathrm{d}\mathscr{E}/\mathrm{d}t = -\int q^2/kT_0 \le 0$, Eq. (16)), in contrast to the conservative Green–Naghdi type II law, whose uncoupled thermal modes oscillate undamped at $\omega_n = c_T k_n$.

**Summary**

A finite rod with insulated ends has thermal modes with wavenumbers $k_n = n\pi/L$ and complex roots of the thermal dispersion equation. Heat-conduction modes are damped under Cattaneo-type laws and undamped oscillations $\omega_n = c_T k_n$ under GN-II. In the coupled problem elastic-like modes inherit damping through $\varepsilon$; there is no regime of persistent heat-driven oscillations.

## 6.6 Resonant modes of a clamped bar

Resonator loss is a temporal quantity: a standing mode with real wavenumber $k_n = n\pi/L$ decays in time at a complex frequency $\omega_n$. The plane-wave polynomial of Eq. (35) is therefore used with real $k$ and complex $s = -i\omega$.

### 6.6.1 Setting

Take a bar of length $L$ with both ends clamped ($u = 0$) and insulated ($\theta_{,x} = 0$). Each eigenfunction has the form $u \propto \sin k_n x$ and $\theta \propto \cos k_n x$ with $k_n = n\pi/L$, so every coupled mode satisfies the boundary conditions exactly and its frequency is a root in $s$ of the polynomial of Eq. (35) at $K = k_n^2$: quartic in $s$ for Lord–Shulman heat flux, cubic for the classical law. The elastic-like root is tracked by continuity in $k$, starting from the adiabatic value $c_1\sqrt{1+\varepsilon}\,k$. In units $c_1 = \omega_* = 1$, with $\varepsilon = 0.1$, the bar-mode figure gives the following.

### 6.6.2 Results

- At small $k$ every model gives the same loss, numerically $8.7 \times 10^{-4}$ at $k = 0.01$, about 13% below the first-order Debye value $\varepsilon k/(1+k^2)$ because the temporal and spatial loss

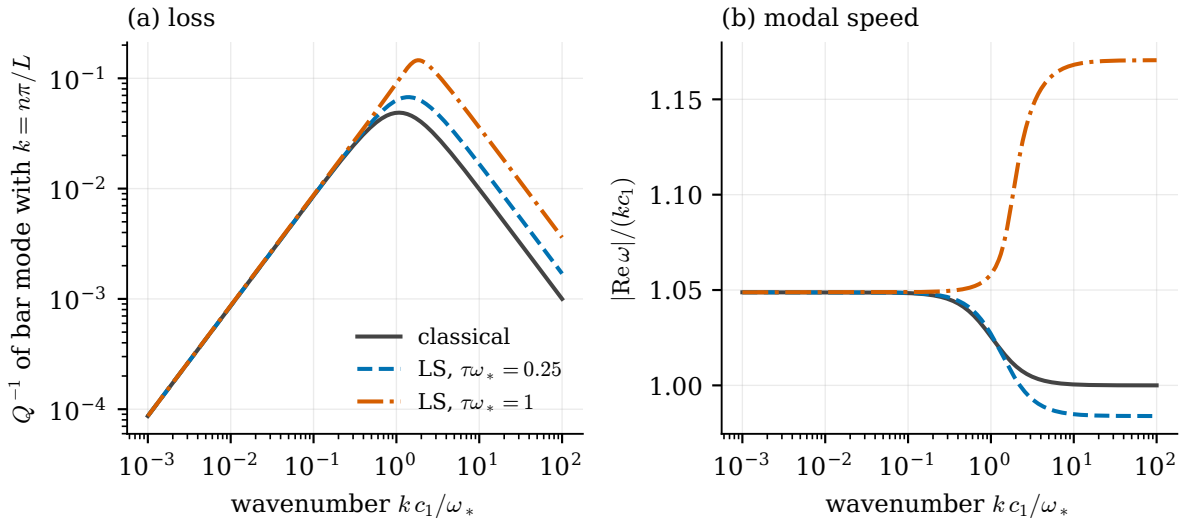



**Figure 24:** Loss $Q^{-1} = 2|\mathrm{Im}\,\omega|/|\mathrm{Re}\,\omega|$ and modal speed of the elastic-like mode of a clamped insulated bar ($\varepsilon = 0.1$) against $k = n\pi/L$ for classical and Lord–Shulman heat flux ($\tau\omega_* = 0.25$ and 1).

measures differ at $O(\varepsilon)$.

- The classical law gives a Debye-type peak $Q^{-1} = 0.0488$ at $k\,c_1/\omega_* = 1.07$, and the modal speed falls from the adiabatic value $1.049\,c_1$ to $c_1$ at large $k$.
- For Lord–Shulman with $\tau\omega_* = 0.25$ the peak rises to 0.0676 at $k = 1.39$, and the high-$k$ modal speed settles at $0.984\,c_1$.
- At $\tau\omega_* = 1$, where the thermal front speed equals $c_1$, the peak reaches 0.146 at $k = 1.84$, three times the classical value, and the high-$k$ modal speed is $1.17\,c_1$. This is the degenerate case of equal front speeds: coupling splits the two fronts as $c^2 = c_1^2[1 + \varepsilon/2 \pm \sqrt{\varepsilon + \varepsilon^2/4}]$, which gives $1.17\,c_1$ for the upper root.

The curves are shown in Fig. 24. Near $\tau\omega_* \approx 1$ the thermal and elastic branches hybridise, the label "elastic-like" loses its edge, and results have to be read together with the branch-tracking procedure.

### 6.6.3 Consequence for resonator design

A bar of fixed length, with its sequence of overtones, traverses the curve of Fig. 24 from left to right. The classical model puts the worst loss at $k_n c_1 \approx \omega_*$, and the lag raises it only for $\tau\omega_*$ of order one, exactly where the lag law is least trustworthy. For every material of Table 3 $\omega_*$ exceeds $10^{11}$ rad/s, so the peak sits at wavelengths near $c_1/\omega_* \sim 10\,\mathrm{nm}$, and micron-sized bar resonators operate on the left, linear-in-$k$ flank where all models agree.

**Summary**

A clamped bar's overtones trace the thermoelastic damping curve from left to right. Classical theory predicts worst loss at $k_n c_1 \approx \omega_*$; lagged models raise it only if $\tau\omega_* \sim 1$, where the lag law is least trustworthy. For all materials of Table 3, $\omega_* > 10^{11}$ rad/s, so micron-scale bar resonators operate on the linear-in-$k$ flank where all models agree.

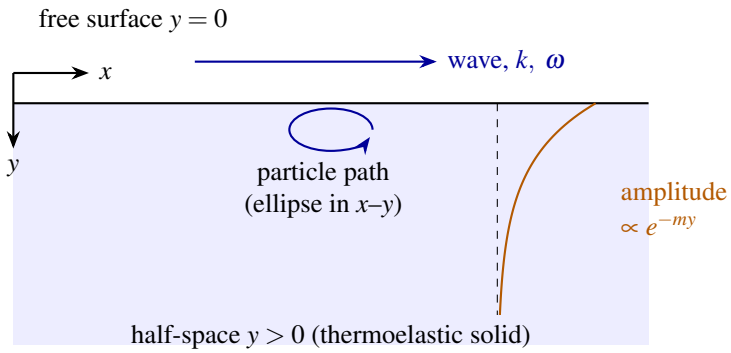



**Figure 25:** Original schematic; the setting follows [290]: thermoelastic Rayleigh wave on a half-space – surface-trapped particle motion decaying exponentially with depth, coupled dilatational–thermal and shear potentials.

## 6.7 Surface waves: thermoelastic Rayleigh waves

### 6.7.1 Formulation

Consider the half-space $y > 0$ in plane strain, with waves propagating along $x$, $\propto e^{ikx}$ and decaying with depth. With potentials $\boldsymbol{u} = \nabla\phi + \nabla \times (\psi \boldsymbol{e}_z)$, each coupled dilatational–thermal mode has $\phi_j, \theta_j \propto e^{-m_j y}$ with

$$m_j^2 = k^2 + \kappa_j, \qquad G\kappa^2 - \big(Gs^2 + s + \varepsilon s\big)\kappa + s^3 = 0 \quad (\rho = c = c_1 = T_0 = 1), \tag{65}$$

which is (33) with $K = -\kappa$, and the shear potential decays with $m_s^2 = k^2 + s^2/c_2^2$. The ratio of temperature to potential amplitude in each coupled mode is $\theta_j = (\kappa_j - s^2)\phi_j/\beta$. The boundary conditions on $y = 0$ are traction-free, $\sigma_{yy} = \sigma_{xy} = 0$, and either an insulated ($\partial_y \theta = 0$, which is $q_y = 0$ for any $G$) or an isothermal ($\theta = 0$) thermal condition. With

$$\sigma_{yy} = \sum_{j=1}^{2} \big[\lambda\,\kappa_j + 2\mu m_j^2 - \beta\,\theta_j/\phi_j\big]\phi_j + 2\mu\,\mathrm{i}k m_s\,\psi, \tag{66}$$

$$\sigma_{xy} = \mu\Big[-2\mathrm{i}k \sum_{j=1}^{2} m_j\phi_j + (m_s^2 + k^2)\psi\Big], \tag{67}$$

the three conditions form a homogeneous $3 \times 3$ linear system for $(\phi_1, \phi_2, \psi)$ whose determinant $\mathscr{D}(s,k)$ must vanish. The root $s(k)$ with $\mathrm{Re}\, m_j > 0$ gives the complex Rayleigh frequency $\omega = \mathrm{i}s$ for real $k$ (temporal damping); the same determinant at real $\omega$ and complex $k$ gives spatial damping. Many apparent disagreements among published Rayleigh dispersion curves come from differences of formulation: which attenuation measure is plotted, which branch of the square roots is taken, how the thermal boundary condition is chosen [81, 83–85, 285–289].

**Check of the limit.** For $\varepsilon \to 0$ the determinant factorises and the root reduces to the classical Rayleigh equation $(2 - c^2/c_2^2)^2 = 4\sqrt{1 - c^2/c_1^2}\sqrt{1 - c^2/c_2^2}$ [290]. For $\nu = 0.3$, so that $c_2^2/c_1^2 = (1-2\nu)/(2-2\nu) = 2/7$, the root is $c_R = 0.4957\,c_1 = 0.9274\,c_2$; the numerical determinant root at $\varepsilon = 10^{-4}$ reproduces it to the digits displayed, and the thermoelastic root approaches it at large $k$, where the response turns isothermal.

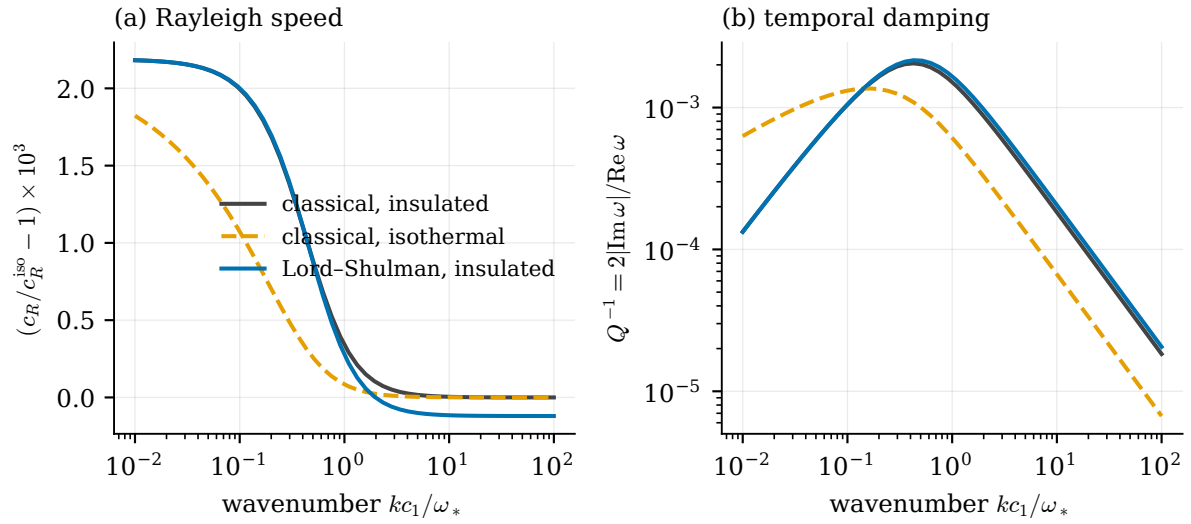



**Figure 26:** Thermoelastic Rayleigh wave in a half-space ($\nu = 0.3$, $\varepsilon = 0.05$). (a) Speed relative to the purely elastic Rayleigh speed. (b) Temporal damping $Q^{-1} = 2|\operatorname{Im}\omega|/\operatorname{Re}\omega$ at real wavenumber $k$ in units of $\omega_*/c_1$. Curves: classical theory with insulated and with isothermal surface, and Lord–Shulman with $\tau_q = 0.25/\omega_*$ and insulated surface.

### 6.7.2 Results

Figure 26 shows the speed change and damping of the thermoelastic Rayleigh wave for $\varepsilon = 0.05$, $\nu = 0.3$. At low wavenumber the speed exceeds the purely elastic Rayleigh speed (the adiabatic limit) by about $2 \times 10^{-3}$ and tends to the elastic value at large $k$ (the isothermal limit), as the bulk wave does (Figure 7a); the effect is an order of magnitude weaker than for the compressional wave, because only part of the surface motion is dilatational. The damping peaks at $kc_1/\omega_* \approx 0.4$ with a quality-factor reciprocal of about $2 \times 10^{-3}$. The thermal boundary condition matters at low wavenumber. An isothermal surface suppresses the surface temperature fluctuation, which shifts the damping peak to smaller $k$ and lowers the speed change. The Lord–Shulman law ($\tau_q = 0.25/\omega_*$, insulated surface) leaves the low-wavenumber results nearly unchanged and matters increasingly at large $k$: against the classical insulated surface the damping differs by less than 1 % for $kc_1/\omega_* \le 0.1$, by 5 % at the damping peak, by 10 % at $kc_1/\omega_* = 1$, and saturates near 12 % for $kc_1/\omega_* \ge 10$, while the speed offset reaches $-1.2 \times 10^{-4}$ relative at large $k$. The bulk wave predicts this: the heat law matters once the product of frequency and lag is of order one.

### 6.7.3 Anisotropic, piezoelectric and nonlocal surface waves

For anisotropic media the Stroh formalism [145, 146] writes the displacement–traction state vector as a first-order system in $y$, and the secular equation becomes the vanishing of a determinant ($3 \times 3$, or larger once piezoelectric and thermal fields are added) built from the eigenvectors with decaying exponents. That is the route used for piezothermoelastic layers and half-spaces [82]. For piezoelectric materials, new surface-wave types arise: the Bleustein–Gulyaev shear-horizontal wave exists for transversely isotropic piezoelectric substrates even though a pure SH wave cannot exist at an ordinary elastic free surface; Rayleigh waves in nonlocal piezoelastic half-spaces and piezo-thermoelectric semiconductors have been treated with Eringen-type nonlocality and with fractional or Klein–Gordon-type extensions [83–85, 128]. Rayleigh surface

wave dynamics of porous piezo-thermoelectric smart material with spatio-temporal nonlocality were studied by [291]; Rayleigh waves in a nonlocal thermoelastic layer lying over a nonlocal thermoelastic half-space were computed by [292]; Rayleigh waves in a thermoelastic half-space coated by a Maxwell–Cattaneo thermoelastic layer were analysed by [293]. Memory-dependent heat transfer effects on Rayleigh waves propagation in nonlocal piezo-thermo-elastic media were investigated by [294]; Rayleigh waves in transversely isotropic thermoelastic diffusive half-space were treated by [295]; Rayleigh-type surface waves in a nonlocal thermoelastic solid half space with voids were studied by [296]. Energy aspects of surface thermoelastic waves are discussed in [86]. Every one of these extensions keeps the structure of the determinant above and adds exponents and boundary conditions. The physical effects are the same three: the Rayleigh root shifts under electromechanical stiffening (by $K^2$, Section 7.1), under nonlocal dispersion (Section 5.3), and under thermal damping as shown here.

### 6.7.4 Practical remarks on secular equations

Three technical points recur. (i) The decaying branch of each square root needs $\operatorname{Re} m > 0$, which puts branch cuts into the complex plane and makes the determinant non-analytic across them; root finding that ignores this can jump to spurious roots. (ii) The determinant has trivial zeros, $s = 0$ among them, that must be excluded when roots are tracked; a naive secant search from a poor initial guess converged to one in the runs reported here. (iii) Continuation in $k$ from a reliable starting point, here the isothermal Rayleigh root, is more robust than independent root finding at every $k$.

**Summary**

The thermoelastic Rayleigh problem is a $3 \times 3$ determinant $\mathscr{D}(s,k)$ from two coupled dilatational–thermal modes and one shear mode, with insulated or isothermal surface. Speed shifts from adiabatic (low $k$) to elastic/isothermal (high $k$); damping peaks near $kc_1/\omega_* \approx 0.4$. The thermal boundary condition shifts the peak; LS changes results by $\sim$10–12% at large $k$.

## 6.8 Thermoelastic Lamb waves in a plate

Plates carry the counterpart of the half-space surface wave (Section 6.7), with two free faces coupling the dilatational, shear and thermal fields. The plate problem recovers the flexural thermoelastic damping of Section 6.9 from the full field equations, which makes it a stringent test of the formulation.

### 6.8.1 Formulation

Consider a plate $-h < y < h$ in plane strain, with waves $\exp[i(kx - \omega t)]$ along $x$ and real $k$. The fields are the two dilatational–thermal modes $j = 1,2$, which are the two roots $\kappa_j$ of the coupled quadratic of Section 4.1 with transverse wavenumbers $m_j = \sqrt{\kappa_j + k^2}$, and the shear mode with $m_s = \sqrt{s^2/c_2^2 + k^2}$ with $s = -i\omega$. Each mode appears as $e^{\pm my}$, so there are six amplitudes. The boundary conditions on $y = \pm h$ are $\sigma_{yy} = \sigma_{xy} = 0$ and either an insulated ($\theta_{,y} = 0$) or an isothermal ($\theta = 0$) face, which gives a $6 \times 6$ determinant $D(s;k,h)$ whose roots are the plate modes. For a given real $k$ the roots $s$ are complex, and $Q^{-1} = 2|\operatorname{Im}\omega|/\operatorname{Re}\omega$

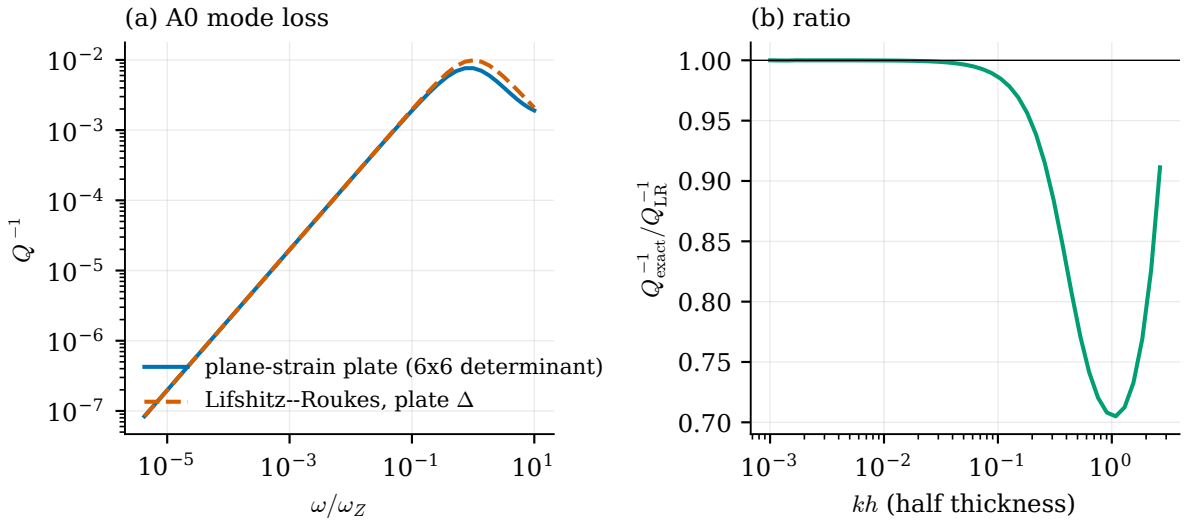



**Figure 27:** Lowest antisymmetric (flexural) mode of a thermoelastic plate, plane strain, $\varepsilon = 0.05$, $\nu = 0.3$, $h = 20\,c_1/\omega_*$, insulated faces. (a) Loss from the $6\times6$ determinant and from Eq. (69) with the plane-strain $\Delta$. (b) Ratio of the two against $kh$.

measures the temporal damping. The heat-flux model enters only through $G(s)$ in the quadratic, so lagging and fractional laws are handled by substitution. The implementation is in Lamb-wave calculation.

### 6.8.2 Validation

Two checks were made.

1. *Elastic limit.* With $\varepsilon = 10^{-8}$ and $kh = 0.3$ the antisymmetric root is $\omega = 0.04426280008$ (units $c_1 = 1$, $h = 1$), against 0.04426280008 from the Rayleigh–Lamb equation $\tan(qh)\,4k^2pq + (q^2-k^2)^2\tan(ph) = 0$ solved separately; they agree to about $10^{-10}$.
2. *Thin-plate thermoelastic damping.* For $\varepsilon = 0.05$, $\nu = 0.3$ and a plate with $h = 20\,c_1/\omega_*$ the loss of the lowest antisymmetric mode was computed over $10^{-3} \lesssim kh \lesssim 1.3$. For $\omega \ll \omega_Z = \pi^2\chi/(2h)^2$ the loss follows Eq. (69) with the plane-strain value $\Delta = E\alpha_T^2 T_0(1+\nu)/[(1-\nu)c_v]$, with ratio 1.000 for $kh \lesssim 0.015$, 0.998 at $kh = 0.036$, and 0.989 at $kh = 0.088$.

Plane strain requires the factor $(1+\nu)/(1-\nu)$ instead of 1, through the stiffness $E/(1-\nu^2)$ and the expansion $(1+\nu)\alpha_T$, and the numbers confirm it. A beam formula quoted with the uniaxial $\Delta$ would underestimate plane-strain damping by a factor 1.86 at $\nu = 0.3$.

### 6.8.3 Beyond the thin-plate limit

Figure 27 shows the loss and its ratio to Eq. (69). The ratio falls to 0.94 at $kh = 0.22$, to 0.77 at $kh = 0.53$ (where $\omega = 1.01\,\omega_Z$) and to 0.71 at $kh = 1.3$. The peak loss is $Q^{-1} = 7.6\times10^{-3}$ at $\omega/\omega_Z = 1.01$, against $9.9\times10^{-3}$ for the thin-plate formula. The thin-plate formula thus overestimates the peak loss by about 30% once the wavelength is a few thicknesses, presumably because shear and rotary-inertia effects, missing from the Euler–Bernoulli kinematics behind Eq. (69), become important; this computation does not isolate that cause. Resonator designs with $kh \gtrsim 0.3$ therefore need the full determinant, or a Mindlin-type thermoelastic model.

### 6.8.4 Role of the heat-flux law

In Eq. (69) heat flows across the thickness, so the relevant dimensionless number is the product of the lag with the transverse relaxation rate $\omega_Z = \pi^2\chi/(2h)^2$. For metal films tens of nanometres thick, $\tau_q\omega_Z \ll 1$ and the parabolic result suffices (Section 6.9); for films below ten nanometres, or where the phonon mean free path is comparable to the thickness, a kinetic or Guyer–Krumhansl treatment (Section 3.4) is the better refinement. The determinant itself does not decide which regime applies; it supplies the correct reference result for each choice of $G(s)$.

**Summary**

Lamb waves in a thermoelastic plate are guided modes from the same $3\times3$ determinant structure as Rayleigh waves, now with both surfaces free. Heat flows across the thickness, so the relevant number is $\tau_q\omega_Z$ with $\omega_Z = \pi^2\chi/(2h)^2$. For films of tens of nm in metals the parabolic result is adequate; below $\sim 10$ nm or with ballistic transport, kinetic/GK is the appropriate refinement.

## 6.9 Thermoelastic damping in flexure: Zener and exact Fourier solutions

Longitudinal waves (Section 4.1) are only one setting for the thermoelastic loss. In microresonators the dominant case is flexure of a thin beam, where the temperature gradient across the thickness $h$ relaxes by transverse conduction.

### 6.9.1 Two classical results

Zener's single-relaxation treatment gives

$$Q^{-1} = \Delta\,\frac{\omega\tau_Z}{1+(\omega\tau_Z)^2}, \qquad \tau_Z = \frac{h^2}{\pi^2\alpha}, \qquad \Delta = \frac{E\alpha_T^2 T_0}{c_v}, \tag{68}$$

with $\alpha$ the thermal diffusivity, $\alpha_T$ the linear expansion coefficient and $c_v$ the volumetric heat capacity. The exact solution of the Fourier problem for a thin rectangular beam in Euler–Bernoulli flexure, due to Lifshitz and Roukes, is

$$Q^{-1} = \Delta\left[\frac{6}{\zeta^2} - \frac{6}{\zeta^3}\,\frac{\sinh\zeta+\sin\zeta}{\cosh\zeta+\cos\zeta}\right], \qquad \zeta = h\sqrt{\frac{\omega}{2\alpha}}. \tag{69}$$

Both reduce to $Q^{-1} \simeq \Delta\,\omega\tau_Z$ for $\omega\tau_Z \ll 1$.

### 6.9.2 Quantitative comparison

Figure 28 compares Eqs. (68) and (69) (flexural-damping figure). With $x = \omega\tau_Z$ the exact solution peaks at $Q^{-1}/\Delta = 0.494$ near $x = 1.008$, against 0.5 at $x = 1$ for the Zener form. The relative error of the Zener form is $+1.3\%$ at $x = 0.01$, 0.1 and 1, $-5\%$ at $x = 10$ and $-14\%$ at $x = 100$. The single-relaxation form is thus accurate to a few percent through the peak and on its low-frequency side, and underestimates the loss for $x \gtrsim 10$, where the exact solution decays as $x^{-1/2}$ and the Zener form as $x^{-1}$.

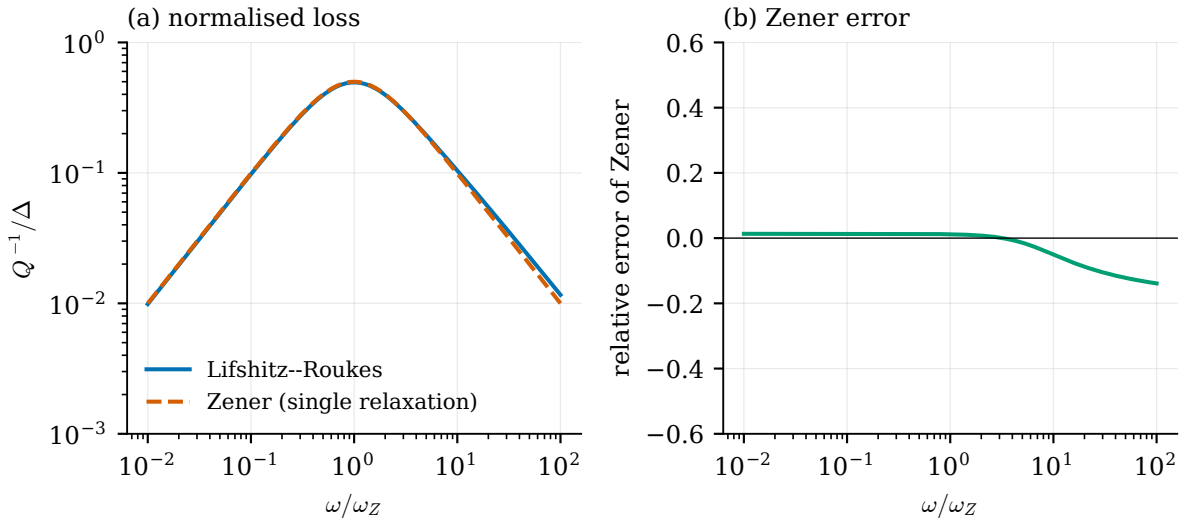



**Figure 28:** (a) Thermoelastic loss of a thin beam in flexure: exact Fourier solution Eq. (69) and the Zener form Eq. (68). (b) Relative error of the Zener form.

### 6.9.3 Where hyperbolic corrections enter

Equation (69) assumes parabolic heat conduction across the thickness. A lagging law (Section 4.3) changes the result only when the transverse relaxation rate $\pi^2\alpha/h^2$ approaches the inverse lag. With $\tau_q \sim 10^{-12}$ s, $h \sim 100$ nm and $\alpha \sim 10^{-4}$ m$^2$/s, the product $\omega\tau_q$ at the Zener peak, $\omega\tau_q = \pi^2\alpha\tau_q/h^2 \approx 9.9 \times 10^{-4} \times 10^{-12}/10^{-14} \approx 0.1$, lies below the limit $\omega\tau_q \lesssim 0.3$ of Section 4.4, but only by a factor of three, so the parabolic result suffices for $h \sim 100$ nm without a wide margin. Corrections become appreciable for $h$ below about 60 nm, where $\omega\tau_q$ reaches 0.3, and are large at $h \sim 10$ nm, or when ballistic transport is relevant; there the Guyer–Krumhansl form (Section 3.4) is the right next step rather than a pure lag law.

**Summary**

Zener's flexural damping has the same Debye form as bulk thermoelastic damping, with $\omega_*$ replaced by $1/\tau_Z$, $\tau_Z \simeq h^2/(\pi^2\alpha)$, and relaxation strength $\Delta = E\alpha_T^2 T_0/(\rho c)$. Lifshitz–Roukes give the exact beam expression. Hyperbolic corrections enter only when $\omega\tau_q$ approaches one at the Zener peak; for $h \sim 100$ nm this requires $\tau_q \gg 10^{-12}$ s, so parabolic conduction is adequate for most resonators and GK is the right refinement below $\sim 10$ nm.

## 6.10 Interfaces, reflection and energy partition

Reflection and transmission at interfaces is the most heavily studied wave problem in generalized thermoelasticity and in multiphysics media; Table 2 lists many of the works. Most of them report *energy ratios* and take a unit sum as a validation. The problem is built from the elastic baseline, thermal coupling is added, and the conditions under which the unit-sum check holds and under which it fails are identified, because the literature is not uniform on that point.

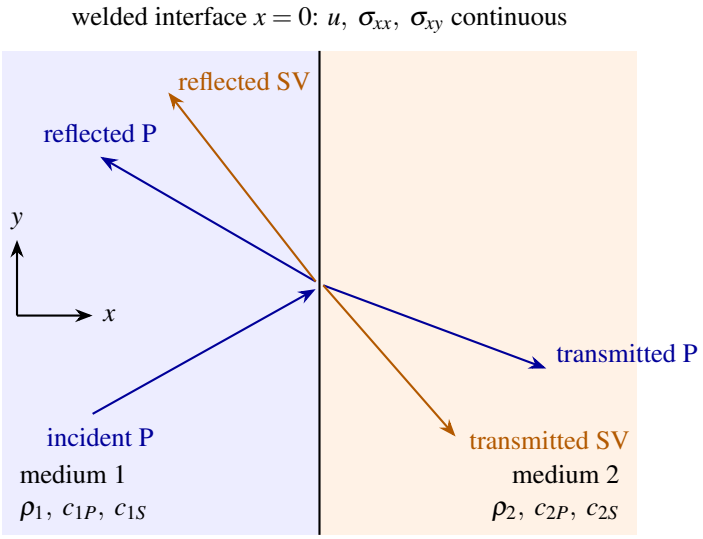



**Figure 29:** Original schematic; the setting follows [22]: welded elastic interface at normal/oblique incidence – reflected P/SV and transmitted P/SV waves; impedance mismatch controls the coefficients (70).

### 6.10.1 Welded elastic interface at normal incidence

Two elastic half-spaces with impedances $Z_j = \rho_j c_{1\,j}$ are perfectly bonded at $x = 0$. For a wave incident from medium 1, continuity of displacement and traction gives the displacement amplitudes

$$r = \frac{Z_1 - Z_2}{Z_1 + Z_2}, \qquad t = \frac{2Z_1}{Z_1 + Z_2}, \tag{70}$$

and the time-averaged energy fractions $\mathscr{R} = r^2$, $\mathscr{T} = 4Z_1Z_2/(Z_1+Z_2)^2$ satisfy $\mathscr{R} + \mathscr{T} = 1$ (Figure 30). The displacement transmission coefficient $t$ can reach two into a soft second medium without violating conservation; only the energy fractions are bounded.

### 6.10.2 Oblique incidence on an elastic interface

For oblique incidence of a P wave, Snell's law conserves the horizontal slowness $p = \sin\theta_1/c_{1,P} = \sin\phi_1/c_{1,S} = \sin\theta_2/c_{2,P} = \sin\phi_2/c_{2,S}$, and four waves are generated: reflected P and SV, transmitted P and SV. Continuity of $u_x, u_z, \sigma_{zz}, \sigma_{xz}$ gives four linear equations for the amplitudes, the Zoeppritz system. It was solved for a pair of media ($\rho_1, c_P, c_S = 2.5, 5.0, 2.8$ and $\rho_2, c_P, c_S = 3.0, 8.0, 4.5$ in arbitrary consistent units), with energy flux per wave $P_z = -\tfrac{1}{2}\,\mathrm{Re}(\sigma_{zj}\overline{\dot{u}_j})$. The sum of the four energy fractions equals one to rounding error ($|\mathrm{sum} - 1| < 2 \times 10^{-15}$ over $0.5°$–$89.5°$), and at normal incidence the P–P reflection fraction (0.099268) equals the impedance formula (0.099268). Figure 31(a) shows the expected features: a critical angle ($38.7°$ here) beyond which the transmitted P wave is evanescent and carries no energy, and a reflected P fraction that reaches total P reflection in the P–P channel only at grazing incidence, with mode conversion in between.

### 6.10.3 Thermoelastic interfaces

When both media are thermoelastic, two further wave types appear in each medium and the interface conditions include thermal continuity. For perfect thermal contact, $\theta$ and the normal

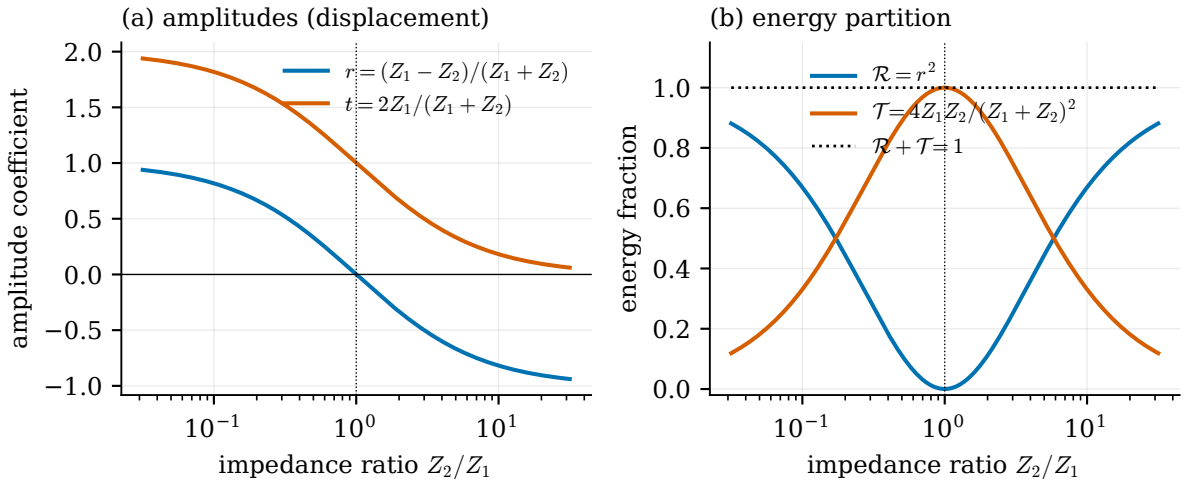



**Figure 30:** Normal incidence on a welded elastic interface. (a) Displacement reflection and transmission coefficients. (b) Energy fractions; $\mathscr{R} + \mathscr{T} = 1$ for every impedance ratio.

flux $q_n$ are continuous together with displacement and traction. In normal incidence there are four amplitudes (reflected elastic and thermal waves, transmitted elastic and thermal waves) and four equations. The case was implemented for two media that differ in density, wave speeds, heat capacities, conductivities, coupling constants and lag times, with Lord–Shulman conduction and an incident elastic-type wave; the amplitude ratios and the flux of each wave follow from (17). Two tests were run. (i) As $\varepsilon \to 0$ (here $\beta = 10^{-6}$) the reflected elastic energy fraction (0.169550173) equals the impedance formula $(Z_1 - Z_2)^2/(Z_1 + Z_2)^2$ to twelve digits. (ii) The *net* flux, from the total fields on either side of the interface, is continuous to $10^{-15}$ at every frequency tested.

Fractional and memory effects on wave reflection in pre-stressed microstructured solids with dual porosity were analysed by [297]; reflection of hygrothermal waves in a nonlocal theory of coupled thermo-elasticity was studied by [298].

**When does "energy fractions sum to one" hold?** The exact statement is item (ii): the net flux of (17) into the interface equals the net flux out of it, since the continuity conditions imply continuity of $\sigma\dot{u}$ and of $\theta q$. That is not the same as the *sum of the fluxes carried by each wave separately* equalling the incident flux. For homogeneous waves in lossless media the two statements coincide, because cross terms between distinct modes vanish in the time average, which is what the elastic checks above confirm numerically. In a dissipative medium, the modes have complex wavenumbers and the cross terms between, for example, the elastic-type and the thermal-type wave at the interface do not vanish, so

$$\sum_n \mathscr{F}_n \neq 1 \quad \text{in general, while} \quad \mathscr{F}_{\text{net}} \equiv 1. \tag{71}$$

Figure 31(b,c) shows an example: the sum of the four mode fractions is within 1.5 % of unity for $\omega \lesssim 2\omega_*$ but reaches 1.34 near $\omega \approx 8\omega_*$ and individual fractions can exceed one (the transmitted elastic fraction reaches 1.1). Energy conservation is not violated; the cross terms account for the difference. The consequence for published results is practical. A sum that deviates from unity can come from (a) a wrong coupling coefficient or boundary condition, (b) a flux definition inconsistent with the model, or (c) genuine interference of modes in a dissipative medium. The

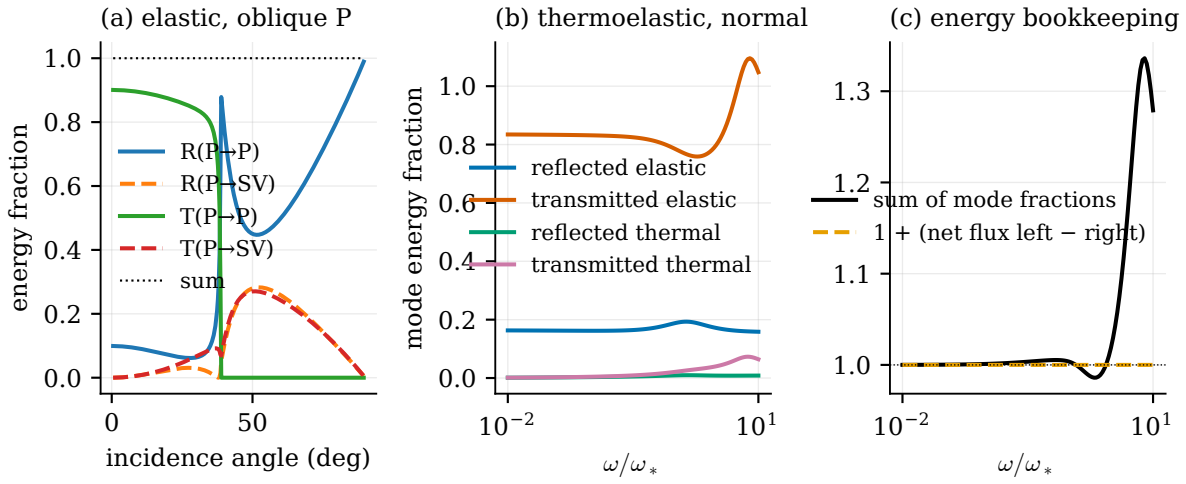



**Figure 31:** Energy partition at welded interfaces. (a) Oblique P incidence on an elastic–elastic interface: reflected and transmitted P and SV energy fractions; their sum is unity at every angle. (b) Normal incidence on a thermoelastic–thermoelastic interface with Lord–Shulman conduction ($\varepsilon_1 = 0.1$, $\beta_2^2 T_0 = 0.3$, i.e. $\varepsilon_2 = 0.065$, $\tau_{q1} = 0.25/\omega_*$, $\tau_{q2} = 0.15/\omega_*$): energy fractions of the four generated waves against frequency. (c) The sum of mode fractions deviates from unity at high frequency because of interference terms, while the net flux of (17) is continuous across the interface (dashed).

first two are errors and the third is not, so the correct check uses the net flux, or includes the interference terms, rather than the sum of mode fluxes. Studies that report energy ratios at thermoelastic and piezothermoelastic interfaces [94–97, 99–104] should be read with this point in mind: when the media are lossy, a unit sum of mode ratios is not a necessary condition and a failure of the sum to equal one is not by itself evidence of error.

### 6.10.4 Imperfect interfaces

Real interfaces are rarely perfect. The usual idealisation replaces continuity by spring conditions, with the traction continuous and proportional to the displacement jump, $\sigma = K_n[u]$ normal and $K_t[u_t]$ tangential; thermal imperfections add a contact resistance, $[\theta] = R_\theta q$, the Kapitza-type jump, and micropolar or piezoelectric media add analogous electric and rotational conditions. The limit $K \to \infty$ recovers the welded interface and $K \to 0$ a free surface. With thermal resistance the net flux of (17) is no longer continuous: the jump term $[\theta]q/T_0 = R_\theta q^2/T_0$ is the availability dissipation of the quadratic energy balance at the interface and must be included in it. It is not the entropy production, which to leading order in a small temperature jump is $q\,[\theta]/T_0^2 = R_\theta q^2/T_0^2$ per unit area and time and equals the dissipation divided by $T_0$; here $q$ is the common normal heat flux and $[\theta]$ the jump in the direction of $q$. Imperfect-interface wave problems have been treated for micropolar solids [108], piezoelectric composites [299, 300], and a fluid–double-porous thermoelastic interface [105].

### 6.10.5 Fluid–solid and multiphysics interfaces

When one medium is an ideal fluid the shear conditions change (no shear traction, tangential displacement discontinuous), and the energy ratios have been computed for fluid–piezothermoelastic and fluid–double-porous interfaces [98, 101, 105]. In piezoelectric media

electric boundary conditions (continuity of potential and of normal electric displacement, or an electrode condition) add two equations per interface; the reflection and refraction at elastic–magneto-thermoelastic diffusion solids with voids [106], micropolar piezothermoelastic half-spaces [107], functionally graded piezoelectric microstructures [109] and flexoelectric or flexomagnetic microstructures [92, 93] extend the same procedure. All of them share the structure of Sections 6.7 and this one: a linear system for the amplitudes, with entries fixed by the dispersion roots of each medium, and an energy flux defined consistently with the model.

### 6.10.6 A checklist for interface calculations

The checks below cost little and catch most errors in interface calculations:

1. Reduce the coupling to zero and compare with the elastic impedance formulas (normal incidence) or the Zoeppritz equations.
2. Verify the Snell invariants (horizontal slowness) for all generated waves, including evanescent ones.
3. Verify continuity of the net flux (17) (not of the sum of mode fluxes) across a perfect interface; for imperfect interfaces include the interface dissipation.
4. Test the boundary conditions independently: substitute the computed amplitudes back into each boundary equation.
5. For lagged and memory models, state the flux definition used for the energy ratio and whether interference terms are included.

**Summary**

At a welded elastic interface normal-incidence reflection/transmission follows from impedance $Z = \rho c_1$ with $\mathscr{R} + \mathscr{T} = 1$. Oblique incidence gives the Zoeppritz system with critical angles. Thermoelastic interfaces add thermal-type waves and the continuity of $\theta$ and $q_n$; the exact check is continuity of the net flux (17), not of the sum of mode fluxes—in lossy media the mode fractions need not sum to one because of interference terms.

## 6.11 Layered media: Love, Stoneley and Scholte waves

Rayleigh waves (Section 6.7) live on a single free surface. Two classical wave types need a *second* medium: Love waves, guided by a surface layer over a half-space, and Stoneley waves, guided by the interface of two half-spaces. Their isothermal elastic secular equations are given, checked against numbers printed in the original papers, and the way the heat law enters once thermal coupling is added is stated. Everything here is the $\varepsilon \to 0$ limit of the coupled problems catalogued in Appendix K; the coupled secular equations are not rederived.

**Love waves.** Let a layer $0 < z < T$ (shear speed $\beta_1$, rigidity $\mu_1$) rest on a half-space $z < 0$ ($\beta_2$, $\mu_2$), with a traction-free upper surface. For anti-plane motion $u_y \propto e^{\mathrm{i}k(x-ct)}$ the layer carries cos and sin solutions with transverse number $kq_1$, $q_1 = \sqrt{c^2/\beta_1^2 - 1}$, and the substrate carries a decaying exponential with $kq_2$, $q_2 = \sqrt{1 - c^2/\beta_2^2}$. Continuity of displacement and traction at $z = 0$ and the free surface at $z = T$ give

$$\tan\bigl(kT\,q_1\bigr) = \frac{\mu_2}{\mu_1}\,\frac{q_2}{q_1}, \qquad \beta_1 < c < \beta_2, \tag{72}$$

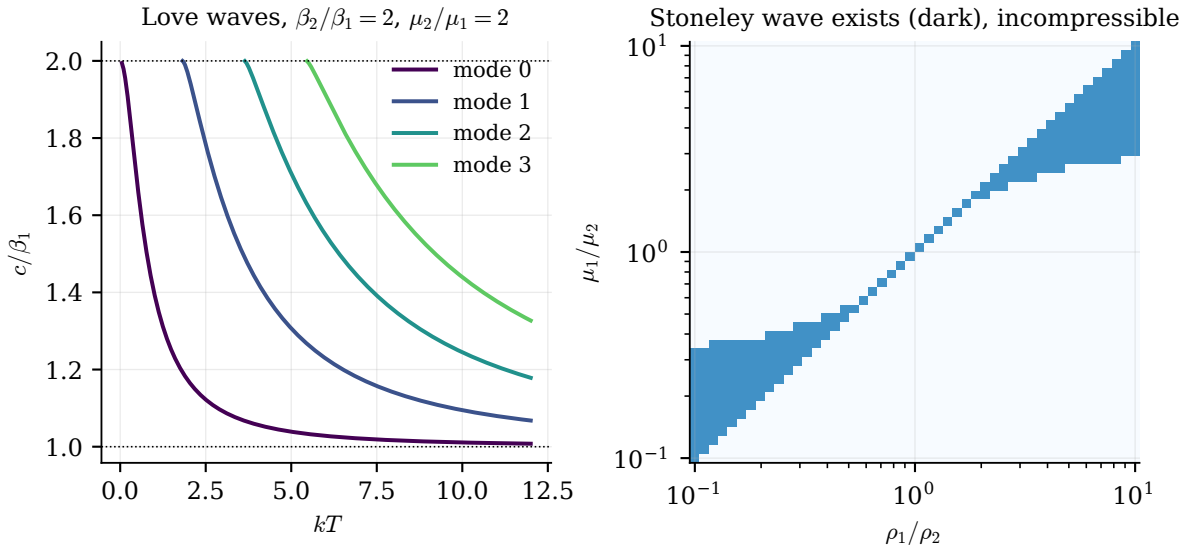



**Figure 32:** Left: Love-wave phase speed against $kT$ for a layer on a stiffer half-space; modes enter at $c = \beta_2$. Right: existence of a real Stoneley root for two incompressible half-spaces as a function of density and rigidity ratios (dark: one root). Isothermal elastic baseline; computed with layered-media figure.

which is Love's relation [301, eq. (40), p. 162]. Love states that the root cannot be real unless the substrate shear speed exceeds that of the layer, so a Love wave requires $\beta_2 > \beta_1$. Three properties follow from (72). (i) The $n$th mode appears at $c = \beta_2$ when $kT = n\pi/\sqrt{\beta_2^2/\beta_1^2 - 1}$ ($n = 0, 1, \ldots$), so the number of modes at a given $kT$ is the integer part of $kT\sqrt{\beta_2^2/\beta_1^2 - 1}/\pi$ plus one. (ii) The fundamental mode has $c \to \beta_2$ as $kT \to 0$ and $c \to \beta_1$ as $kT \to \infty$, decreasing monotonically. (iii) Dispersion is purely geometric: it is controlled by $kT$ and two ratios, with no intrinsic time scale. Figure 32(left) shows the first four modes for $\beta_2/\beta_1 = \mu_2/\mu_1 = 2$. The layered-media check confirms (i)–(iii) numerically (mode counts $1, 3, 12$ at $kT = 0.5, 5, 20$).

**Stoneley waves.** Two half-spaces are welded at $z = 0$; a wave $e^{\mathrm{i}k(x-ct)}$ decays into both. Each medium carries a dilatational and a shear potential decaying with $r_j = \sqrt{1 - c^2/\alpha_j^2}$ and $s_j = \sqrt{1 - c^2/\beta_j^2}$, so $c < \min(\beta_1, \beta_2)$ is necessary [302, pp. 422–423]. Continuity of the two displacement and two traction components gives a $4 \times 4$ determinant that must vanish [302, eq. (23), p. 418]. Stoneley notes that for $\alpha_1 = \alpha_2$ and $\beta_1 = \beta_2$ a root exists at every density ratio, and that existence is not general when the wave speeds differ strongly. The determinant was solved independently, in real form with $k = 1$. For incompressible media with $\rho_1 = 8.2$, $\rho_2 = 3.2$ and $\beta_1 = \beta_2$ it gives $c = 0.99287\,\beta$, the value printed by Stoneley (p. 422), and for $\rho_1 = 2\rho_2$, $\beta_2^2 = 2\beta_1^2$ it gives no real root, as printed (p. 423). For finite compressibility the root moves from $0.986\,\beta$ ($\alpha/\beta = 1.5$) to $0.9929\,\beta$ ($\alpha/\beta \to \infty$). Figure 32(right) maps the existence region for incompressible media; it is a band around the line $\mu_1/\mu_2 = \rho_1/\rho_2$ (equal shear speeds), widening toward large and small ratios.

**Scholte's range of existence.** Scholte determined, for Stoneley waves, the region of the $(\rho_1/\rho_2, \mu_1/\mu_2)$ plane in which a wave exists, bounded by two curves; Stoneley waves "can

exist for every value" of the ratios between them [303, p. 120]. He treated a layer on a half-space with $T/L$ as parameter, $L$ being the transverse wavelength in the layer, and states that a surface-wave system exists for every density ratio and every $T/L$ provided the shear speed $\beta$ exceeds a Rayleigh speed (p. 123); the exact boundary curves of the one- and two-system regions are on p. 126. The map in Fig. 32 reproduces the shape of that region only for incompressible media; Scholte's curves are not recomputed here. For a liquid on a solid the same determinant, with the liquid carrying only a dilatational potential and zero shear traction, gives a Scholte-type interface wave slower than both the liquid sound speed and the solid Rayleigh speed. Water (1480 m/s) on steel ($\rho = 7800\,\mathrm{kg/m^3}$, $\alpha = 5960$, $\beta = 3260\,\mathrm{m/s}$, handbook-type values) gives $c = 0.9997$ times the water speed; the number is computed here and not taken from the source.

**Anisotropy.** For bonded anisotropic half-spaces Barnett, Lothe, Gavazza and Musgrave write the existence condition as $\det \mathbf{A} = 0$ at a subsonic speed $v_s$, where $\mathbf{A}$ is the sum of the two surface-impedance matrices, a $3 \times 3$ Hermitian matrix [304, eq. (2.11), p. 156]. This is the anisotropic form of the determinant condition above.

**How the heat law enters.** In a thermoelastic layered problem each medium carries, besides the elastic partial waves, a thermal-type partial wave with $k_T^2 = -\rho c\, s/G(s)$ in the template of Section 3.3, and the interface conditions gain continuity of temperature and heat flux; the normal-incidence problem of Section 6.10 has this structure. The heat law therefore enters the layered dispersion only through $G(s)$ in the thermal root, and the admissibility test $\operatorname{Re} G(\mathrm{i}\omega) \geq 0$ of Section 3.3.7 applies to each medium separately. For piezoelectric media the analogous elastic baseline is the Bleustein–Gulyaev wave, with exact solutions for graded properties reported by Collet [305] (atlas entry A5). Coupled thermoelastic Love and Stoneley problems with specific heat laws are discussed in the sources of Appendix K; this review has not independently re-solved them.

**Table 10:** Elastic baseline: values computed here from the secular equations against values printed in the original papers. The columns of Rayleigh's table are identified with the Poisson ratios by their values.

| Quantity | Source | Printed | Computed here |
|---|---|---|---|
| Rayleigh speed, incompressible, $c/\beta$ | Rayleigh [290] | 0.9554 | 0.9553 |
| Rayleigh speed, Poisson ratio $1/4$ | Rayleigh [290] | 0.9194 | 0.9194 |
| Rayleigh speed, Poisson ratio 0 | Rayleigh [290] | 0.8741 | 0.8740 |
| Stoneley, $\rho_1 = 8.2$, $\rho_2 = 3.2$, $c/\beta$ | Stoneley [302] | 0.99287 | 0.99287 |
| Stoneley, $\rho_1 = 2\rho_2$, $\beta_2^2 = 2\beta_1^2$ | Stoneley [302] | no real root | no real root |

# 7. Multiphysics couplings

## 7.1 Coupling to further fields

Thermoelastic waves belong to a larger class: whenever another field is energetically coupled to deformation and temperature, the dispersion relation gains branches or renormalised constants, while the heat-flux law acts as an exchangeable module that leaves the coupling structure alone.

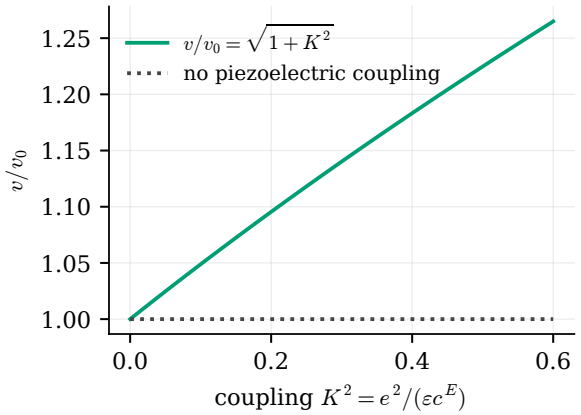



**Figure 33:** Piezoelectric stiffening of the longitudinal wave speed, (74).

Piezoelectric coupling is treated in detail, because it admits an exact reduction, and the other couplings are then surveyed at the level of structure.

### 7.1.1 Piezoelectric stiffening

Consider a one-dimensional piezoelectric bar in the quasi-electrostatic approximation, with $E = -\varphi_{,x}$ and the magnetic field neglected [306]. The constitutive relations are

$$\sigma = c\,u_{,x} - e\,E, \qquad D = \varepsilon_e E + e\,u_{,x}, \tag{73}$$

with elastic constant $c$ at constant field, piezoelectric constant $e$ and permittivity $\varepsilon_e$ at constant strain. Gauss's law $D_{,x} = 0$ (no free charge) gives $E = -(e/\varepsilon_e)u_{,x}$ up to a uniform field, so

$$\sigma = \Big(c + \frac{e^2}{\varepsilon_e}\Big)u_{,x}, \qquad v = \sqrt{\frac{c + e^2/\varepsilon_e}{\rho}} = v_0\sqrt{1+K^2}, \quad K^2 = \frac{e^2}{\varepsilon_e c}. \tag{74}$$

The electromechanical coupling constant $K^2$ runs from a fraction of a percent in weakly piezoelectric crystals to several tens of percent in strongly piezoelectric ceramics, so the stiffening of Figure 33 is large enough to matter in resonator design.

### 7.1.2 Thermopiezoelectric waves: exact renormalisation

With a pyroelectric coefficient $p$ the relations extend to

$$\sigma = c u_{,x} - eE - \beta\theta, \qquad D = e u_{,x} + \varepsilon_e E + p\theta, \qquad \rho\eta = \beta u_{,x} + pE + \frac{\rho c_E}{T_0}\theta, \tag{75}$$

the last being the entropy; the pyroelectric and thermal-stress coefficients enter symmetrically, as the existence of a thermodynamic potential requires [11, 12, 78]. Eliminating $E$ through $D_{,x} = 0$ leaves a purely thermoelastic system with the renormalised constants

$$\tilde{c} = c + \frac{e^2}{\varepsilon_e}, \qquad \tilde{\beta} = \beta - \frac{ep}{\varepsilon_e}, \qquad \rho\tilde{c}_v = \rho c_E - \frac{T_0 p^2}{\varepsilon_e}, \tag{76}$$

and therefore all results of Sections 4.1–4.3 hold with $c_1^2 \to \tilde{c}/\rho$, $\beta \to \tilde{\beta}$, $c \to \tilde{c}_v$ in the definitions of $\varepsilon$ and $\omega_*$. The reduction was verified symbolically, computing the $3\times 3$ determinant of

the coupled system in $(u, \theta, \varphi)$ and comparing it with the renormalised thermoelastic polynomial: their ratio is a constant factor independent of every material parameter except the trivial scaling of the Gauss equation (thermopiezoelectric check). Three observations follow. (i) The piezoelectric stiffening raises the isothermal speed by $\sqrt{1+K^2}$ and therefore changes $\omega_*$ and $\varepsilon$. (ii) The product $ep$ enters $\tilde{\beta}$ with a sign: according to orientation and conventions, the pyroelectric effect can *reduce* or *raise* the thermal stress, and because the sign conventions for $e$ and $p$ differ across the literature, any reported pyroelectric effect should come with a statement of conventions [306]. (iii) The heat capacity under zero electric displacement ($D = 0$) is smaller than under zero field, by $T_0 p^2/\varepsilon_e$, the electric analogue of the difference between adiabatic and isothermal elasticity.

**Limits of the quasi-electrostatic model.** The model carries no electromagnetic branch. It holds when elastic wave speeds are much smaller than the speed of light and the wavelength is well below the electromagnetic wavelength at the same frequency, which is true of acoustic waves in every practical piezoelectric solid, but it excludes polaritons and fully dynamic electromagnetic coupling.

**Extensions in the literature.** Piezothermoelastic waves with memory and fractional heat laws, semiconductor effects (photo-excited carriers and plasma waves), nonlocal piezoelasticity and surface effects, flexoelectric microstructure, and functionally graded or viscous variants have been treated in a large body of work [91, 92, 103, 104, 109, 117, 129, 130, 132, 193, 253, 307]. The structural point of (76) survives in every setting that remains one-dimensional or plane-wave: coupling to the electric field without free charge is an exact renormalisation, and a genuinely new branch appears only once carriers (semiconductors) or higher electric moments (flexoelectricity) enter.

Three-phase-lag thermoelastic heat conduction with higher-order time-fractional derivatives was proposed by [308]; generalized thermoelasticity based on higher-order memory-dependent derivative with time delay was developed by [309]. Memory-dependent and fractional order analysis of the initially stressed piezo-thermoelastic medium was presented by [310]; electro-thermoelasticity theory with memory-dependent derivative heat transfer was formulated by [179]. Photo-thermo-piezo-elastic waves in semiconductor medium subject to distinct two temperature models were studied by [311]; quasi-P wave through orthotropic piezo-thermoelastic materials subject to higher order fractional and memory-dependent effects was analysed by [312]. Theory of two-temperature thermoelasticity without energy dissipation was given by [313]; two-temperature thermoelasticity without energy dissipation of Green–Naghdi model was studied by [314].

### 7.1.3 Magneto-thermoelasticity

For a perfectly conducting solid in a uniform magnetic field $\boldsymbol{H}_0$, the Lorentz force $\mu_0 \boldsymbol{J} \times \boldsymbol{H}_0$ acts as an additional body force. For a longitudinal wave along $x$ with $\boldsymbol{H}_0$ perpendicular to the propagation direction and the displacement along the propagation direction, $h = -H_0 u_{,x}$, $J = -h_{,x}$ and the force is $\mu_0 H_0^2 u_{,xx}$, so that $\rho \ddot{u} = (\lambda + 2\mu + \mu_0 H_0^2) u_{,xx} - \beta \theta_{,x}$. The magnetic field thus adds the Alfvén term to the stiffness, $c_1^2 \to c_1^2 + v_A^2$ with $v_A^2 = \mu_0 H_0^2/\rho$, and the dispersion polynomial (33) holds with that substitution. Finite electrical conductivity and displacement current add a magnetic diffusion branch and a further coupling that depends on the

conductivity [58, 106, 112, 115, 315, 316]; the fractional-order heat-conduction law in magneto-thermoelasticity of [58] is a standard reference. Magneto-electro-thermo-elastic solutions for transversely isotropic media are given in [317]; modified fractional-order piezoelectric thermoelasticity models appear in [318, 319].

### 7.1.4 Thermoelastic diffusion and chemical coupling

When a diffusing species is present, the concentration $C$ and chemical potential add a third field: the stress contains a term proportional to $C$, the energy balance a term proportional to $\dot{C}$ and the species balance a diffusive flux coupled to temperature. The dispersion polynomial becomes cubic in $K$ and a third, diffusive branch appears, with decay governed by the mass diffusivity. Higher-order and multi-lag diffusion models have been proposed [119], and reflection at interfaces with magneto-thermoelastic diffusion solids with voids has been computed [106].

### 7.1.5 Microstructure: micropolar, voids and porosity

Micropolar elasticity [13, 73, 74] adds microrotation as an independent field. In the isotropic case the dilatational wave is accompanied by a longitudinal wave of modified speed, the transverse waves couple to microrotation waves, and the rotational waves have a cut-off frequency. Materials with voids add an independent volume-fraction field [75–77] and one extra dilatational wave [76]; thermal coupling is introduced in [77]; poro-thermoelasticity and double porosity add slow dilatational waves associated with pore fluid pressure [102, 105, 320]. Fractional-order thermoelasticity with voids, micropolar fractional models and two-temperature versions have been studied [81, 88, 107, 125, 321, 322]. Each microstructural field adds branches that appear as new roots of the characteristic equation; whether they are physically observable depends on the microinertia and the coupling coefficients, which are usually assigned values with limited experimental support.

### 7.1.6 Table of couplings

**Summary**

Adding a field energetically coupled to deformation and temperature renormalises constants and/or adds branches. Piezoelectric stiffening with no free charge is an exact reduction ($c \to c + e^2/\varepsilon_e$, $\beta, c_v$ renormalised). Magnetic field adds the Alfvén term; diffusion adds a branch; voids and micropolarity add extra waves. All such couplings share the same dispersion-polynomial structure: solve the coupled system, then read speeds and damping from its roots.

## 7.2 Piezoelectric shear-horizontal surface waves

The thermopiezoelectric coupling of Section 7.1 changes bulk stiffness, and piezoelectric media also carry surface waves with no elastic counterpart. The simplest is the Bleustein–Gulyaev (BG) wave [323, 324], a shear-horizontal (SH) wave localised at the surface of a hexagonal (6mm) crystal. It is included as the prototype of electromechanical surface localisation, and because its closed form states cleanly how the electrical boundary condition enters.

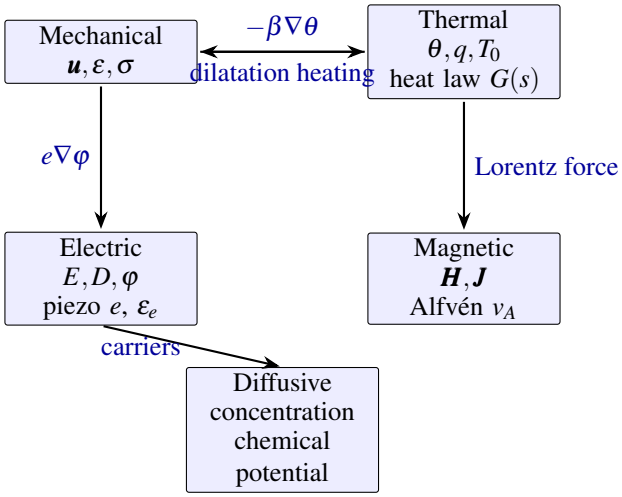



**Figure 34:** Original schematic; the setting follows [12, 78]: multiphysics coupling – each added field renormalises constants and/or adds branches; with no free charge the piezo-electric effect is an exact stiffening renormalisation.

### 7.2.1 Formulation

Let the half-space $y > 0$ be a 6mm crystal with the polar axis along $z$ and motion $u_z(x, y, t)$ polarised along $z$, with wave number $k$ along $x$. The relevant constants are the shear stiffness $c_{44}$, piezoelectric constant $e_{15}$ and permittivity $\varepsilon$, combined in $K^2 = e_{15}^2/(c_{44}\varepsilon)$ and the stiffened modulus $\bar{c} = c_{44}(1 + K^2)$ with bulk speed $\bar{v} = \sqrt{\bar{c}/\rho}$. In the quasi-static approximation the fields are $u = A\,e^{-my}$ and $\varphi = (e_{15}/\varepsilon)\,u + B\,e^{-ky}$, with $m = k\sqrt{1 - v^2/\bar{v}^2}$, and in the vacuum $y < 0$ the potential is $\varphi = C\,e^{ky}$. The boundary conditions at $y = 0$ are a free surface $\sigma_{yz} = c_{44}u_{,y} + e_{15}\varphi_{,y} = 0$ together with either of the following:

- *metallised surface*, $\varphi = 0$;
- *free (unmetallised) surface*, continuity of $\varphi$ and of $D_y$ across the interface with vacuum permittivity $\varepsilon_0$.

### 7.2.2 Results

Eliminating the amplitudes gives

$$\frac{m}{k} = \frac{K^2}{1 + K^2} \quad \text{(metallised)}, \qquad \frac{m}{k} = \frac{\varepsilon_0}{\varepsilon + \varepsilon_0}\,\frac{K^2}{1 + K^2} \quad \text{(free)}, \tag{77}$$

so that the surface wave speed is $v = \bar{v}\sqrt{1 - (m_*/k)^2}$ with $m_*/k$ from Eq. (77). The roots of the $3 \times 3$ secular determinant agree with these forms to the digits quoted (Bleustein–Gulyaev check). For $K^2 = 0.2$, $\bar{v} = 1.0954\,v_t$ (with $v_t = \sqrt{c_{44}/\rho}$), the metallised speed is $1.0801\,v_t$, i.e. 1.4% below $\bar{v}$, while for the free surface $v = 1.0954$, $1.0953$ and $1.0916\,v_t$ for $\varepsilon_0/\varepsilon = 0.01, 0.1$ and 1. For $K^2 = 0.5$ the metallised value is $1.1547\,v_t$ against $\bar{v} = 1.2247\,v_t$.

Two consequences follow. The shift between free and metallised speeds, the usual electromechanical coupling measure of a surface wave, is of order $K^4$ and hence small when $K^2$ is small. The decay length $1/m$ is far more sensitive to the electrical condition: for $K^2 = 0.2$ it is about $1/k \cdot 6$, roughly one wavelength, when metallised, against about $600/k$, roughly 100 wavelengths, for a free surface with $\varepsilon_0/\varepsilon = 0.01$. A plate a few wavelengths thick therefore does not support the free-surface BG wave as a surface wave in any strict sense.

**Table 11:** Added fields and their effect on the plane-wave problem (structure only; $\Delta n$ is the increase in the number of branches in one-dimensional dilatational motion).

| Added field | Principal effect on waves | $\Delta n$ | Remarks |
|---|---|---|---|
| Electric (quasi-static, no free charge) | stiffness $c \to c + e^2/\varepsilon_e$; $\beta$, $c_v$ renormalised | 0 | Exact reduction, Eq. (76). |
| Electric with carriers (semiconductor) | plasma / diffusive branch | $+1$ | Photo-thermo-elastic and piezo-semiconductor models. |
| Magnetic (perfect conductor) | stiffness $c_1^2 \to c_1^2 + v_A^2$ | 0 | Finite conductivity adds a diffusion branch. |
| Concentration (diffusion) | third diffusive branch | $+1$ | Coupling to temperature through the chemical potential. |
| Voids / porosity | extra dilatational wave(s) | $+1$ (single) $+2$ (double) | Slow waves, strong damping. |
| Microrotation (micropolar) | rotational waves with cut-off | transverse | Longitudinal speed modified. |
| Two temperatures | wavenumber-dependent $\theta$ vs. $\varphi$ | 0 | Acts like a length scale. |

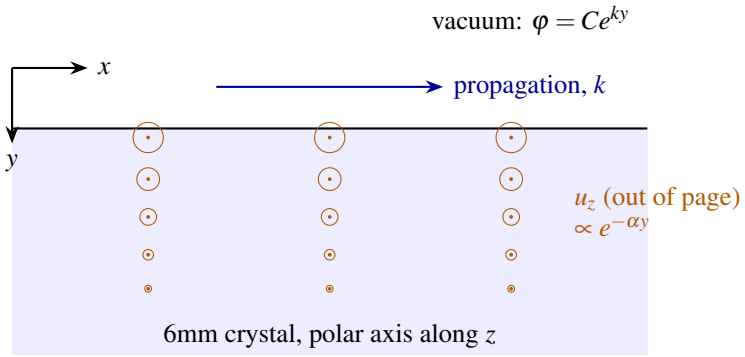



**Figure 35:** Geometry: Bleustein–Gulyaev SH surface wave – particle motion along $z$, localised at the surface $y = 0$ of a 6mm piezoelectric half-space; electrical boundary condition (metallised/free) controls decay length.

Rayleigh-type waves in nonlocal micropolar thermoelastic half-space containing void pores were computed by [325]; temperature-rate-dependent thermoelasticity theory with memory-dependent derivative, including energy and uniqueness theorems, was developed by [326].

### 7.2.3 Thermal coupling

For this SH polarisation with uniform fields in $z$ the shear strains $\varepsilon_{xz}, \varepsilon_{yz}$ do not couple to the (diagonal) thermal-stress tensor of a hexagonal crystal, and the pyroelectric coupling acts along the polar axis $z$, which is perpendicular to the in-plane electric field. The BG wave is therefore not coupled to temperature in this geometry, and thermal effects enter only through the temperature dependence of $c_{44}$, $e_{15}$ and $\varepsilon$, which shifts the speed without introducing a loss. Coupled thermo-piezoelectric surface waves exist for other cuts and polarisations, where the

sagittal-plane motion has a dilatational component, and for those the Rayleigh-type determinant of Section 6.7 has to be extended by the electrical conditions.

**Summary**

The Bleustein–Gulyaev SH surface wave has no elastic analogue. Its speed is $v = \bar{v}\sqrt{1-(m/k)^2}$ with $\bar{v} = v_t\sqrt{1+K^2}$, and the decay exponent $m/k$ is $K^2/(1+K^2)$ (metallised) or scaled by $\varepsilon_0/(\varepsilon+\varepsilon_0)$ (free surface). For $K^2 = 0.2$ the shift is 1.4% below $\bar{v}$ metallised; the free-surface decay length can reach $\sim 100$ wavelengths. Not thermally coupled in this geometry.

# 8. Methods, benchmarks and worked examples

## 8.1 Solution methods and verification

### 8.1.1 Analytical methods

For linear problems with constant coefficients the classical tools of elasticity and heat conduction carry over, with only the algebra changed by the coupling.

- **Plane-wave and normal-mode analysis.** For unbounded or periodic media, (33) gives complete frequency-domain information. Real frequency with complex wavenumber describes spatial decay under steady excitation; real wavenumber with complex frequency describes temporal decay of a free disturbance. The two attenuation measures coincide only for weak damping ($Q^{-1} \ll 1$), and the relation involves the group velocity: $\operatorname{Im}\omega \approx -v_g \operatorname{Im} k$. Comparing an experiment against the wrong measure is a common source of apparent inconsistency.
- **Integral transforms.** For half-spaces, layers and cylinders, Laplace transformation in time and Fourier (or Hankel) transformation in space reduce the problem to ordinary differential equations with exponential solutions, as in Sections 6.4 and 6.7. Carrying the heat-flux law as the function $G(s)$ lets one derivation serve the whole template.
- **Potential methods and eigenfunction expansion.** Helmholtz potentials decouple shear from dilatation in the bulk, and eigenfunction expansion in the transform domain is often used for finite domains [111].
- **Wavefront expansions.** Discontinuities propagate along characteristics determined by the high-frequency limit; (37) is an example. Jump amplitudes follow transport equations along the front and decay exponentially in LS-type theories.

### 8.1.2 Numerical inversion of Laplace transforms

Closed forms in the transform domain are typically inverted numerically. The commonly used algorithms are the Stehfest method [327], Durbin's Fourier-series method [328] (and the closely related method of Dubner and Abate [329]), the Honig–Hirdes method [330], and contour-deformation methods such as Talbot's [280]; Abate and Whitt [331] review the common framework. Applications to thermoelastic problems often report numbers from one of these methods without a check, so four implementations (Talbot, Stehfest, de Hoog et al. [332], and Cohen acceleration [333], as implemented in a standard multiprecision library with default parameters at 15 digits) were benchmarked on four transforms with known inverses, chosen to represent the features of thermoelastic responses: a smooth decay, an oscillation, a discontinuous step with a

delay, and a diffusive response (Table 12). Four points deserve recording. (i) For smooth and

**Table 12:** Maximum absolute error of four numerical Laplace inversion methods on test transforms (evaluated at $t = 0.5, 2, 5, 10$; for the step at $t = 0.5, 0.95, 1.05, 2, 5$). Default parameters, 15 digits. "$4 \times 10^{193}$" indicates a numerical blow-up.

| Test function | Talbot | Stehfest | de Hoog | Cohen |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| smooth: $1/(s+1)^2$ | 6.9e−18 | 7.1e−13 | 9.8e−18 | 6.9e−18 |
| oscillatory: $1/\sqrt{s^2+1}$ | 3.9e−2 | 6.6e−4 | 3.6e−16 | 6.1e−16 |
| step: $e^{-s}/s$ | 3.8e193 | 1.8e−1 | 1.4e−6 | 1.8e−1 |
| diffusive: $e^{-\sqrt{s}}/s$ | 1.1e−16 | 5.5e−14 | 1.1e−16 | 1.1e−16 |

diffusive responses all four methods are essentially exact ($< 10^{-12}$), which is why published diffusion-dominated results rarely depend on the method. (ii) For the step with a delay, Talbot's method *fails catastrophically* at times before the delay ($t = 0.95 < 1$): its contour, which extends into the left half-plane, is multiplied by $e^{-s}$ and grows without bound. This is exactly the situation of a Cattaneo front, whose transform contains $e^{-x/c_T \cdot s}$. Section 6.4 handles this by setting the solution to zero ahead of the known front and inverting only for $t > x/c_T$. (iii) Stehfest and Cohen err by order 0.2 near the discontinuity, smearing the front and ringing, whereas de Hoog gives $1.4 \times 10^{-6}$ at the tested points. (iv) For oscillatory functions the default Talbot setting is inadequate at $t = 10$, with error 0.04, while de Hoog and Cohen stay accurate. All methods can be tuned, through the number of terms or the contour parameter, so the table ranks nothing; its message is that the choice and the checks matter. The recommendation is to invert with two independent methods, to compare against a known limit, and to treat results near discontinuities as unreliable beyond the known front position.

### 8.1.3 Time-domain numerics

For problems that do not admit transform solutions (heterogeneous, nonlinear, complex geometry) finite-element and finite-difference methods in space and time are used. Two issues belong to hyperbolic thermal models. Schemes built for parabolic heat equations, implicit and numerically dissipative, smear the thermal front and so cannot represent the finite-speed effect that motivates the model; explicit or high-resolution schemes with controlled dissipation are the appropriate choice, as are space–time discontinuous Galerkin formulations. Second, the time step must resolve the relaxation time ($\Delta t \ll \tau_q$) and meet a Courant–Friedrichs–Lewy (CFL) condition set by the *largest* wave speed, $\max(c_1, c_T)$ and not $c_1$: when $c_T \gg c_1$, as in many metals, the thermal front governs the stability bound. Memory-dependent and fractional operators need stored history and, without optimisation, cost $O(N^2)$ in the number of time steps; short-memory approximations and fast convolution cut this down, and should come with an error estimate. Finite-element implementations with memory-dependent heat transfer in fibre-reinforced cylinders [113] and rotating nano-beams [114] illustrate the approach.

### 8.1.4 A verification discipline

The checks below catch most errors in new thermoelastic wave calculations, and it is recommended that papers say which they performed.

1. **Reduce to a known limit**: set the coupling to zero (elastic and thermal problems separately), and set the lags to zero (Fourier).
2. **Check the dispersion relation symbolically** against the field equations, as in Appendix B; sign and factor errors in the coupling terms are detected immediately.
3. **Check energy**: for conservative members of the family (GN-II) the energy is constant; for the others, the energy balance (16) must hold with the stated dissipation; for interfaces, the net flux must be continuous (Section 6.10).
4. **Check high- and low-frequency asymptotics**: adiabatic and isothermal speeds, front speeds (e.g. (37)), classical diffusive scaling.
5. **Check branches**: track roots by continuity and ensure that Taylor truncation has not introduced spurious roots.
6. **Report dimensionless groups**: $\varepsilon$, $\omega/\omega_*$, $\omega\tau$, $c_T/c_1$, $\xi\omega/c_1$, so that results can be compared across studies.

**Summary**

Solution methods: analytical separation for simple geometries, Laplace/Fourier inversion for transients, numerical root finding for dispersion and secular equations. Verification discipline: reduce to the elastic limit, check Snell invariants, verify net-flux continuity (not mode-flux sums), test boundary conditions by substitution, state the flux definition for lagged and memory models. Report dimensionless groups $\varepsilon$, $\omega/\omega_*$, $\omega\tau$, $c_T/c_1$, $\xi\omega/c_1$ for comparability.

## 8.2 A finite-difference benchmark for hyperbolic heat conduction

Hyperbolic heat laws are usually validated in the time domain against a smooth test problem, which hides the real difficulty: a front that the scheme has to carry without spurious oscillation or excessive smearing. A small benchmark with an exact solution is given, and what three standard schemes achieve is reported.

### 8.2.1 Problem

The uncoupled Cattaneo system in first-order form,

$$\rho c\,\theta_t + q_x = 0, \qquad \tau\,q_t + q = -k\,\theta_x, \tag{78}$$

on $x > 0$ with $\theta = q = 0$ initially and $q(0,t) = q_0 H(t)$, is solved in units $\rho c = k = \tau = q_0 = 1$, so $c_T = 1$ and the front is at $x = t$. The exact solution is the inverse Laplace transform of Eq. (61), taken as zero ahead of the front. At $t = 5$ it gives $\theta = 1.7615,\ 0.5923,\ 0.0959$ at $x = 1, 3, 4.9$ and the jump at the front is $q_0 e^{-x/2\ell}/(\rho c c_T) = e^{-2.5} = 0.082$.

### 8.2.2 Schemes

The system is advanced by Strang splitting. The source $-q/\tau$ is integrated exactly over half steps, and the hyperbolic part (characteristic speeds $\pm c_T$) by one of three schemes: (i) Lax–Friedrichs, (ii) first-order upwind on the characteristic variables, (iii) second-order Lax–Wendroff. All three run at Courant number 0.9, and the boundary value $q = q_0$ enters through a ghost cell. The code is in finite-difference benchmark.

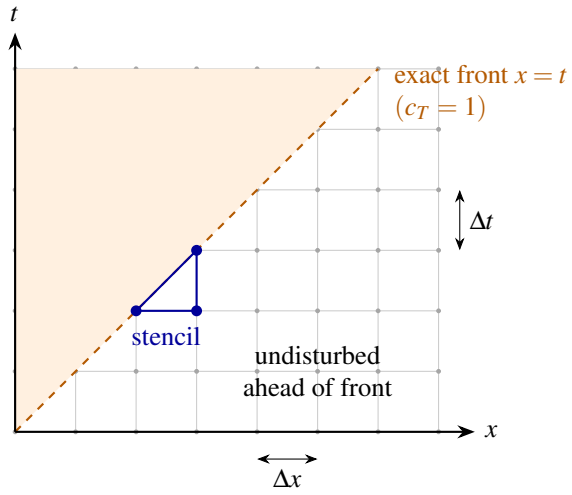



**Figure 36:** Original schematic; the setting follows [35]: finite-difference benchmark for hyperbolic heat conduction – the front at $x = t$ must be carried without smearing or oscillation; error measured in a window around and away from the front.

### 8.2.3 Results

Errors are $L^1$ norms over the sampled interval at $t = 5$. Over $0.05 \le x \le 4.95$, which contains the front, the observed orders between $N = 800$ and 1600 cells are 0.85 for Lax–Friedrichs, 0.94 for upwind and 0.58 for Lax–Wendroff, with errors at $N = 1600$ of $2.7 \times 10^{-3}$, $1.3 \times 10^{-3}$ and $8.6 \times 10^{-4}$. Away from the front ($0.05 \le x \le 3.5$) the picture changes:

| $N$ | 100 | 200 | 400 | 800 | 1600 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| upwind $L^1$ | $9.6 \times 10^{-3}$ | $4.3 \times 10^{-3}$ | $2.1 \times 10^{-3}$ | $1.1 \times 10^{-3}$ | $5.3 \times 10^{-4}$ |
| Lax–Wendroff $L^1$ | $1.1 \times 10^{-3}$ | $2.7 \times 10^{-4}$ | $6.1 \times 10^{-5}$ | $1.5 \times 10^{-5}$ | $3.8 \times 10^{-6}$ |

with observed orders 1.0 for the upwind scheme and 2.0 for Lax–Wendroff in the smooth region. Formal accuracy is reached away from the front, and the neighbourhood of the discontinuity controls the global error, where all three schemes converge at an order below one. A single global error norm therefore says little about how a scheme carries a front, and a benchmark for hyperbolic heat conduction should report the error around the front separately from the error away from it.

A domain of influence theorem for generalized thermoelasticity with memory-dependent derivative was proved by [334].

### 8.2.4 A caution about the reference solution

The exact solution above was obtained by numerical Laplace inversion, and the choice of inversion algorithm matters at the accuracy required here. At $x = 1$, $t = 5$ the Talbot method with default settings gave 1.76126 at 30 working digits and 1.76086 at 20 digits, whereas the de Hoog and Stehfest methods give 1.761515 and 1.761516 at 20 digits; the finite-difference solution at $N = 800$ agrees with the latter to $2 \times 10^{-6}$. A reference solution with an error of $3 \times 10^{-4}$ or more would have hidden the second-order convergence of Lax–Wendroff at $N \gtrsim 400$. Inversion results used as benchmarks should be cross-checked with a second algorithm (Section 8.1.2).

**Summary**

The Cattaneo benchmark has an exact front at $x = t$ (in units $c_T = 1$). Lax–Friedrichs, upwind and Lax–Wendroff all converge below order one globally because of the discontinuity; away from the front the orders are 1.0 and 2.0 respectively. Report front-window and smooth-window errors separately, and cross-check Laplace-inversion reference solutions with a second algorithm.

## 8.3 Worked examples

Four practical questions show how the results of the review are used. All numbers come from the rounded handbook inputs of Table 3 at $T_0 = 300$ K (worked-example calculation); they illustrate the procedure and should be redone with measured parameters for a specific specimen.

### 8.3.1 Example 1: Does a lag law matter for ultrasound in aluminium?

**Question.** A 1 GHz longitudinal wave propagates in aluminium; should a Cattaneo (Lord–Shulman) law with $\tau_q = 1$ ps be used instead of Fourier's law?

**Step 1: characteristic numbers.** From Table 3: $c_1 = 6198$ m/s, $\varepsilon = 0.027$, $\omega_* = \rho c c_1^2/k = 3.94 \times 10^{11}$ rad/s. The lag enters through $\tau_q \omega_* = 0.39$, so the thermal front speed $c_T = \sqrt{k/(\rho c \tau_q)} = 9.9$ km/s is $1.6\, c_1$.

**Step 2: where the wave sits on the dispersion curves.** At 1 GHz the frequency ratio is $\omega/\omega_* = 1.6 \times 10^{-2}$ and $\omega\tau_q = 6.3 \times 10^{-3}$. The Debye loss of Eq. (34) is $Q^{-1} = \varepsilon x/(1+x^2) = 4.3 \times 10^{-4}$ with $x = \omega/\omega_*$; at 1 MHz it is $4.3 \times 10^{-7}$.

**Step 3: what the lag changes.** The lag modifies the response through $\omega\tau_q$. By the truncation analysis of Section 4.4 the corrections to the thermal branch are at the $10^{-4}$ level or below for $\omega\tau_q \sim 6 \times 10^{-3}$ (the first-order relative error scales as $(\omega\tau)^2/4$), so the Fourier result is adequate. The lag would matter only at frequencies of order $\omega_*$ and above, tens of GHz, where the phonon mean free path is comparable with the wavelength and the kinetic closure of Section 3.4 no longer holds.

**Conclusion.** For ultrasonic and MHz–GHz work in aluminium the parabolic (Biot) theory is the right model; a lag law adds parameters and no accuracy.

### 8.3.2 Example 2: Thermoelastic damping of a silicon nanobeam

**Question.** At which frequency does the thermoelastic loss peak for a silicon beam of thickness $h$, and how large is it?

**Step 1.** The diffusivity is $\chi = k/\rho c = 9.2 \times 10^{-5}$ m$^2$/s. The Zener frequency is $f_Z = \pi\chi/(2h^2)$, which gives $1.4 \times 10^6$ Hz for $h = 10\,\mu$m, $1.4 \times 10^8$ Hz for $1\,\mu$m, $1.4 \times 10^{10}$ Hz for 100 nm and $3.6 \times 10^9$ Hz for $h = 200$ nm (a value in between).

**Step 2.** The relaxation strength is $\Delta = E\alpha_T^2 T_0/c_v = 2.0 \times 10^{-4}$, so the peak loss is $Q_{\max}^{-1} \approx 0.494\,\Delta \approx 1.0 \times 10^{-4}$ (Section 6.9). This corresponds to a quality factor limit of about $10^4$ at the peak, which is a significant limit for sub-micron resonators with intrinsic $Q$ above $10^4$.

**Step 3: check validity.** A micron-size silicon beam at $f_Z \sim 10^8$ Hz has $\omega\tau_q \sim 10^{-3}$ for $\tau_q \sim 1$ ps, so a lag law is not required. For $h \lesssim 100$ nm, bulk values of $k$ are no longer reliable because the

phonon mean free path in silicon at room temperature (hundreds of nanometres) exceeds the thickness, and the Guyer–Krumhansl or kinetic description (Section 3.4) is the relevant model, with a thickness-dependent effective conductivity as input.

### 8.3.3 Example 3: Energy partition at an aluminium–copper interface

**Question.** What fraction of a normally incident longitudinal wave in aluminium is reflected at a welded copper interface (elastic limit)?

The impedances are $Z_1 = \rho c_1 = 1.67 \times 10^7$ and $Z_2 = 4.07 \times 10^7\,\mathrm{kg\,m^{-2}s^{-1}}$ (aluminium, copper). Then $r = (Z_1 - Z_2)/(Z_1 + Z_2) = -0.417$, $t = 2Z_1/(Z_1 + Z_2) = 0.583$, $R = r^2 = 0.174$ and $T = (Z_2/Z_1)t^2 = 0.826$, with $R + T = 1$ to four digits. The sign of $r$ shows a phase reversal of the reflected displacement wave (impedance increases). When thermal coupling is included, the reflected and transmitted amplitudes acquire corrections of order $\varepsilon$ and additional thermal waves are generated; the energy bookkeeping must use the net-flux conservation of Section 6.10, not the sum of mode-wise energy fractions.

### 8.3.4 Example 4: Is a heat pulse in steel hyperbolic?

**Question.** A surface of steel is heated at $t = 0$. After how long does the Fourier and the Cattaneo solution differ, and by how much in position?

For steel $\chi = 1.3 \times 10^{-5}\,\mathrm{m^2/s}$. The Fourier diffusion length is $\sqrt{\chi t} = 1.1 \times 10^{-7}\,\mathrm{m}$ at $t = 1\,\mathrm{ns}$ and $3.6 \times 10^{-6}\,\mathrm{m}$ at $1\,\mu\mathrm{s}$. The Cattaneo front speed for $\tau_q = 1\,\mathrm{ps}$ is $\sqrt{\chi/\tau_q} = 3.6\,\mathrm{km/s}$, so the front has travelled only $3.6 \times 10^{-9}\,\mathrm{m}$ in one lag time. The two solutions therefore differ only for $t \lesssim$ a few $\tau_q$, within a few nanometres of the surface, where continuum theory and a bulk $k$ are already doubtful. Resolving the difference needs a time resolution well below a picosecond, so such an experiment requires ultrashort-pulse heating and detection.

### 8.3.5 Lessons

(i) Compute $\omega_*$, $\varepsilon$ and $\omega\tau_q$ before choosing a model; the regime map of Section 10.1 shows at a glance whether lag effects can matter. (ii) For devices below about 100 nm the first deviation from the Fourier picture is size-related, not lag-related. (iii) The elastic interface calculation is a necessary baseline for the thermoelastic one.

**Summary**

Worked examples: (i) compute $\omega_*, \varepsilon, \omega\tau_q$ before choosing a model; (ii) below $\sim 100\,\mathrm{nm}$ the first deviation from Fourier is size-related, not lag-related; (iii) the elastic interface calculation is the necessary baseline. The scripts reproduce every number: dispersion roots, damping curves, Rayleigh speeds, interface energy fractions, flexural damping.

# 9. Applications and the evidence base

## 9.1 Applications by field

The theories reviewed here serve four broad application areas. For each, the relevant regime of parameter space is stated, using the characteristic numbers derived above.

### 9.1.1 Laser ultrasonics and short-pulse heating

Laser-generated ultrasound uses the thermal stress of pulsed heating to generate elastic waves [335]. For nanosecond pulses on bulk metals $\omega\tau_q \ll 1$, the classical coupled theory with surface heating suffices, and the thermal diffusion length over the pulse, $\sqrt{\alpha t_p}$, sets the source depth. For femtosecond–picosecond pulses the heat-carrier relaxation, electron–phonon coupling in metals, falls on time scales where hyperbolic or two-temperature models matter, and thin-film heating is modelled with lagging, fractional or memory-dependent laws; bilayer analyses under pulsed heating combine them [116]. The benchmark thermal shock of Section 6.4 shows what to look for: the stress peak at the elastic front and its sensitivity to the heat law, here about 20 % between Fourier and Lord–Shulman for the parameters used.

### 9.1.2 Micro- and nano-electromechanical resonators

Thermoelastic damping is a leading loss mechanism in flexural micro-resonators. The classical Zener relaxation (Section 4.1.4) captures the dependence on thickness and frequency, and the extension to beams and plates by Lifshitz and Roukes [143] is standard. The corrections reviewed here enter in two ways. In ultra-thin structures at very high frequency, lagging and non-Fourier effects change the damping; examples are DPL-based thermoelastic damping in nonlocal nanoplates [121], couple-stress micro-plates [122] and rotating nano-beams with spatiotemporal nonlocality [114]. At small sizes, nonlocal and gradient elasticity also shift the vibration frequencies on which the damping depends. Two cautions follow from the analysis presented here: the form of the nonlocal thermoelastic constitutive law (form A or B, Section 5.3) changes the predicted damping near the elastic cut-off, and the lag time enters only through $\omega\tau$, so unless the frequency is within one or two decades of $1/\tau_q$, the classical result is adequate.

### 9.1.3 Piezoelectric devices, sensors and semiconductors

Thermopiezoelectric coupling affects bulk and surface acoustic wave devices, energy harvesters and sensors, and photothermal effects in piezoelectric semiconductors add carrier dynamics [91, 253, 307]. In the quasi-static, charge-free regime the electric field acts on thermoelastic waves as the exact renormalisation (76), and designs that sense temperature through the pyroelectric effect depend on the sign convention discussed there. Interface problems (substrate–film, electrode–crystal) are the subject of the energy-ratio literature [95, 96, 99, 103, 104], where Section 6.10 suggests the checks to apply.

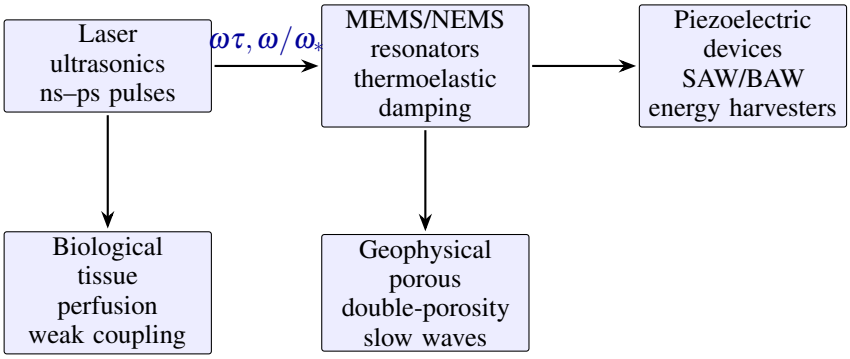



**Figure 37:** Application regime map: four areas ordered by the dimensionless numbers $\omega\tau$ (lag relevance) and $\omega/\omega_*$ (coupling relevance); Section 10.1 gives the quantitative criteria.

### 9.1.4 Biological tissue and heterogeneous media

Heat transfer in biological tissue is classically described by the bioheat equation of Pennes [336], which adds blood perfusion to the Fourier equation. Non-Fourier models have been applied to tissue, on the strength of reported large relaxation times in nonhomogeneous materials [151, 152], though the interpretation of those measurements is debated; DPL and fractional models have been fitted to such data [46, 124]. Shock-induced nonlocal coupled thermoelasticity analysis with energy dissipation in a MEMS/NEMS beam resonator was presented by [197]. Fractional order thermo-viscoelastic theory of biological tissue with dual phase lag heat conduction model was developed by [337]; bio-heat transfer analysis based on fractional derivative and memory-dependent derivative heat conduction models was performed by [338]. For water-like media $\omega_* = \rho c c_1^2/k \approx 10^{13}$ rad/s (with $\rho \approx 10^3$ kg/m$^3$, $c \approx 4 \times 10^3$ J/kg K, $c_1 \approx 1.5 \times 10^3$ m/s, $k \approx 0.6$ W/m K) lies far above any frequency of interest, and the thermoelastic coupling is weak, so tissue work concerns the thermal field rather than thermoelastic waves.

Effect of magnetic field and gravity on 2D fiber-reinforced medium under fractional order theory of thermoelasticity was analysed by [339].

### 9.1.5 Geophysical and porous media

Porous and double-porous thermoelastic models with two temperatures are applied to wave propagation in saturated and partially saturated solids [102, 105, 320], where additional slow waves carry fluid and heat and attenuate strongly. The validity of generalized heat laws in such media, whose time scales are set by pore-scale processes, is largely untested.

### 9.1.6 Summary

In all four areas the single most informative dimensionless number is $\omega\tau$ (frequency times the relevant lag), and the second is $\omega/\omega_*$. The regime map in Section 10.1 makes this quantitative.

**Summary**

Applications divide by regime: laser ultrasonics (classical adequate for ns pulses; lagged/fractional for fs–ps), MEMS/NEMS resonators (Zener damping with nonlocal/lag corrections near cut-off), piezoelectric devices (exact stiffening renormalisation in charge-free regime), biological tissue (weak coupling, interest in thermal field), geophysical porous

media (slow diffusive waves, largely untested). The key numbers are $\omega\tau$ and $\omega/\omega_*$.

## 9.2 A quantitative guide to application regimes

Section 9.1 lists application areas. The dimensionless groups that decide the heat law are now evaluated for six representative scenarios, which shows at a glance which model of this review is relevant. The table is generated by scenario table from the rounded handbook inputs of Table 3 and a lag $\tau_q = 1$ ps; $\delta_T = \sqrt{2\chi/\omega}$ is the thermal penetration depth and $\lambda = c_1/f$ the acoustic wavelength.

**Table 13:** Dimensionless groups for six scenarios ($T_0 = 300$ K, $\tau_q = 1$ ps). The assessment column applies the rule: Fourier is adequate if $\omega\tau_q < 0.1$ and $\omega/\omega_* < 0.1$; a lag law may matter if $\omega\tau_q < 1.5$ but then the kinetic validity of the model must be checked; otherwise the continuum heat law itself is questionable.

| Scenario | Material | $f$ (Hz) | $\omega/\omega_*$ | $\omega\tau_q$ | $\delta_T$ (m) | $\lambda$ (m) | Assessment |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Ultrasonic testing | Aluminium | $1.0\times10^{7}$ | $1.6\times10^{-4}$ | $6.3\times10^{-5}$ | $1.8\times10^{-6}$ | $6.2\times10^{-4}$ | Fourier adequate |
| GHz acoustics | Aluminium | $1.0\times10^{9}$ | $1.6\times10^{-2}$ | $6.3\times10^{-3}$ | $1.8\times10^{-7}$ | $6.2\times10^{-6}$ | Fourier adequate |
| Picosecond ultrasonics | Aluminium | $1.0\times10^{11}$ | $1.6\times10^{0}$ | $6.3\times10^{-1}$ | $1.8\times10^{-8}$ | $6.2\times10^{-8}$ | lag may matter; check kinetics |
| Silicon beam, $h = 1\,\mu$m, at $f_Z$ | Silicon | $1.4\times10^{8}$ | $1.1\times10^{-3}$ | $9.1\times10^{-4}$ | $4.5\times10^{-7}$ | $6.1\times10^{-5}$ | Fourier adequate |
| Silicon film, $h = 20$ nm, at $f_Z$ | Silicon | $3.6\times10^{11}$ | $2.7\times10^{0}$ | $2.3\times10^{0}$ | $9.0\times10^{-9}$ | $2.5\times10^{-8}$ | continuum law questionable |
| Copper film, $h = 50$ nm, at $f_Z$ | Copper | $7.3\times10^{10}$ | $2.6\times10^{0}$ | $4.6\times10^{-1}$ | $2.3\times10^{-8}$ | $6.2\times10^{-8}$ | lag may matter; check kinetics |

### 9.2.1 Reading the table

- *Ultrasonic testing and GHz acoustics (aluminium).* With $\omega\tau_q$ between $6\times10^{-5}$ and $6\times10^{-3}$ and $\omega/\omega_*$ between $1.6\times10^{-4}$ and $1.6\times10^{-2}$, classical coupled thermoelasticity suffices. The thermal penetration depth (1.8 $\mu$m at 10 MHz, 0.18 $\mu$m at 1 GHz) is far smaller than the acoustic wavelength (620 $\mu$m and 6.2 $\mu$m), so the wave feels the temperature field as a thin boundary layer at interfaces and as weak bulk damping.
- *Picosecond ultrasonics (aluminium, 100 GHz).* Here $\omega/\omega_* = 1.6$, $\omega\tau_q = 0.63$, and the wavelength (62 nm) is comparable with the thermal penetration depth (18 nm). This is the corner of the regime map (Section 10.1) where lag and coupling effects could be visible, and also where carrier mean free paths rival the wavelength, so any deviation from the classical result needs a kinetic or atomistic cross-check.
- *Silicon beam, $h = 1\,\mu$m.* At the Zener frequency $f_Z = 1.4\times10^{8}$ Hz, $\omega\tau_q \approx 10^{-3}$ and the Fourier law with the exact flexural result Eq. (69) is adequate. The thermal penetration depth (0.45 $\mu$m) is a sizeable fraction of the thickness, which is why the damping peaks here.
- *Silicon film 20 nm and copper film 50 nm.* At the thermal relaxation frequency of the film, $\omega\tau_q$ is 2.3 and 0.46 and $\omega/\omega_*$ is 2.7 and 2.6. These are the regimes in which a continuum heat law with bulk parameters has to be treated with caution: the film thickness is comparable to or below the carrier mean free path, boundary scattering reduces the effective conductivity, and the relaxation frequency of the continuum model is not reliable.

### 9.2.2 Consequences for the choice of theory

1. The classical coupled theory suffices for essentially every ultrasonic, above-micron MEMS and geophysical application, and it is the baseline in any case.
2. Lag models can matter only in the lower right-hand corner of Table 13, at frequencies above about $10^{10}$ Hz or thicknesses below about 100 nm. There the continuum assumptions are also strained, so a claim of a lag effect needs an independent test.
3. The Guyer–Krumhansl and nonlocal models (Sections 3.4 and 5.3) are the first refinement once size effects are suspected, because they carry a length scale and lag models do not.
4. Boundary integral equation formulation for thermoelasticity with two relaxation times was developed by [340]; reciprocal and variational theorems on the two-temperature Green–Lindsay thermoelasticity theory were given by [341]. The electromechanical and magnetic couplings (Section 7.1) change the stiffness at all frequencies, and are therefore relevant over the whole table, even where the heat law is not.

**Summary**

The regime map is organised by $\omega\tau_q$ (lag relevance) and $\omega/\omega_*$ (coupling relevance). For $\omega\tau_q \ll 0.05$ the classical law suffices; for $0.05 \lesssim \omega\tau_q \lesssim 1$ lagged models matter; for $\omega\tau_q \gtrsim 1$ the exact delay/kinetic law is needed. GK and nonlocal models carry a length scale and are the first refinement once size effects are suspected. Electromechanical and magnetic couplings change stiffness at all frequencies.

## 9.3 Experimental evidence and parameter identification

A wave theory is only as useful as its parameters. This section reviews which experiment probes which parameter, what the experiments can and cannot discriminate, and how published lag times and fractional orders should be read.

### 9.3.1 Second sound and ballistic heat pulses

The direct signature of wave-like heat transport is second sound, a propagating temperature wave. It was predicted for dielectric crystals at low temperature [29, 31] and observed in solid helium [27] and in sodium fluoride [28, 342], in narrow temperature windows where momentum-conserving phonon collisions dominate over resistive ones. A further observation in graphite above 100 K [343] extends the window to a much higher temperature in a material of high anisotropy. There the fitted second-sound speed at 85 K is about 3200 m/s against 3650 m/s from ab initio calculations, with oscillations at 104 and 125 K and none at 50 and 150 K (values from the first-release version of the paper, with no error bar quoted for the fit). These experiments work in a hydrodynamic phonon window with $\tau_N \ll \tau_R$, exactly the conditions under which the Guyer–Krumhansl law (Section 3.4) applies. They do not show that a Cattaneo or lag law with a single relaxation time describes conduction in ordinary solids at room temperature.

### 9.3.2 Ultrafast optical methods

Pump–probe reflectivity measures electron–lattice energy exchange on femtosecond to picosecond timescales [344] and picosecond ultrasonics generates and detects coherent acoustic pulses in thin films [345]. The first is where the two-temperature picture of Section 4.3 provides the

continuum model, and what is measured is an electron–phonon coupling time rather than $\tau_q$. In the second, the heat input launches a strain pulse whose amplitude and shape depend on diffusion within the first tens of nanometres, so thermoelastic coupling acts as the source and not as a loss mechanism. Time-domain thermoreflectance [346] fits a diffusive model with interface resistance to extract the conductivity of films and interfaces, and a short-delay deviation from that fit is where lag or ballistic corrections are usually claimed.

### 9.3.3 Resonator quality factors

Micro- and nano-resonators provide the cleanest tests of thermoelastic damping because $Q$ can be measured against temperature and thickness. The quantitative signature, Eqs. (68) and (69), is a loss peak at $f_Z = \pi\chi/(2h^2)$ with the scaling $f_Z \propto h^{-2}$ and a height proportional to $\Delta$. Verification therefore needs a sweep of thickness or temperature rather than a single value, with anchor and surface losses subtracted; those losses lie outside the models of this review. A mismatch can be blamed on a lag or size effect only once their contributions are bounded.

### 9.3.4 Heterogeneous media and biological tissue

The relaxation times of order seconds reported for non-homogeneous materials, processed biological tissue among them [151, 152], reflect heat transfer through a heterogeneous microstructure and are effective macroscopic parameters. Reading them as molecular relaxation times is not warranted, and the values have been disputed. For tissue the parabolic Pennes bioheat equation [336] remains the baseline against which any hyperbolic correction has to be judged.

### 9.3.5 What the dispersion relation can identify

Equation (33) contains the heat law only through the single function $G(s)$ and is *linear* in $G$. If the complex wavenumber $k(\omega)$ of the elastic-type branch is measured (phase velocity from $\mathrm{Re}\,k$, attenuation from $\mathrm{Im}\,k$) and $\rho, c_1, c, \beta, T_0$ are known, (33) can be solved for $G$ at each frequency,

$$G(-\mathrm{i}\omega) = -\frac{s\left[\rho^2 c\,(c_1^2 K - \omega^2) + \beta^2 T_0 K\right]}{\rho\,K\,(c_1^2 K - \omega^2)}, \qquad K = k^2,\ s = -\mathrm{i}\omega. \tag{79}$$

A measured $k(\omega)$ therefore determines the heat-flux function $G(-\mathrm{i}\omega)$ *without assuming* a lag model; the model enters afterwards, when a parametric form of $G$ is fitted.

For the template $G(s) = [k(1 + \tau_T s) + k^*(1 + \tau_v s)/s]/(1 + \tau_q s)$ the five parameters $(k, k^*, \tau_q, \tau_T, \tau_v)$ are *not* all identifiable. Writing the numerator as $k^* + (k + k^*\tau_v)s + k\tau_T s^2$, $G$ depends only on the four combinations

$$k^*, \qquad k + k^*\tau_v, \qquad k\,\tau_T, \qquad \tau_q, \tag{80}$$

so the parameters can move along $(\delta k, \delta\tau_T, \delta\tau_v) = (\delta, -\tau_T\delta/k, -\delta/k^*)$ without changing $G$ and hence without changing any wave property of the one-dimensional problem, which is consistent with the combination $\tau_v^* = k + k^*\tau_v$ of Roy Choudhuri [42]. Two consequences follow: dispersion or attenuation data alone cannot separate $k$ from $\tau_v$, and a pair $(k, \tau_v)$ fitted to such data is a convention rather than a measurement (compare Section 4.4).

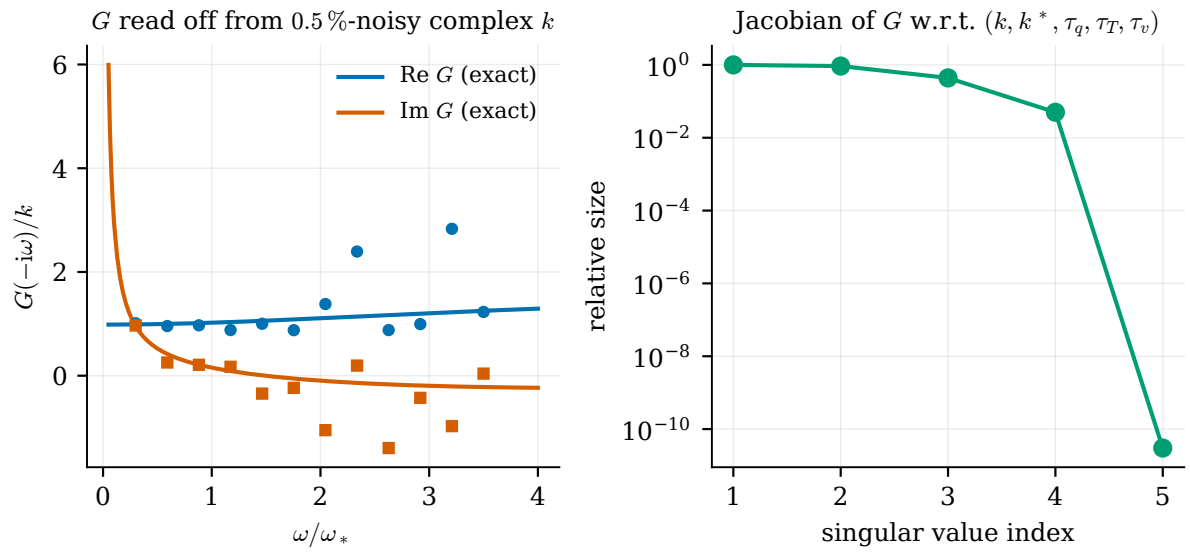



**Figure 38:** Synthetic identification test. Left: $G(-\mathrm{i}\omega)/k$ recovered from 0.5 %-noisy complex wavenumbers through (79) (markers) against the exact function (lines). Right: singular values of the Jacobian of $G$ with respect to $(k, k^*, \tau_q, \tau_T, \tau_v)$; the fifth is zero to rounding, the fourth is small.

**Numerical check (synthetic data).** The identifiability check generates $k(\omega)$ from the template with a chosen parameter set, verifies that (79) returns $G$ to $10^{-9}$, that the Jacobian of $G(-\mathrm{i}\omega)$ with respect to the five parameters has numerical rank four (singular values relative to the largest: 1, 0.93, 0.44, 0.05, $3 \times 10^{-11}$), and that two parameter sets differing along the null direction give identical $G$. With 0.5 % random noise on complex $k$ at twelve frequencies, the combinations $k^*$ and $\tau_q$ are recovered to 2 % and below 1 %, $k + k^*\tau_v$ to about 12 % and $k\tau_T$ only to about 26 % (Fig. 38). These figures describe this synthetic example, with one parameter set, one noise level and one seed, and not any material; no experimental data enter.

### 9.3.6 How to read a published lag time

1. Identify what was measured: a response time of a temperature signal, a conductivity, or a quality factor.
2. Identify the model used to extract $\tau$ and whether other parameters were fitted simultaneously. A fit of two or more lag parameters from a single curve is usually not identifiable (compare Section 4.4).
3. Compare $\omega\tau$ with the validity limits of the model (Section 4.4 for truncated lag laws, Section 3.4 for the kinetic basis).
4. Check whether a simpler model (Fourier with interface resistance, or Guyer–Krumhansl) explains the same data.

A model parameter that cannot be measured independently of the model that defines it is a fitting constant and not a material property, and papers that tabulate such constants for many materials without an independent test provide limited guidance.

**Summary**

Experimental evidence: second sound at cryogenic temperatures (Ackerman–Bertman, Jackson et al.) is the cleanest demonstration of wave-like heat transport; room-temperature

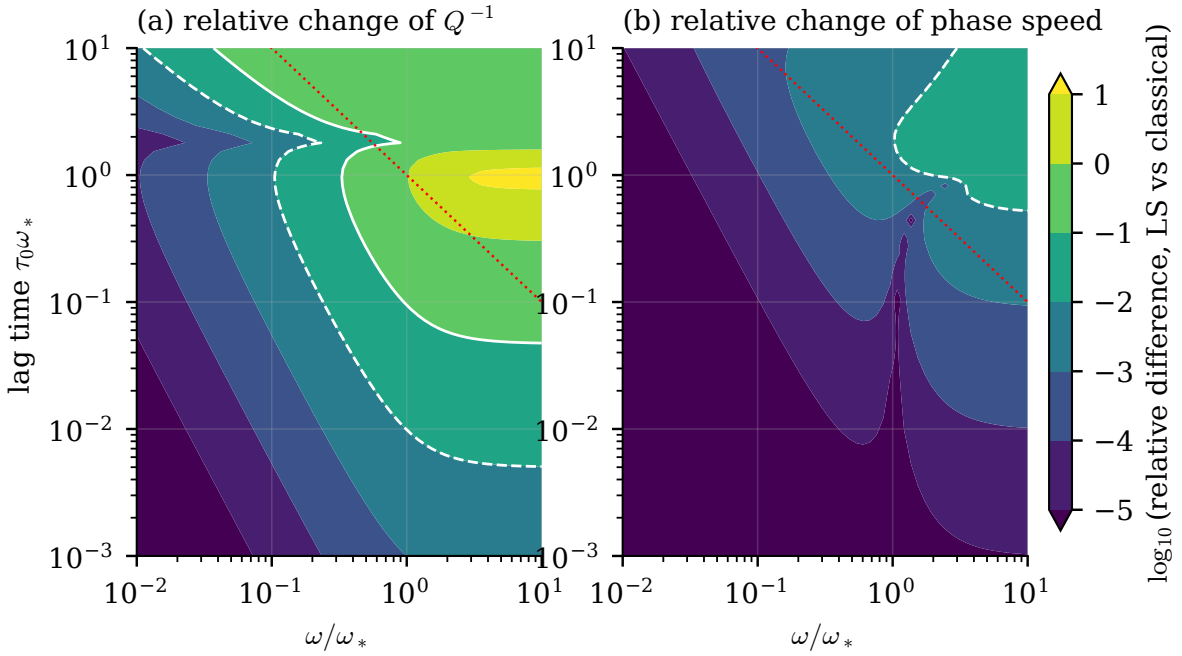



**Figure 39:** Relative difference between the Lord–Shulman and classical predictions for the elastic-type branch ($\varepsilon = 0.02$): (a) damping $Q^{-1}$, (b) phase speed. Dashed and solid white contours mark 1 % and 10 % differences; the dotted red line is $\omega\tau_0 = 1$. The hybridisation locus $c_T = c_1$ is the horizontal line $\tau_0\omega_* = 1$ (not drawn); near it the thermal and elastic speeds coincide ($c_T = c_1$), the branches hybridise, and the labelling "elastic-type" is ambiguous; features in that region should be read qualitatively.

reports of large relaxation times in nonhomogeneous materials are debated. Pump–probe and ultrasonic damping can determine lags independently. A model parameter not measurable independently of the model is a fitting constant, not a material property.

# 10. Synthesis: comparability, pitfalls and decision guide

## 10.1 Comparative synthesis and decision guide

### 10.1.1 When does the heat law matter? A regime map

Most users want to know one thing first: will a generalized heat law change their prediction? The question is answered for the damping and the speed of the elastic-type branch by computing the relative difference between Lord–Shulman and classical predictions over the plane of the two relevant dimensionless numbers, the frequency $\omega/\omega_*$ and the lag $\tau_0\omega_*$ (Figure 39). The coupling is $\varepsilon = 0.02$, typical of metals (Table 3). Three conclusions follow. (i) The heat law affects the *damping* much earlier than the *speed*: a 10 % change in $Q^{-1}$ at $\omega \gtrsim \omega_*$ requires $\omega\tau_0 \gtrsim 0.05$–$0.1$, a 1 % change requires roughly $\omega\tau_0 \gtrsim 0.005$, and the phase speed changes by less than 1 % over most of the plane. (ii) Far below $\omega_*$ the difference is negligible unless the lag is very large, because the thermal field is then adiabatic over a period. (iii) Around $\omega\tau_0 = 1$, differences of tens of percent in $Q^{-1}$ appear. A paper that reports a "strong effect of the relaxation time on the phase speed" for realistic lags and ultrasonic frequencies should therefore be examined for its choice of nondimensionalisation: a nondimensional lag chosen

for plotting convenience can be far larger than any physical value.

### 10.1.2 Taxonomy of models and combinations

Table 14 places the models discussed in this review by the structure of their heat law (the function $G(s)$), their elastic constitutive law, and their additional fields. A published model is a point in the product of these three choices. The literature contains many models because that product is large, not because there are many physically distinct mechanisms.

**Table 14:** Taxonomy. A model is specified by one entry from each of the three groups.

| Axis | Options (representative references) |
|---|---|
| Heat law $G(s)$ | Fourier [1]; Cattaneo/LS [32]; Green–Lindsay (modifies coupling) [33]; GN I–III [36, 38]; DPL [40]; TPL [42]; MGT [71]; fractional [56]; MDD [59]; Guyer–Krumhansl [30]; two-temperature variants [62]; thermoelasticity and generalized thermoelasticity viewed as wave hierarchies [182]. |
| Elastic law | Local; Eringen nonlocal [15, 48]; gradient [17, 18]; couple stress [192]; micropolar [13]; Klein–Gordon type [128]; viscoelastic (Kelvin–Voigt) [253]. |
| Added fields | Piezoelectric [11]; semiconductor/photothermal [307]; magnetic [58]; diffusion [119]; voids/porosity [76, 77, 320]. |

### 10.1.3 Comparative table

Table 15 summarises the models against the criteria that decide when each is appropriate.

### 10.1.4 Pitfalls checklist

Each issue below recurs in the literature, and each is examined somewhere in this review.

1. **The $\tau_T \geq \tau_q/2$ condition belongs to the second-order-in-$\tau_q$ truncation** of DPL, not to the first-order template; no unstable root of the first-order version was found in the numerical sweep of Section 4.3, which is evidence and not a proof.
2. **DPL $\to$ Lord–Shulman** needs $\tau_T \to 0$ at fixed $\tau_q$, not $\tau_q \to 0$; $\tau_T = \tau_q$ gives exactly Fourier's law.
3. **TPL $\to$ DPL** needs $k^* \to 0$; with $k^* \neq 0$ the low-frequency limit changes qualitatively.
4. **Fractional order $\alpha \to 2$ is the wave equation, not Fourier's law.**
5. **GN-III does not have a finite thermal front speed**; it is wave-like at low and diffusive at high frequency.
6. **The classical theory is adiabatic at low and isothermal at high frequency**; labels on speeds must say which modulus $c_1$ refers to.
7. **Branch identification**: follow roots by continuity; nearest-to-$\omega/c_1$ selection fails when branches hybridise.
8. **DPL is diffusive at both ends**; "wave-like" only at intermediate frequency.
9. **The sign of the effect of a hyperbolic heat law on a pulse depends on the boundary condition** (prescribed flux or temperature).
10. **MDD forms differ in their high-frequency limit**; check $s\kappa(s)$ as $s \to \infty$.

**Table 15:** Comparative summary of heat-conduction models for thermoelastic waves.

| Model | Extra parameters | Finite front speed | Condition and its status | Main caution |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Classical | 0 | no | $k, c > 0$ (thermodynamic) | Instantaneous thermal signal. |
| Lord–Shulman | 1 ($\tau_0$) | yes ($c_T$) | $\tau_0 > 0$ (positivity) | Lag also multiplies the coupling term. |
| Green–Lindsay | 2 ($\tau_0, \tau_1$) | yes | $\tau_1 \geq \tau_0 > 0$ (entropy-inequality restriction, derived in [33]) | Discontinuities at fronts. |
| GN II | 1 ($k^*$) | yes ($c_*$) | $k^* > 0$ (positivity) | No dissipation. |
| GN III | 2 ($k, k^*$) | no (strict) | both $> 0$ (positivity) | Not an improved Cattaneo law. |
| DPL, 1st order | 2 | no (strict) | no instability found (numerical, not a proof) | Both-limits diffusive; $\tau_T = \tau_q$ is Fourier. |
| DPL, 2nd order in $\tau_q$ | 2 | depends | $\tau_T \geq \tau_q/2$ (spectral stability; theorem reported in the cited source, checked numerically here; equality is the critical case, not strict exponential decay) | Unstable otherwise. |
| TPL | 4 | no (strict) | reported in [44]; not re-derived here | Many parameters; $k^*$ changes low-$\omega$ limit. |
| MGT | 2–3 | yes ($c_T$) | parameter conditions (reported in the literature; not re-derived here) | Third order in time. |
| Fractional | 1 order + lag | depends on $\alpha$ | model-dependent (open in general) | $\alpha \to 2$ is not Fourier. |
| MDD | 1–3 | variant-dependent | model-dependent (open in general) | High-frequency limit depends on kernel. |

The "condition" column mixes different kinds of statement and each entry is labelled: positivity of coefficients, a thermodynamic restriction, a spectral-stability result, or a numerical observation. These are not interchangeable, and none of them is a proof of well-posedness in the sense of existence, uniqueness and continuous dependence unless stated.

11. **Energy ratios in lossy media**: the sum of mode fractions need not equal one because of interference; the net flux must be continuous.
12. **Eringen calibration**: $\xi$ depends on the calibration target (zone boundary versus long wavelength).
13. **Gradient sign**: a positive gradient coefficient gives stiffening dispersion, the opposite of lattice softening.
14. **Nonlocal thermoelastic form** (smoothing the thermal stress or not) changes damping near the cut-off.
15. **Talbot inversion fails for delayed transforms** for times before the delay; set the solution to zero ahead of the front.
16. **Piezo sign conventions**: the sign of $ep$ determines whether pyroelectricity increases or decreases thermal stress.
17. **Report dimensionless groups** so that nondimensional lags can be related to physical values.

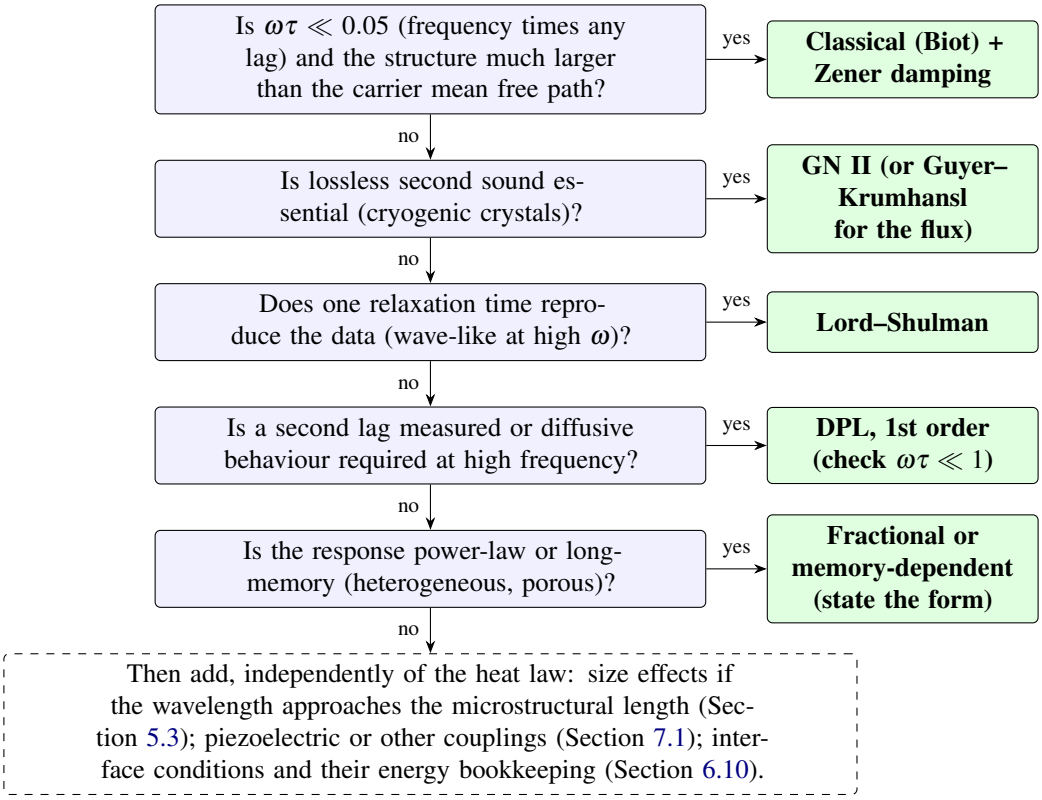



**Figure 40:** Decision sequence for choosing a starting model. The threshold $\omega\tau \ll 0.05$ follows from the regime map of Figure 39.

### 10.1.5 Decision guide

Figure 40 gives a sequence for choosing a starting model. It is a guide, not a substitute for checking against data. The frequency thresholds quoted in this review answer different questions and are not one universal boundary: $\omega\tau_q \lesssim 0.3$ is the range in which the Taylor truncations reproduce the thermal-branch wavenumber of the exact delay law (Section 4.4); $\omega\tau < 0.1$ together with $\omega/\omega_* < 0.1$ is the rule used to call Fourier adequate in the scenario table (Section 9.2); and $\omega\tau \ll 0.05$ in Fig. 40 comes from the Lord–Shulman regime map of Fig. 39 for the damping of the elastic-type branch at $\varepsilon = 0.02$. Each is tied to its own observable, tolerance and parameter range.

**Summary**

Comparative synthesis: for linear homogeneous media the template models with rational heat laws share one dispersion polynomial, whereas exact delays, fractional powers and hereditary kernels give transcendental or multivalued relations; differences show in damping before speed and only when $\omega\tau \gtrsim 0.05$. LS and MGT have finite thermal fronts; classical, DPL, TPL and GN-III do not (first-order template). GN-II is unique in being energy-conserving. Piezoelectric stiffening is exact in the charge-free regime. Nonlocal lengths are calibration-dependent. At interfaces in lossy media, net flux is conserved but mode fractions need not sum to one.

## 10.2 A taxonomy of the field, and when two studies are comparable

The literature labels a study "generalized thermoelastic" or it does not. That single axis collapses independent commitments into one word. A study may adopt a relaxation law for the heat flux, a gradient or integral law for the stress, a coupling to a second field, and a validation regime, and each of these can be varied while the others are held fixed. Two studies that share the label can therefore differ in the mathematics of their governing equations, in their modal content and in the evidence they offer. Section 10.1 compares families; this section says what a family *is* as a coordinate, so that a new model can be placed without argument.

The heat-flux template of Section 3.2 is a special case of Axis 2: the operator is local in space and first order in time, and the lags are the coordinate that separates the template's members. A model that needs an integral, fractional or gradient operator has left that axis rather than moved along it, which is why such models cannot be ranked against the template's members by setting a lag to zero.

The three groups of Table 14 (structure of the heat law, elastic constitutive law, additional fields) are a coarse, model-oriented view; in the five-axis scheme below they correspond to the mathematical axis (Axis 2), the physical axis (Axis 1) and the coupling axis (Axis 4), while the wave and validation axes (Axes 3 and 5) describe what a study does with the model.

A study is classified by its vector of commitments $\mathbf{c} = (c_1, \ldots, c_5)$, one coordinate per axis:

**Axis 1: Physical axis (material class).** Classical elastic, thermoelastic, piezoelectric, piezothermoelastic, magneto-thermo-elastic, poroelastic, micropolar, two-temperature, semiconductor-like. It fixes which conserved quantities and driving fields exist before any approximation.

**Axis 2: Mathematical axis (operator structure).** Local PDE, integro-differential, fractional-order, nonlocal gradient, hereditary memory integral, or variational/weak form. The most consequential differences between studies run along this axis.

**Axis 3: Wave axis (modal content).** Does the thermal mode propagate at finite speed; how many coupled modes exist; is there attenuation; what is the dispersion character of each.

**Axis 4: Coupling axis (field topology).** Which fields are coupled and how strongly: thermoelastic, thermo-piezoelectric, thermo-magneto-elastic, thermo-poro-elastic, thermo-micro-elastic. Coupling topology, and not the choice of energy functional, decides whether an interface problem is tractable.

**Axis 5: Validation axis (evidence regime).** Existence and uniqueness only; closed-form solution for a special geometry; numerical solution validated against a reference; comparison with experiment; a shared benchmark suite.

Two studies are *structurally* comparable, at the level of model class, when their vectors agree in the first two coordinates; a comparison of numbers further needs compatible geometry, parameters, boundary and interface conditions, nondimensional regime and observable. If they differ there, a comparison of numbers means nothing and only a comparison of structure is available. To make the weaker statement quantitative, define the axis-weight dissimilarity

$$d(\mathbf{c}, \mathbf{c}') = \sum_{j=1}^{5} w_j \left(1 - \delta_{c_j c'_j}\right), \qquad w_{\text{math}} \geq w_{\text{phys}} > w_{\text{coup}} > w_{\text{wave}} > w_{\text{val}}, \tag{81}$$

with the ordering stated because it is a modelling decision open to challenge: a difference in the mathematical axis changes the governing operator and invalidates most direct comparisons, whereas a difference in the validation axis changes only the epistemic status of the conclusion. The weights are reported whenever the dissimilarity is used, and no result in this review depends

on their numerical values.

**Table 16:** The five axes with their admissible values. A study occupies one cell of the product; the last column gives an example assignment for a coupled fractional piezothermoelastic problem.

| Axis | Admissible values | Example |
|---|---|---|
| Physical | elastic; thermoelastic; piezoelectric; piezothermoelastic; magneto-thermo-elastic; poroelastic; micropolar; two-temperature; semiconductor | piezothermoelastic |
| Mathematical | local PDE; integro-differential; fractional; nonlocal gradient; hereditary; variational | fractional + local coupling |
| Wave | finite/infinite thermal speed; number of coupled modes; attenuating/non-attenuating | two modes, one attenuated |
| Coupling | none; thermal; thermal + electric; thermal + magnetic; thermal + poro; thermal + micro-rotation | thermal + electric |
| Validation | proof only; closed form; verified numerics; experiment; shared benchmark | verified numerics |

A taxonomy earns its place only if it changes a decision, and this one changes three in the present review. It fixes the order in which Section 10.1 compares families; it is why Section 6.10 insists that an energy flux be defined consistently with the model before ratios are compared (see Appendix J); and it is why Section 11.1 keeps apart the questions that differ in the mathematical axis from those that differ only in evidence.

# 11. Summary and Research Gaps

## 11.1 Open problems and research agenda

### 11.1.1 Theory

1. **A classification theorem for the template.** For the first-order template no unstable root has been found numerically for DPL in a finite sweep of positive lags (an analytical statement is lacking), and when the thermal front has finite speed (the behaviour of $sG(s)$ at large $s$) has been identified. What applied authors still lack is a complete analytical statement of well-posedness, decay and front structure for the coupled TPL and MGT systems with all parameters positive, that is, the conditions on $(\tau_q, \tau_T, \tau_v, k, k^*)$ together with the role of the coupling $\varepsilon$, in a form they can use directly.
2. **Thermodynamics of truncated lag models.** The time-differential DPL and TPL models raise questions of thermodynamic compatibility and continuous dependence [44, 45]. A systematic account of which truncations admit an energy functional and an entropy inequality, and of what restrictions these impose on the lags, would resolve the confusion over the $\tau_T \geq \tau_q/2$ condition (Section 4.3).
3. **Memory-dependent and fractional models.** Energy functionals, thermodynamic admissibility, uniqueness and finite-speed properties are not available for the memory-dependent

and fractional laws at the generality of the template models. The high-frequency limit of the MDD law depends on the kernel (Section 5.1), which suggests that a classification of kernels by $s\kappa(s)$ at large $s$ would be worth having.

4. **Interface conditions for lagged and memory models.** What is missing is a set of thermodynamically consistent interface conditions with thermal resistance for lagged and memory heat laws, including the entropy production at the interface (Section 6.10).
5. **Mode interference in dissipative media.** Energy ratios will keep their ambiguity until there is a systematic way to apportion the energy flux among generated waves in lossy media.

### 11.1.2 Combined effects

6. **Joint size and memory effects.** Authors compute combinations of nonlocal or gradient elasticity with hyperbolic or memory heat laws far more often than they validate them against lattice dynamics or atomistic simulation. A benchmark in which a lattice model with heat carriers supplies the reference dispersion would show which combination is justified.
7. **Calibration of length scales.** The calibration target, zone boundary or long wavelength, changes $\xi$ by about one third (Section 5.3); systematic calibration protocols for thermoelastic problems do not exist.
8. **Nonlocal forms of thermoelastic coupling.** The smoothed and unsmoothed forms of the thermal stress differ near the cut-off. The thermodynamically consistent form should be derived from a nonlocal free energy rather than chosen.
9. **Surface and interface thermoelasticity at the nanoscale.** Surface stress, surface heat capacity and Kapitza resistance modify both surface waves and interface partition in ways that the bulk models treated here do not capture.

### 11.1.3 Experiments and data

10. **Measurement of both branches.** Most of the present evidence is indirect. An experiment that measured the elastic-type and the thermal-type branch in the same solid across the crossover frequency would discriminate among heat laws.
11. **Independent determination of lags.** Relaxation times and lags are generally obtained by fitting. An independent measurement, from pump–probe experiments together with ultrasonic damping for instance, would test the models instead of fitting them.
12. **Thermoelastic damping at ultra-high frequency.** Resonators at gigahertz frequencies already reach the regime in which lagged corrections matter; systematic data on damping against frequency and size would calibrate them.

### 11.1.4 Computation

13. **Benchmark suite.** A set of agreed benchmark problems, namely the heat pulse, thermal shock, Rayleigh wave and interface problems of this review, with reference solutions at specified precision, would improve the reliability of numerical codes.
14. **Efficient memory operators.**

**Summary**

Open problems: (theory) classification theorem for the template, thermodynamics of truncated lag models, memory-model energy functionals, consistent interface conditions for lagged/memory laws, mode-interference framework for dissipative media. (combined effects) joint size-and-memory validation against lattice dynamics, calibration protocols for length scales, thermodynamically consistent nonlocal thermal stress, nanoscale surface/interface thermoelasticity. (experiments) measure both branches in the same solid, independent lag determination, ultra-high-frequency damping data. (computation) agreed benchmark suite, fast memory operators.

Fast algorithms for fractional and memory-dependent operators in time-domain codes, with error control.

### 11.1.5 Researchable questions, and what would settle each

The agenda above states the gaps. A gap becomes usable only when the evidence that would close it is stated as well, since that is what lets a reader judge whether a proposed study is decisive or merely related. The table makes the test explicit, and its final column names the section where the gap is first stated in this paper.

**Table 17:** Researchable questions. Each row restates a gap stated in Section 11.1; the third column names the evidence that would move it from open to closed. No new claim is introduced.

| # | Question | What would settle it | Stated in |
|---|---|---|---|
| R1 | What is the total (not availability) energy flux for each generalized family, and how does it differ from the flux used for interface partition? | A time-domain derivation per family under an explicit free-energy convention, external-field power terms and boundary conditions, checked against the primary formulation — and a statement of the first-order reduction that recovers the flux used for the energy ratios. | Section 3.2, Section 6.10 |
| R2 | Is energy conserved at an interface in generalized and nonlocal media, and in what sense? | An interface balance derived from the selected model's flux, with the admissible jump conditions, tested against a benchmark whose reference solution does not depend on the model under test. | Section 6.10 |
| R3 | Which benchmark is the right reference for a generalized theory? | A specification whose reference solution is independent — analytic limit, symbolic determinant, or an independently implemented discretization — with a stated tolerance. | Appendix I |
| R4 | Do the predicted generalized modes exist in a real material, with the predicted attenuation? | An experimental measurement of the predicted observables under conditions inside the model's stated validity domain. | Section 9.3 |
| R5 | How should energy flux and energy partition be normalized across families so that comparisons mean something? | A normalization in terms of physical observables rather than model parameters. | Section 10.1 |
| R6 | How are nonlocal interface conditions and a nonlocal divergence theorem formulated? | A variational statement of the nonlocal boundary-value problem from which the interface conditions follow rather than are assumed. | Section 5.3 |
| R7 | Are phase-lag, memory-kernel and anisotropy parameters identifiable from measurable data? | The number and type of independent measurements needed to separate the parameters, established by analysis of the sensitivity structure or by a designed experiment; the answer is model-specific. | Section 9.3 |
| R8 | Do the thermodynamic restrictions reduce the admissible parameter set under anisotropic symmetry as they do in the isotropic case? | The anisotropic admissibility analysis carried through for each family, with the coordinate-free form of the fractional and memory operators under anisotropic differentiation. | Section 3.2 |
| R9 | Which comparative statements survive when each family's own conventions are respected? | A model-by-model full-text check of constitutive conventions, free energies and external-field power terms before any flux or mode count is compared. | Section 10.1 |
| R10 | Can the benchmarks be reproduced from published inputs, and at what convergence rate? | Shared implementations, published inputs and reported convergence rates for every benchmark. | Section 8.1 |

R1 and R9 are the same question at different depths. A family-level flux comparison cannot be trusted until the model-specific derivations behind it exist, which is why the register in Appendix J marks the affected entries open instead of filling them.

## 11.2 Conclusions

Generalized thermoelasticity is a family organised by the function $G(s)$ that relates heat flux to temperature gradient, together with choices of elastic law and added fields, and not a collection of unrelated theories. That organisation buys three kinds of result. It gives exact statements about reductions and limits, among them the clarification that the often-quoted DPL stability condition belongs to a specific truncation and that GN-III has no finite front speed. It gives a dispersion polynomial for linear homogeneous media and rational heat laws, from which comparative speeds, attenuation and thermoelastic damping follow, and which shows that the heat law affects damping long before it affects speed, and only for $\omega\tau \gtrsim 0.05$. It gives problem-level results: finite fronts and surface jumps in heat pulses, the structure of thermoelastic Rayleigh waves, the renormalisation by piezoelectric coupling, the calibration dependence of nonlocal lengths, and the distinction between net energy flux and mode-by-mode fractions at interfaces in lossy media. Many of the open questions concern validation rather than derivation: independent measurement of lags, joint validation of size and memory effects against lattice dynamics, and benchmark solutions. The unified notation, the verified reductions, the pitfalls checklist and the decision guide are there so that readers can choose, justify and check models, and the open problems so that effort goes where it is most needed.

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## Declarations

## Author contributions (CRediT)

**Vipin Gupta:** Conceptualization; Methodology; Software; Validation; Formal analysis; Investigation; Data curation; Writing – original draft; Writing – review and editing; Visualization; Supervision; Project administration.

## Funding

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## Competing interests

The author declares no conflict of interest.

## Data and code availability

The scripts that produce every computed figure and every benchmark in Appendix D and Appendix I come with the manuscript, together with the parameter registers in Appendix H. No experimental data were generated in this work; every experimental value quoted is attributed to its source in the text.

## Use of generative tools

Generative AI tools were used in preparing this manuscript: for drafting and language editing, for writing and running the verification scripts, for checking notation and cross-references, and for literature and claim checks whose results are summarised in the evidence protocol (Section 2.4). The author reviewed the content and is responsible for it; the tools are not authors. Not every cited work was read page by page, and the claim register records which attributions were checked against the printed source and which were not.

## Nomenclature

Indices follow the Einstein summation convention; a comma denotes a spatial derivative and a dot a time derivative. The strain tensor is written with two indices ($\varepsilon_{ij}$) so that it is not confused with the scalar coupling $\varepsilon$. The unstarred $k$ is the thermal conductivity in $G$ and in tables, and

the wavenumber in $\exp[\mathrm{i}(kx-\omega t)]$ and in dispersion relations, where $K=k^2$; the symbol $K^2$ is the electromechanical coupling and is used only in the piezoelectric sections. The unindexed $c$ is always the specific heat. Plane waves are $\exp[\mathrm{i}(kx-\omega t)]$ with $\operatorname{Im} k \geq 0$ for spatial decay in the propagation direction, and a "branch" of the dispersion relation is a root $k(\omega)$ followed by continuity in $\omega$.

**Latin symbols**

| | |
|---|---|
| $G(s)$ | heat-flux function |
| $K=k^2$ | squared wavenumber in dispersion polynomials |
| $K^2$ | electromechanical coupling |
| $T_0$ | reference temperature |
| $Z=\rho c_1$ | mechanical impedance |
| $c$ | specific heat at constant strain |
| $c_1=\sqrt{(\lambda+2\mu)/\rho}$ | isothermal P-wave speed |
| $c_2=\sqrt{\mu/\rho}$ | shear wave speed |
| $c_T$ | thermal wave speed |
| $k,\ k^*$ | conductivities (Fourier, Green–Naghdi) |
| $q_i$ | heat flux |
| $s=-\mathrm{i}\omega$ | Laplace variable (complex frequency) |
| $u_i$ | displacement |
| $v$ | thermal displacement, $\dot{v}=\theta$ |

**Greek symbols**

| | |
|---|---|
| $\alpha=k/\rho c$ | thermal diffusivity |
| $\alpha_T$ | linear expansion coefficient |
| $\beta=(3\lambda+2\mu)\alpha_T$ | thermal-stress coefficient |
| $\varepsilon=\beta^2 T_0/(\rho^2 c c_1^2)$ | thermoelastic coupling |
| $\varepsilon_{ij}$ | strain |
| $\theta=T-T_0$ | temperature increment |
| $\lambda,\ \mu$ | Lam e constants |
| $\xi,\ \ell$ | nonlocal and gradient lengths |
| $\rho$ | mass density |
| $\sigma_{ij}$ | stress |
| $\tau_q,\ \tau_T,\ \tau_v$ | relaxation time and lags |
| $\tau_R,\ \tau_N$ | resistive and normal phonon relaxation times |
| $\omega$ | angular frequency |
| $\omega_*=\rho c c_1^2/k$ | thermal characteristic frequency |

**Subscripts and superscripts**

| | |
|---|---|
| 0 | reference state |
| $i,\ j,\ k$ | tensor indices |
| $()_{,i}$ | spatial derivative |
| $\dot{()}$ | time derivative |

$()^*$ Green–Naghdi quantity

# A. Derivations of the balance laws

This appendix records where each balance used in Section 3.2 comes from and what it assumes, so that a reader can see which statements are identities of continuum mechanics and which already contain a constitutive choice. Every derivation below is algebra on the stated assumptions, and none of them uses a heat law.

## Linear momentum

Take an arbitrary material volume $V$ with surface $\partial V$ and outward normal $n_i$. Cauchy's postulate gives the surface traction $t_i = \sigma_{ji} n_j$. Requiring that the rate of change of linear momentum equal the resultant force for *every* $V$, $\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}t}\int_V \rho \dot{u}_i \,\mathrm{d}V = \int_{\partial V} \sigma_{ji} n_j \,\mathrm{d}S + \int_V \rho f_i \,\mathrm{d}V$, and applying the divergence theorem together with the transport theorem gives $\rho \ddot{u}_i = \sigma_{ji,j} + \rho f_i$ after the volume is shrunk to a point. The assumptions are that a Cauchy stress exists (no couple stresses), that the motion is described by a single displacement field, and that the body is non-polar. These are exactly the assumptions recorded for (1).

## Symmetry of the stress

The same argument applied to the moment of momentum about a point, with no body couples and no couple stresses, leaves $\int_V e_{ijk}\sigma_{jk}\,\mathrm{d}V = 0$ for every $V$, hence $\sigma_{ij} = \sigma_{ji}$. The conclusion follows from the assumptions and is not an independent law: in a micropolar or couple-stress continuum the stress is not symmetric, and the derivation must be redone with the couple-stress tensor.

## Mechanical power

Contracting the momentum balance (1) with the velocity and using the symmetry of the stress gives

$$\rho \frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}t}\left(\tfrac{1}{2}\dot{u}_i\dot{u}_i\right) = \left(\sigma_{ij}\dot{u}_i\right)_{,j} - \sigma_{ij}\dot{\varepsilon}_{ij} + \rho f_i \dot{u}_i, \tag{82}$$

so the stress power $\sigma_{ij}\dot{\varepsilon}_{ij}$ is the only term that exchanges mechanical energy with the internal state. Here the strain enters, and not the displacement gradient: the rotation does no work.

## Internal energy

If the internal energy of a material volume changes by the heat supplied plus the stress power delivered, then with heat flux $q_i$ and supply $r$,

$$\rho \dot{e} = \sigma_{ij}\dot{\varepsilon}_{ij} - q_{i,i} + \rho r, \tag{83}$$

which is the second line of (1). This is an axiom of the theory: it defines what $e$ means, and a generalized theory that changes the flux $q_i$ or adds a state variable must restate it.

### The exact Eulerian flux

Adding the power balance and the internal-energy balance gives the material-derivative form $\rho\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}t}\left(\frac{1}{2}\dot{u}_i\dot{u}_i+e\right)+\left(q_j-\sigma_{ji}\dot{u}_i\right)_{,j}=\rho f_i\dot{u}_i+\rho r$. Converting the material derivative with mass conservation yields (18). The last step is the one the literature often skips: the material form is not the fixed-volume form, and the difference is the advection term $\mathscr{E}_{\mathrm{tot}}\dot{u}_j$. Omitting it is legitimate only as a first-order reduction under the small-motion assumptions stated with (19).

## B. Derivation and verification of the dispersion polynomial

With $\partial_x\to \mathrm{i}k$ and $\partial_t\to s=-\mathrm{i}\omega$, the momentum and energy balances (32) for the template give the linear system

$$\left(\rho s^2+\rho c_1^2k^2\right)\hat{u}+\mathrm{i}\beta k\,\hat{\theta}=0, \tag{84}$$

$$T_0\beta\, s\,\mathrm{i}k\,\hat{u}+\left(s\rho c+G(s)k^2\right)\hat{\theta}=0, \tag{85}$$

where the second equation uses $\mathrm{i}k\,\hat{q}=-\mathrm{i}k\,G\,\mathrm{i}k\,\hat{\theta}=Gk^2\hat{\theta}$. Its determinant is $(\rho c_1^2k^2+\rho s^2)(s\rho c+Gk^2)+\beta^2T_0\,s\,k^2$ (since $(\mathrm{i}k)(\mathrm{i}k)=-k^2$), which is (33) because $\rho s^2=-\rho\omega^2$. The identity was checked symbolically with every template parameter kept as a symbol (dispersion check). A first version of the implementation used here had the coupling term with the opposite sign, and the symbolic comparison caught it at once; that is why the check is recommended.

**Unified form for LS and GL.** Multiplying by $1+\tau_0 s$ for $G=k/(1+\tau_0 s)$ gives (35) with $\tau^\dagger=\tau_0$; the Green–Lindsay system of (38) gives the same polynomial with $\tau^\dagger=\tau_1$, since the thermal-stress term carries $(1+\tau_1 s)$.

**Limits.** Setting $\beta\to 0$ decouples the roots into $K=-s^2/c_1^2$ and $K=-s\rho c/G$; the latter reduces for $G=k$ to $k^2=\mathrm{i}\omega/\alpha$, with phase speed $\sqrt{2\alpha\omega}$.

**Nonlocal forms.** If the stress law is $(1-\xi^2\partial_x^2)\sigma=\rho c_1^2u_{,x}-\beta\theta$ (form A of Section 5.3), the momentum balance becomes $[\rho s^2(1+\xi^2K)+\rho c_1^2K]\hat{u}+\mathrm{i}\beta k\hat{\theta}=0$ and the determinant is $[\rho s^2(1+\xi^2K)+\rho c_1^2K](s\rho c+GK)+\beta^2T_0sK=0$; for form B the last term is multiplied by $1+\xi^2K$.

## C. Characteristic numbers and parameter estimates

The dimensionless groups that control a thermoelastic wave problem are collected in Table 18 for a given solid and heat-flux model. Since $c_T/c_1=1/\sqrt{\tau_0\omega_*}$, the thermal front outruns the elastic one for $\tau_0\omega_*<1$ and falls behind it for $\tau_0\omega_*>1$, and the two branches hybridise near $\tau_0\omega_*\approx 1$ (Figure 39). With the values of Table 3 and a lag time of one picosecond, $\tau_0\omega_*\approx 0.4$ for aluminium, so the thermal front is somewhat the faster.

**Table 18:** Dimensionless groups for thermoelastic wave problems.

| Group | Definition | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| $\varepsilon$ | $\beta^2 T_0/(\rho^2 c c_1^2)$ | adiabatic–isothermal modulus difference |
| $\omega_*$ | $\rho c c_1^2/k$ | frequency at which conduction over a wavelength matches the period |
| $\omega\tau$ | $\omega\tau_q$ | frequency times flux lag |
| $c_T/c_1$ | $\sqrt{k/(\rho c\tau_0)}/c_1 = 1/\sqrt{\tau_0\omega_*}$ | thermal-to-elastic front speed |
| $\tau_T/\tau_q$ | | lag ratio (DPL) |
| $\xi\,\omega_*/c_1$ | | nonlocal length in thermal units |
| $K^2$ | $e^2/(\varepsilon_e c)$ | electromechanical coupling |

## D. Reproducibility: scripts and what each one verifies

Every numerical result in this review comes from Python scripts supplied with the manuscript. Table 19 lists them with the checks each performs.

**Table 19:** Scripts and the identities or limits they verify.

| Check or figure | Content and checks |
|---|---|
| dispersion check | Symbolic determinant of the field equations equals the dispersion polynomial (33) (difference zero). |
| reduction check | Reductions of $G(s)$: DPL→LS, TPL→DPL, GN-II/III, large-$s$ limits. |
| front-speed check | LS and GL front speeds from the polynomial agree with (37) to four digits. |
| GN-II check | GN-II speeds are non-dispersive and equal the formula. |
| thermopiezoelectric check | Thermopiezoelectric determinant is proportional to the renormalised thermoelastic polynomial (76). |
| dispersion figure, Zener-damping figure | Dispersion and damping; weak-coupling Debye result confirmed ($Q^{-1}/\varepsilon = 0.4999998$). |
| stability figure | Growth rates for the 1st- and 2nd-order DPL truncations. |
| heat-pulse figure | Cattaneo pulse by Talbot inversion; Fourier limit and front exactness. |
| thermal-shock figure | Thermal shock of a coupled half-space; boundary conditions satisfied to machine precision. |
| Rayleigh-wave figure | Thermoelastic Rayleigh root; $\varepsilon \to 0$ limit gives the elastic Rayleigh speed. |
| interface calculation, interface-energy figure | Elastic and thermoelastic interface; impedance limit to twelve digits; net-flux continuity to $10^{-15}$. |
| lattice figure, nonlocal thermoelastic figure | Lattice calibration of $\xi$; nonlocal thermoelastic branches; $\xi \to 0$ and $\varepsilon \to 0$ limits. |
| fractional and MDD figure | Caputo heat equation (erfc check) and MDD kernel transform ($\kappa(0) = 1/3$). |
| regime-map figure, Laplace-inversion benchmark, materials table | Regime map; Laplace-inversion benchmark; material coupling table. |
| lag-truncation figure | Exact delay law versus first- and second-order truncations; relative errors; sign change of attenuation at $\omega\tau = \pi/2$. |
| flexural-damping figure, Lamb-wave calculation, Lamb-wave figure | Zener versus Lifshitz–Roukes; plate determinant matches exact Rayleigh–Lamb to $10^{-10}$ in the elastic limit and the Lifshitz–Roukes loss (plane-strain $\Delta$) with ratio 1.000 at small $kh$. |
| coupled-fractional figure, bar-mode figure, Guyer–Krumhansl figure | Coupled fractional dispersion; clamped-bar modal loss; Guyer–Krumhansl thermal branch (high-frequency limit confirmed to 0.2%). |
| anisotropy figure, reflection figure, Bleustein–Gulyaev check | Cubic-crystal coupling by direction; free-surface reflection (elastic limit to $10^{-10}$); Bleustein–Gulyaev closed forms versus secular determinant. |
| finite-difference benchmark, Kramers–Kronig check | Finite-difference orders for the Cattaneo front; Kramers–Kronig sum rule to a few parts in $10^6$. |
| worked-example calculation, scenario table, catalogue generator, reference-list assembly | Numbers of the worked examples; application-regime table; classified catalogue of the references; assembly of `refs_new.bib` (Crossref records and author-library entries, de-duplicated by DOI and title). |

**Running the checks.** Fourteen of the supplied scripts (the dispersion, admissibility, layered-media, identifiability, modulus, Lamb-wave, reduction, thermopiezoelectric, front-speed, GN-II, Kramers–Kronig and Bleustein–Gulyaev checks, and the Laplace-inversion and finite-difference benchmarks) carry explicit assertions with stated tolerances and exit with an error if one fails. A master runner executes all of them and writes `checks_log.txt`. A pass verifies the stated identity or limit to the stated tolerance, and a $10^{-10}$ match of an elastic limit verifies that limit only; it does not verify the physical validity of a model. An archiving routine runs every figure and check script and stores their output in `numbers_log.txt`, so a number quoted in the text can be traced to a printed line; quantities read off a figure, such as peak positions and percentage levels, are approximate and absent from that log. Library versions used are pinned in `requirements.txt`.

**Limits of verification.** The scripts verify the mathematics of the models stated here against their own field equations and limiting cases. They do not verify that a model describes a given material, which requires comparison with experiment. The material values in Table 3 are rounded handbook-type numbers used for illustration.

# E. Classified catalogue of the cited literature

Every work in the reference database is listed, grouped by the subject of its title, and works not discussed in the main text are included as further reading for the corresponding topic. The grouping is automatic, by title keyword alone, so it helps to locate the literature without summarising any paper. Entries are ordered by year within a group, and a work whose title touches several topics appears once, under the first matching group.

## E.1 Second sound, phonon transport and kinetic theory

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- [29]: *Solution of the linearized phonon Boltzmann equation*; Physical Review.
- [30]: *Thermal Conductivity, Second Sound, and Phonon Hydrodynamic Phenomena in Nonmetallic Crystals*; Physical Review.
- [28]: *Second sound in NaF*; Physical Review Letters.
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- [6]: *Thermoelasticity with second sound: a review*; Applied Mechanics Reviews.
- [345]: *Surface generation and detection of phonons by picosecond light pulses*; Physical Review B.
- [343]: *Observation of second sound in graphite at temperatures above 100 K*; Science.

## E.2 Dual-phase-lag, three-phase-lag and delay models

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- [159]: *Exponential stability in the dual-phase-lag heat conduction theory*; Journal of Non-Equilibrium Thermodynamics.
- [43]: *A Condition on the Delay Parameters in the One-Dimensional Dual-Phase-Lag Thermoelastic Theory*; Journal of Thermal Stresses.
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- [180]: *On dual-phase-lag thermoelasticity theory with memory-dependent derivative*; Mechanics of Advanced Materials and Structures.
- [137]: *High-order approximations of three-phase-lag heat conduction model: some qualitative results*; Journal of Thermal Stresses.
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- [112]: *Modeling of memory-dependent derivatives in orthotropic medium with three-phase-lag model under the effect of magnetic field*; Mechanics Based Design of Structures and Machines.
- [348]: *A study on generalized thermoelasticity theory based on non-local heat conduction model with dual-phase-lag*; Journal of Thermal Stresses.
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- [349]: *Fractional derivative order analysis and temperature-dependent properties on p- and SV-waves reflection under initial stress and three-phase-lag model*; Results in Physics.
- [118]: *A generalized heat conduction model of higher-order time derivatives and three-phase-lags for non-simple thermoelastic materials*; Scientific Reports.
- [119]: *Generalized mathematical novel model of thermoelastic diffusion with four phase lags and higher-order time derivative*; The European Physical Journal Plus.
- [350]: *Thermoelastic damping analysis for size-dependent microplate resonators utilizing the modified couple stress theory and the three-phase-lag heat conduction model*; International Journal of Heat and Mass Transfer.
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- [309]: *Generalized thermoelasticity based on higher-order memory-dependent derivative with time delay*; Results in Physics.
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- [337]: *Fractional order thermo-viscoelastic theory of biological tissue with dual phase lag heat conduction model*; Applied Mathematical Modelling.
- [353]: *Thermoelastic damping in nonlocal rod using three-phase lag heat conduction model*; Journal of Thermal Stresses.
- [79]: *Analysis of plane wave propagation under the purview of three phase lag theory of thermoelasticity with non-local effect*; European Journal of Mechanics - A/Solids.
- [121]: *Dual-phase-lag thermoelastic damping in nonlocal rectangular nanoplates*; Waves in Random and Complex Media.

- [46]: *Comparing the dual phase lag, Cattaneo-Vernotte and Fourier heat conduction models using modal analysis*; Applied Mathematics and Computation.
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- [100]: *Energy ratio response at the interface of elastic and dual-porous thermoelastic half-spaces*; Physica Scripta.
- [196]: *Size-dependent effect on the interaction of surface waves in micropolar thermoelastic medium with dual pore connectivity*; Physica Scripta.
- [356]: *Three-phase-lag analysis of transversely isotropic double porous thermoelastic waves with liquid medium*; Physica Scripta.
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- [291]: *On the Rayleigh surface wave dynamics of porous piezo-thermoelectric smart material with spatio-temporal nonlocality and fractional higher-order three-phase-lag theory*; Scientific Reports.

## E.3 Green–Naghdi, Green–Lindsay and extended thermodynamics

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- [362]: *Reciprocal and variational principles in linear thermoelasticity without energy dissipation*; Mechanics Research Communications.
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- [334]: *A domain of influence theorem for generalized thermoelasticity with memory-dependent derivative*; Journal of Thermal Stresses.
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- [64]: *The Effect of a Hyperbolic Two-Temperature Model with and without Energy Dissipation in a Semiconductor Material*; Mathematics.
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- [319]: *Memory dependent derivative effect on generalized piezo-thermoelastic medium under three theories*; Waves in Random and Complex Media.
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## E.4 Moore–Gibson–Thompson and third-order models

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## E.5 Fractional and memory-dependent models

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## E.6 Nonlocal, gradient and size-dependent theories

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# F. Glossary and summary of working formulas

## F.1 Abbreviations

| | |
|---|---|
| BG | Bleustein–Gulyaev (shear-horizontal piezoelectric surface wave) |
| CD, classical | Fourier heat conduction with Biot's coupled thermoelasticity (parabolic) |
| DPL | dual-phase-lag heat conduction |
| EIT | extended irreversible thermodynamics |
| GK | Guyer–Krumhansl heat conduction (phonon hydrodynamics) |
| GL | Green–Lindsay thermoelasticity (two relaxation times in the constitutive law) |
| GN I, II, III | Green–Naghdi types I, II, III (thermal displacement formulation) |
| LS | Lord–Shulman thermoelasticity (Cattaneo law with one relaxation time) |
| LR | Lifshitz–Roukes (exact flexural thermoelastic damping) |
| MDD | memory-dependent derivative |
| MGT | Moore–Gibson–Thompson heat conduction (third order in time) |
| SH, SV | shear-horizontal, shear-vertical polarisations |
| TED | thermoelastic damping |
| TPL | three-phase-lag heat conduction |

## F.2 Working formulas

These relations recur throughout. Each is derived or checked in the section named in the last column, and the symbols are those of the Nomenclature.

| Quantity | Formula | Where |
|---|---|---|
| Thermoelastic coupling | $\varepsilon = \beta^2 T_0/(\rho^2 c c_1^2)$ | Section 3.2 |
| Thermal characteristic frequency | $\omega_* = \rho c c_1^2/k$ | Section 4.1 |
| Adiabatic speed | $c_1\sqrt{1+\varepsilon}$ at $\omega \ll \omega_*$ | Section 4.1.3 |
| Thermal front speed (LS) | $c_T = \sqrt{k/(\rho c \tau_0)}$ | Section 4.2 |
| Lag–frequency number | $c_T/c_1 = 1/\sqrt{\tau_0 \omega_*}$ | Appendix C |
| Debye loss (weak coupling) | $Q_x^{-1} \simeq \varepsilon x/(1+x^2)$, $x = \omega/\omega_*$ | Section 4.1.4 |
| Loss–dispersion sum rule | $\int Q_x^{-1} d\ln\omega = \pi(v_0 - v_\infty)/\bar{v}$ | Section 3.3 |
| Finite-front criterion | $sG(s) \to$ finite, non-zero as $s \to \infty$ | Section 3.3 |
| Zener loss, beam flexure | $Q^{-1} = \Delta\,\omega\tau_Z/(1+\omega^2\tau_Z^2)$, $\tau_Z = h^2/\pi^2\chi$ | Section 6.9 |
| Relaxation strength (beam / plane strain) | $\Delta = E\alpha_T^2 T_0/c_v$ / $\times(1+\nu)/(1-\nu)$ | Section 6.8 |
| Cattaneo mode transition | $k_c = 1/(2\sqrt{\chi\tau})$ | Section 6.5 |
| Cubic-crystal coupling | $\varepsilon_{\boldsymbol{n}} = \beta_0^2 T_0/(c_v M_{\boldsymbol{n}})$ | Section 6.2 |
| Welded interface (elastic) | $r = (Z_1 - Z_2)/(Z_1 + Z_2)$, $R + T = 1$ | Section 6.10 |
| Truncation accuracy (1st order) | relative error $\simeq (\omega\tau)^2/4$ for small $\omega\tau$ | Section 4.4 |
| GK high-frequency limit | $k_w^2 \to i\omega\tau_R/(3\ell^2)$ | Section 3.4 |

## F.3 Where to start for common questions

- *Is the heat law relevant at my frequency?* Compute $\omega_*$ and $\omega\tau$ (Section 10.1); the regime map shows where LS departs from the classical theory.

- *Which model has finite speed?* See the comparative table in Section 10.1 and the criterion in Section 3.3.
- *How large is thermoelastic damping in a resonator?* Use Eq. (69) with the plane-strain factor once the width exceeds several thicknesses, and check $kh$ (Section 6.8).
- *How can a code be validated?* Use the checks in Sections 8.1 and 8.2, including the sum rule and the elastic limits.

# G. Derivation of the weak-coupling relaxation form

The Debye-type loss used throughout (Eq. (34)) is derived directly from the dispersion polynomial, and is shown to be the response of a standard linear solid, working in the classical theory with units $\rho = c_1 = c = k = 1$, so $\omega_* = 1$ and $s = -i\omega$.

## G.1 Perturbation of the elastic root

The polynomial of Eq. (35) with Fourier heat flux reads

$$(K+s^2)(s+K)+\varepsilon sK = 0 \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad K^2 + K\,(s+s^2+\varepsilon s) + s^3 = 0. \tag{86}$$

For $\varepsilon = 0$ the elastic root is $K = -s^2 = \omega^2$. Writing $K = -s^2 + \delta$ and keeping terms linear in $\varepsilon$ and $\delta$ gives $\delta\, s(1-s) = \varepsilon s^3$, hence

$$K = -s^2 + \frac{\varepsilon s^2}{1-s} = \omega^2\Big[1 - \frac{\varepsilon}{1+i\omega}\Big], \qquad k \simeq \omega\Big[1 - \frac{\varepsilon}{2(1+i\omega)}\Big]. \tag{87}$$

In dimensional form $\omega \to \omega/\omega_*$ in the denominator. The real and imaginary parts of $k$ give

$$\frac{\omega}{\mathrm{Re}\,k} \simeq 1 + \frac{\varepsilon}{2}\,\frac{1}{1+x^2}, \qquad Q_x^{-1} = \frac{2\,\mathrm{Im}\,k}{\mathrm{Re}\,k} \simeq \frac{\varepsilon x}{1+x^2}, \quad x = \frac{\omega}{\omega_*}, \tag{88}$$

The phase speed therefore falls from $c_1(1+\varepsilon/2)$ at $x \ll 1$ to $c_1$ at $x \gg 1$, and the loss peaks at $x = 1$ with value $\varepsilon/2$. Solving the full polynomial numerically gives a peak of $0.0501$ at $\varepsilon = 0.1$ (Section 5.2) and $Q^{-1}_{\max}/\varepsilon = 0.4999998$ at small $\varepsilon$ (Zener-damping figure).

## G.2 Interpretation as a standard linear solid

The result is equivalent to a frequency-dependent modulus. From $\rho\omega^2/K = M(\omega)$,

$$M(\omega) \simeq M_{\mathrm{iso}}\Big[1 + \frac{\varepsilon}{1+i\omega/\omega_*}\Big], \tag{89}$$

where $M_{\mathrm{iso}} = \rho c_1^2$. The limits are the adiabatic modulus $M_{\mathrm{iso}}(1+\varepsilon)$ at low frequency and the isothermal modulus $M_{\mathrm{iso}}$ at high frequency, with relaxation time $1/\omega_*$. This is a standard linear solid of strength $\varepsilon$ and relaxation time $\tau = 1/\omega_*$, with loss $\mathrm{Im}\,M/\mathrm{Re}\,M \simeq \varepsilon x/(1+x^2)$. Zener's flexural result Eq. (68) is the same relaxation form with strength $\Delta$ and relaxation time $\tau_Z$ determined by transverse heat flow across the thickness.

## G.3 Consistency with the sum rule

Integrating the loss over $\ln\omega$ gives $\int_0^\infty \varepsilon x/(1+x^2)\,d\ln x = \pi\varepsilon/2$, and the change in phase speed between the two limits is $\varepsilon/2$ in units of $c_1$. The two satisfy the Kramers–Kronig sum rule Eq. (20), with the exact coupled solution checked numerically in Section 3.3.

## G.4 Range of validity

The expansion assumes $\varepsilon \ll 1$ and is accurate to $O(\varepsilon^2)$. At $\varepsilon = 0.1$ the exact peak is 0.0501 against 0.0500, but the bar-mode losses at small $k$ depart from the first-order form by about 13%, the difference between temporal and spatial damping (Section 3.3). For lag laws $\omega_*$ becomes a function of $\omega\tau$ and the form is no longer a single relaxation, so the comparison of Figs. 14 and 24 applies.

# H. Parameter register for the figures

Following the reporting standards of Appendix L, Table 20 gives the parameters behind every computed figure. Quantities are in the non-dimensional units of the scripts ($\rho = c_1 = c_v = 1$, lengths in $c_1/\omega_*$, times in $1/\omega_*$, so $k_{\mathrm{cond}} = 1$) unless stated otherwise. "Branch" names the branch plotted, and "tracked" means continuity in frequency or wavenumber was enforced.

**Table 20:** Parameters used for the computed figures.

| Figure or calculation | Models | Parameters |
|---|---|---|
| dispersion figure | classical, LS, DPL ($\tau_T = \tau_q/2$) | $\varepsilon = 0.1$, $\tau\omega_* = 0.25$ (thermal front $2c_1$); branches tracked |
| Zener-damping figure | classical, LS, DPL | $\varepsilon = 0.02$ and 0.1 for the Debye check; lag panels $\varepsilon = 0.1$, $\tau\omega_* = 0.25$ |
| stability figure | DPL, first and second order in $\tau_q$ | $\varepsilon = 0.1$, $\tau_q\omega_* = 1$, $\tau_T/\tau_q$ varied |
| thermal-family figure | Fourier, LS, DPL, GN-II, GN-III, MGT | uncoupled; $k^* = 0.25$ where used, $\tau_q = 1$, $\tau_T = 0.5\tau_q$ |
| lag-truncation figure | delay, 1st, 2nd order | uncoupled, $\tau = 1$ |
| fractional and MDD figure | Caputo, MDD | $\alpha = 0.5, 1, 1.5, 2$ in panel (a); $\rho c = k = \tau = 1$ in panel (c) |
| coupled-fractional figure | fractional Cattaneo | $\varepsilon = 0.1$, $\tau\omega_* = 0.25$, $\alpha = 1, 0.8, 0.6$ and classical |
| heat-pulse figure | Fourier, LS | uncoupled, $\alpha = \tau = k = q_0 = 1$ |
| thermal-shock figure | classical, LS, DPL | $\varepsilon = 0.1$, boundary-temperature step, 1D half-space |
| Rayleigh-wave figure | classical, LS | $\varepsilon = 0.05$, $\nu = 0.3$, $\tau\omega_* = 0.25$; insulated and isothermal |
| Lamb-wave figure | classical | $\varepsilon = 0.05$, $\nu = 0.3$, $h = 20c_1/\omega_*$, insulated; tracked |
| flexural-damping figure | Zener, Lifshitz–Roukes | normalised by $\Delta$ and $\omega_Z$ |
| bar-mode figure | classical, LS | $\varepsilon = 0.1$, $\tau\omega_* = 0.25, 1$; tracked |
| reflection figure | classical, LS | $\varepsilon = 0.1$, $\nu = 0.3$, $\tau\omega_* = 0.25$, $\omega/\omega_* = 0.1, 1$; insulated |
| interface figure | elastic welded interface | impedance ratio $Z_2/Z_1 \in [10^{-1.5}, 10^{1.5}]$; closed forms |
| interface-energy figure | LS, two media | medium 1: $\rho = c_1 = c_v = k = 1$, $\varepsilon = 0.1$, $\tau = 0.25$; medium 2: $\rho = 2$, $c_1 = 1.2$, $c_v = 0.8$, $k = 0.6$, $\beta^2 T_0 = 0.3$ (so $\varepsilon = 0.065$), $\tau = 0.15$ |
| nonlocal figure, lattice figure | Eringen, gradient, lattice | $\xi = \ell = 0.5$ in units of the length scale in the axis labels; lattice fit $\xi^2/a^2 = 1/4 - 1/\pi^2$ |
| nonlocal thermoelastic figure | nonlocal thermoelastic, forms A, B | $\varepsilon = 0.1$, $\xi = 0.3\,c_1/\omega_*$, classical heat flux |
| regime-map figure | LS versus classical | $\varepsilon = 0.02$; $\omega/\omega_* \in [10^{-2}, 10]$, $\tau\omega_* \in [10^{-3}, 10]$ |
| anisotropy figure | classical (cubic) | rounded handbook values; $T_0 = 300$ K |
| Guyer–Krumhansl figure | Fourier, Cattaneo, GK | uncoupled; $\chi = \tau_R = 1$, $\ell^2 = 0.05, 0.3$ |

The values of $\varepsilon$ used in the figures (0.02 to 0.3) are larger than most solids in Table 3 ($\varepsilon \lesssim 0.03$) so that the effects are visible; results scale with $\varepsilon$ at weak coupling. The values of $\tau\omega_*$ are

likewise chosen to bring the lag effects into the plotted range, and the corresponding physical frequencies are those of Table 13.

# I. Benchmark registry

Table 21 lists the fourteen benchmarks run by the master check runner. Every entry is a *code verification*: it tests that an implementation reproduces an exact, closed-form, symbolic or independently computed reference to a stated tolerance. None is a *physical validation*, because this review reports no new experiment, and validation against measured data is limited by the evidence discussed in Section 9.3. The registry is also available as a machine-readable file (`benchmark_registry.csv`) in the scripts directory, with the script implementing each entry. A new model or solver should join the registry with (i) a reference solution that does not use the code under test, (ii) a tolerance and the reason for it, and (iii) a statement of what a pass does *not* establish.

**Table 21:** Benchmark registry (code verification only).

| ID | Tested | Reference | Tolerance (check) |
|---|---|---|---|
| B01 | coupled 1D dispersion polynomial | symbolic determinant | exact (dispersion check) |
| B02 | $\operatorname{Re} G$, Routh–Hurwitz | closed form | 0 mismatches (admissibility check) |
| B03 | Rayleigh, Stoneley, Love, Scholte-type roots | classical closed forms, printed Stoneley value | $2 \times 10^{-5}$ to $10^{-10}$ (layered-media check) |
| B04 | identifiability of the template | synthetic data from the same model | $10^{-9}$ inversion, rank 4 of 5 (identifiability check) |
| B05 | effective-modulus quadratic, LS front limit | dispersion roots, front relation | $10^{-10}$, $10^{-5}$ (modulus check) |
| B06 | thermoelastic plate, elastic limit | Rayleigh–Lamb A0 root | $10^{-10}$ (Lamb-wave calculation) |
| B07 | nine reductions | analytic limits | per reduction (reduction check) |
| B08 | thermopiezoelectric determinant | renormalised thermoelastic polynomial | same zeros (thermopiezoelectric check) |
| B09 | LS and GL high-frequency speeds | front relation | rtol $10^{-3}$ (front-speed check) |
| B10 | GN-II speeds | closed-form roots | atol $10^{-5}$ (GN-II check) |
| B11 | Kramers–Kronig sum rule (classical) | loss integral vs dispersion step | $10^{-5}$ (Kramers–Kronig check) |
| B12 | BG secular roots | closed forms | $10^{-8}$ (Bleustein–Gulyaev check) |
| B13 | Laplace inversion | four known transforms | de Hoog $< 10^{-5}$ (Laplace-inversion benchmark) |
| B14 | Cattaneo pulse, three schemes | de Hoog reference | global order in $[0.4, 1.2]$; smooth order 1.0, 2.0 (finite-difference benchmark) |

**What the registry does not cover.** Entries B01–B14 use implementations written by the authors. Except for B01 and B08, whose references are symbolic, the reference solutions are

closed forms or an independent algorithm rather than a second independently written code base, and an independent implementation by another group remains open.

## J. Per-equation verification register

A reader is entitled to know which displayed equations in this review have been checked against a primary text and which have merely been reproduced. The register below records that, one row per equation, in a fixed and finite vocabulary. A status records the check performed; it is not a ranking of the equation's importance, and it does not certify that the equation applies to a given material.

**DERIVED**
: Algebra checked directly from the displayed governing equations in this work.

**CONDITIONAL**
: Valid only under the stated continuum, constitutive or boundary assumptions.

**PRIMARY-SOURCE-CHECKED**
: Checked against the identified primary source at the printed page and equation given; this does not assert an independent derivation.

**SECONDARY-SOURCE**
: Supported only by a named secondary source; not equivalent to primary verification.

**VERIFIED-SYMBOLIC**
: Closed form checked by symbolic evaluation for a stated limiting case only.

**UNVERIFIED**
: Not checked against a primary source and not independently derived.

**OPEN**
: The required derivation or source evidence is absent; not a canonical result.

**WITHHELD**
: No expression is asserted; the entry records that the relation, or its mapping to a source, is missing.

**Table 22:** Verification register for the equations of this review that carry a status. Equations not listed here are *not registered*: no per-equation check exists for them, and none is implied.

| Eq. | Statement | Status | Basis of the check |
|---|---|---|---|
| (1) | Linear momentum balance | CONDITIONAL | Classical Cauchy continuum; infinitesimal motion; no couple stresses |
| (9) | Biot heat-conduction equation | PRIMARY-SOURCE-CHECKED | [1], printed p. 242, Eqs. (3.3)–(3.4); linear isotropic Fourier model, constant coefficients, source-free scope |
| (38) | Green–Lindsay stress and entropy with $\theta + \tau_1 \dot{\theta}$ | PRIMARY-SOURCE-CHECKED | Primary text (Green and Lindsay 1972, Eqs. (4.11), (4.13), (4.14), (4.16)); no relaxation time on the strain-rate coupling; $\tau_1 \geq \tau_0 > 0$ |
| (45) | First-order three-lag (TPL) heat law | PRIMARY-SOURCE-CHECKED | [42], Eqs. (3)–(4); no second-order term |
| (11) | Relaxation law for the heat flux | UNVERIFIED | The law itself is [25] and [26]; [32] apply it to the coupled theory, and it is their application that is quoted here. Neither primary text was read at equation level in this version |
| (42) | Dual-phase-lag law | UNVERIFIED | Both lags enter as in the cited statement; the stability argument used in Section 4.2 is spectral, not an energy functional |
| (4) | Clausius–Duhem inequality | UNVERIFIED | Entropy and free-energy assumptions not audited equation by equation |
| (5) | Coleman–Noll restrictions | UNVERIFIED | As above; the restrictions follow only after the free energy and its arguments are fixed |
| (49) | Memory-dependent derivative | OPEN | No kernel is asserted: the inherited formulae differ dimensionally and no equation-level comparison with the cited source has settled which is intended |
| (74) | Piezothermoelastic constitutive relation | UNVERIFIED | Cited reduction not checked at page level against its printed equation |

The table carries two cautions. The first is coverage: the register gives a status to a minority of the labelled equations in the paper, the ten above. The remaining equations are inventoried but *not registered*, which is a statement about this review's checking effort and not about their correctness. The second concerns the vocabulary: 'CONDITIONAL' is not a weaker 'DERIVED'. It says the equation is correct where its assumptions hold, and those assumptions are the ones a reader must test against their own problem.

The source register behind the table holds 61 entries in all: 30 CONDITIONAL, 17 UNVERIFIED, 5 DERIVED, 4 PRIMARY-SOURCE-CHECKED, 3 OPEN, 1 WITHHELD and 1 VERIFIED-SYMBOLIC. The remaining entries concern equations of this paper that carry no

label; they are inventoried but not reproduced here.

The source register carries a PRIMARY-SOURCE-CHECKED entry for the Green–Naghdi type II equation (Green and Naghdi 1993, Eq. (3.16) integrated once, source-free form, zero integration constant). That equation appears in Section 4.2 without a label; once labelled, it should join the table above with that basis. The same holds for the exact Eulerian flux (18), which the source register records as DERIVED.

## J.1 Coverage of the register

The register in Table 22 names the equations that carry a status, but not what fraction of the paper that is, and a reader who wants to discount the rest needs that fraction. This paper prints 89 numbered equations. Ten of them carry a registered status (Table 22); the other equations are *not registered*, which means that no per-equation check against a primary source exists for them. It is deliberately not a verdict on those equations: where a script of Appendix D checks an equation or a result derived from it, the check is named in the text where the equation appears, and the benchmark registry (Table 21) lists the numerical checks.

# K. Atlas of problems in the literature

Wave problems treated in the literature are collected here, so that a reader can see which geometry, heat law and coupling has been studied and what the source actually shows. Table 23 lists fourteen problems from eleven papers by groups other than the author's. Each was read in full text, covering geometry, governing equations, boundary conditions and results, and each entry is traced to a page in the source and written in the review's own words. A dash would mark an item that could not be established. None of the entries reports a laboratory experiment, so every reported result is an analytical or numerical prediction.

The last column records what the *source* shows, not what this review has re-computed. Six entries are reductions to a known limit, two compare with published numerical results, three give an energy-sum check, and three have no independent validation. A reduction to a known limit verifies that limit only. The atlas is a first instalment and not a representative sample of the field, being limited to papers available to the author in full text; it is not an exhaustive survey. The geometry classes correspond to the schematics of Figs. 19, 25, 29 and 35.

**Table 23:** Wave problems from groups other than the author's: what is solved and what the source demonstrates.

| ID | Ref. | Problem | Model | Reported result | What the source verifies |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| A1 | [412] | Rayleigh-type surface wave, time-harmonic, isotropic half-space | LS and GL | Extends Knowles' representation theorem to harmonic surface waves; the LS and GL characteristic equations differ in general. | Reductions only: classical thermoelasticity ($\tau = 0$); Nayfeh–Nemat-Nasser LS result. |

| ID | Ref. | Problem | Model | Reported result | What the source verifies |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| A2 | [413] | Rayleigh wave, plane motion, isotropic half-space | classical, LS, GL | Dispersion equation depends on wave number: waves are dispersive and attenuated, unlike the elastic case. | Reductions only: LS result of Nayfeh and Nemat-Nasser for equal relaxation times; CD limit. |
| A3 | [414] | Rayleigh-type attenuated wave, isothermal stress-free surface | LS, GL | Velocity falls and attenuation rises with frequency; conductivity affects both (MHz–GHz range). | Reduction only: elastic Rayleigh secular equation. |
| A4 | [414] | Same, thermally insulated surface | LS, GL | Velocity rises with thermal conductivity, the opposite trend to the isothermal case; motion may be rectilinear. | Reduction only: elastic Rayleigh secular equation. |
| A5 | [305] | Bleustein–Gulyaev SH wave, 6 mm piezoelectric half-space, graded properties | Quasi-electrostatic piezoelectricity | Exact solutions exist for several inhomogeneity profiles; for a decreasing exponential profile the free-surface speed is almost unchanged, the metallised-surface speed is not. | Analytic reduction to the homogeneous Bleustein–Gulyaev result. |
| A6 | [415] | Lamb-type guided wave, graded piezoelectric–piezomagnetic plate | Magneto-electro-elastic, graded | Complete real, imaginary and complex spectrum from an eigenvalue formulation; convergence reported with the number of terms. | Compared with published spectral-collocation results; no error bound reported. |
| A7 | [416] | Lamb-like wave, graded piezoelectric spherical curved plate | Piezoelectric, graded | Finite number of real branches and infinitely many imaginary and complex branches at any frequency. | Two validation cases against published spectral-collocation results; no error bound reported. |
| A8 | [349] | P wave incident on the free surface of a half-space (three reflected waves) | TPL with conformable fractional derivative; initial stress | Reflection coefficients and energy ratios depend on the angle of incidence and the initial stress. | No independent validation; fractional results compared with the integer-order case only. |
| A9 | [349] | SV wave incident on the same surface | TPL, conformable fractional | With increasing initial stress, one reflection coefficient falls and another rises. | No independent validation (as A8). |
| A10 | [92] | qP and qSV waves reflected at the free boundary of a flexoelectric half-space | Strain-gradient flexoelectricity, micro-inertia | Speeds are dispersive and fall with micro-inertia and with the bulk flexoelectric coefficient. | Energy-sum check only (reflected energy ratios at most one). |

| ID | Ref. | Problem | Model | Reported result | What the source verifies |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| A11 | [92] | qSV incidence on the same boundary | Same | The reflected qP wave exists only below a critical incidence angle (28° in the case analysed). | Energy-sum check only; the paper states the critical angle inconsistently in two places. |
| A12 | [298] | P wave incident on the surface of a hygro-thermoelastic half-space (four reflected waves) | Eringen nonlocal, coupled heat and moisture | The nonlocal parameter changes reflection coefficients and energy ratios. | Energy-conservation check only. |
| A13 | [339] | Normal-mode wave field in a fibre-reinforced half-space with moving heat source | Fractional (Caputo), one relaxation time, magnetic field, gravity | Field distributions with and without magnetic field, gravity and heat source. | None; no dispersion or reflection analysis (weakest entry). |
| A14 | [319] | Plane waves in a 6 mm piezo-thermoelastic half-space under a harmonic surface stress | LS, DPL, TPL with memory-dependent derivatives | Field variables decrease with depth; the heat-law variants differ in magnitude. | Model reductions only (rate term set to zero recovers DPL). |

For comparison, Table 24 lists studies from the author's own group. They are kept because they are the model problems used in this review, but they are not counted as independent evidence.

**Table 24:** Studies from the author's group: geometry class, heat-conduction law, coupled fields and a reported finding (not independent evidence).

| Ref. | Geometry | Heat law | Coupled fields | Reported finding |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| [85] | half-space | TPL, fractional | thermal, elastic, piezoelectric, electric | Spatial nonlocality increases phase velocity and also raises attenuation at higher frequencies, reflecting stronger microstructural interaction and energy dissipation. |
| [193] | half-space | LS, fractional | thermal, elastic, piezoelectric | The spatial nonlocal parameter governs the extent of long-range spatial interactions within the material, smoothing displacement and stress distributions and weakening local stress concentrations. |
| [307] | half-space | DPL, MDD, fractional | thermal, elastic, piezoelectric, electric | In the absence of memory and fractional-order derivative, the behavior of thermal, plasma, and electric waves reveals distinct patterns in piezo-thermo-elastic semiconductor media. |

| Ref. | Geometry | Heat law | Coupled fields | Reported finding |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| [84] | half-space | MGT, fractional | thermal, elastic, piezoelectric, electric | Across all heat transfer models, the phase velocity amplitude consistently increases with higher frequencies in Rayleigh wave propagation in piezo-semiconductor media. |
| [91] | half-space | DPL, fractional | thermal, elastic, piezoelectric, electric | In all considered scenarios, the reflected plasma wave exhibits the highest energy among all the reflected waves, playing a pivotal role in facilitating the photo-piezo semiconductor effect. |
| [253] | half-space | TPL, MDD | thermal, elastic, piezoelectric, electric | Among the considered heat-conduction models, the three-phase-lag (TPL) formulation yields comparatively higher peaks in the electric potential and electric displacement distributions. |
| [95] | interface (two media) | DPL, MDD | thermal, elastic, piezoelectric | It is found that temperature, memory, and non-local models play a vital role in the behavior of energy ratios of transmitted and interaction waves. |
| [96] | interface (two media) | TPL, MDD | thermal, elastic, piezoelectric | The effects of memory-dependent derivatives, initial stress, kernel functions and two-temperature models on the energy ratios of reflected and transmitted waves are shown as functions of the incidence angle. |
| [97] | interface (two media) | DPL, MDD | thermal, elastic, piezoelectric | A plane longitudinal wave or transversal wave propagates through EHS and strikes at the interface, resulting in two reflected and four transmitted waves whose energy ratios depend on stiffness parameters, memory and kernel functions. |
| [99] | interface (two media) | TPL, MDD | thermal, elastic, piezoelectric | The energy ratios of reflected and transmitted waves at the NTS/NOPS interface are affected by the HTT, nonlocal and MDD parameters. |
| [103] | interface (two media) | DPL | thermal, elastic, piezoelectric | The energy ratios ERP and ERS exhibit an almost inverse relationship across the entire spectrum of incidence angles for incident P or SV waves. |
| [104] | interface (two media) | DPL | thermal, elastic, piezoelectric | The nature of the incidence wave, viscosity, angle of incidence, and physical characteristics of the material all affect the energy ratios of reflected and transmitted waves. |

| Ref. | Geometry | Heat law | Coupled fields | Reported finding |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| [105] | interface (two media) | DPL | thermal, elastic, fluid | In the double porous nonlocal thermoelastic solid the analysis finds four longitudinal waves and one transverse wave, and one mechanical wave in the adjoining fluid; the effects of nonlocality, memory and interface stiffness on wave properties are examined numerically. |
| [114] | rod/bar/beam | MGT, fractional | thermal, elastic, magnetic | Among different thermoelastic theories, the MGT theory with higher-order memory-dependent derivative yields the most flexible and sensitive response, whereas the GN-III theory offers a conservative and damped response profile. |

**Summary**

Of the fourteen independent problems, ten are surface-wave or reflection problems on a half-space, two are normal-mode field problems in a half-space and two are guided waves in graded plates. Verification is thin: no entry reports an experiment, and only two compare with independent numerical results. The atlas should be read as a map of what has been computed, not of what has been validated.

# L. Reporting standards for new work

What limited the comparisons in this review was usually not the models but what the original papers report. A short set of reporting standards is therefore proposed that would make future results directly comparable. They follow from the pitfalls collected in Section 10.1 and from the checks of Sections 8.1 and 8.2.

## L.1 What a paper on generalized thermoelastic waves should state

1. **The heat-flux law as an explicit parameter set.** Give the model in the template of Section 3.2, or state where it departs from it, so that $G(s)$, the polynomial of Eq. (35) and the limit $\omega \to \infty$ follow without a reading of the derivation. For lagging models give the truncation order.
2. **Which limits were verified.** Name the reductions that were tested numerically or symbolically, Fourier and Lord–Shulman and the elastic limit $\varepsilon \to 0$ for instance, and give the numerical agreement achieved.
3. **A non-dimensional parameter table.** Report $\varepsilon$, $\omega/\omega_*$, $\omega\tau_q$ (and $\omega\tau_T$, $\alpha$, $\xi\omega_*/c_1$ as relevant) for every figure. A figure without them cannot be placed on the regime map of Section 10.1.
4. **The material source and the status of the parameters.** Say whether a lag time or fractional order is measured, estimated by a stated argument, or assigned for illustration; illustrative values should not share a table with measured ones.
5. **Branch handling.** For dispersion curves state how roots were selected and followed (Section 3.3), and mark the regions of hybridisation.

6. **Energy statements.** Where energy ratios are reported, give the energy flux used (Section 3.2.5), say whether the ratios sum to one, and if they do not, whether the cross terms between modes were included (Section 6.10).
7. **Inversion and discretisation.** For transient results state the Laplace-inversion method and its cross-check, or the discretisation and the Courant number, and give the error in a window around the front separately from the global error (Section 8.2).
8. **Boundary and interface conditions.** State the thermal condition (insulated, isothermal, convective) and, at interfaces, the continuity conditions for the heat flux and for the temperature or the thermal displacement.

## L.2 Claims that need an independent test

- A lag time or fractional order extracted from a single curve that carries several free parameters.
- A claim that a model predicts a "new wave", offered without a check of the number of roots of the dispersion polynomial in each frequency range and of their causality (Section 3.3).
- A reflection or transmission result whose energy ratios sum to one only because the thermal wave was dropped.
- A size effect taken from a nonlocal law whose length parameter was chosen by trial rather than calibrated to a lattice or atomistic dispersion curve (Section 5.3).

## L.3 Limitations of this review

The review covers linear waves about a uniform reference state. It does not cover nonlinear thermoelasticity, radiative or reactive heat transfer, or the full literature on bounded-domain well-posedness. The numerical checks use rounded handbook values and non-dimensional parameter sets chosen to separate the effects under discussion; they illustrate mechanisms and should be repeated with measured parameters before design use. The classified catalogue in the appendix is organised by title keywords and does not assess the content of the individual papers. Statements that rest on the cited literature rather than on the computations reported here carry their citations.

**Summary**

Reporting standards: state $G(s)$ explicitly; give all parameters with units and provenance; report truncation order for lag laws; check energy conservation via net flux, not mode-flux sums; give the dimensionless numbers $\omega\tau$ and $\omega/\omega_*$; state the thermal boundary condition; provide scripts or reference data; repeat numerical checks with measured parameters before design use.

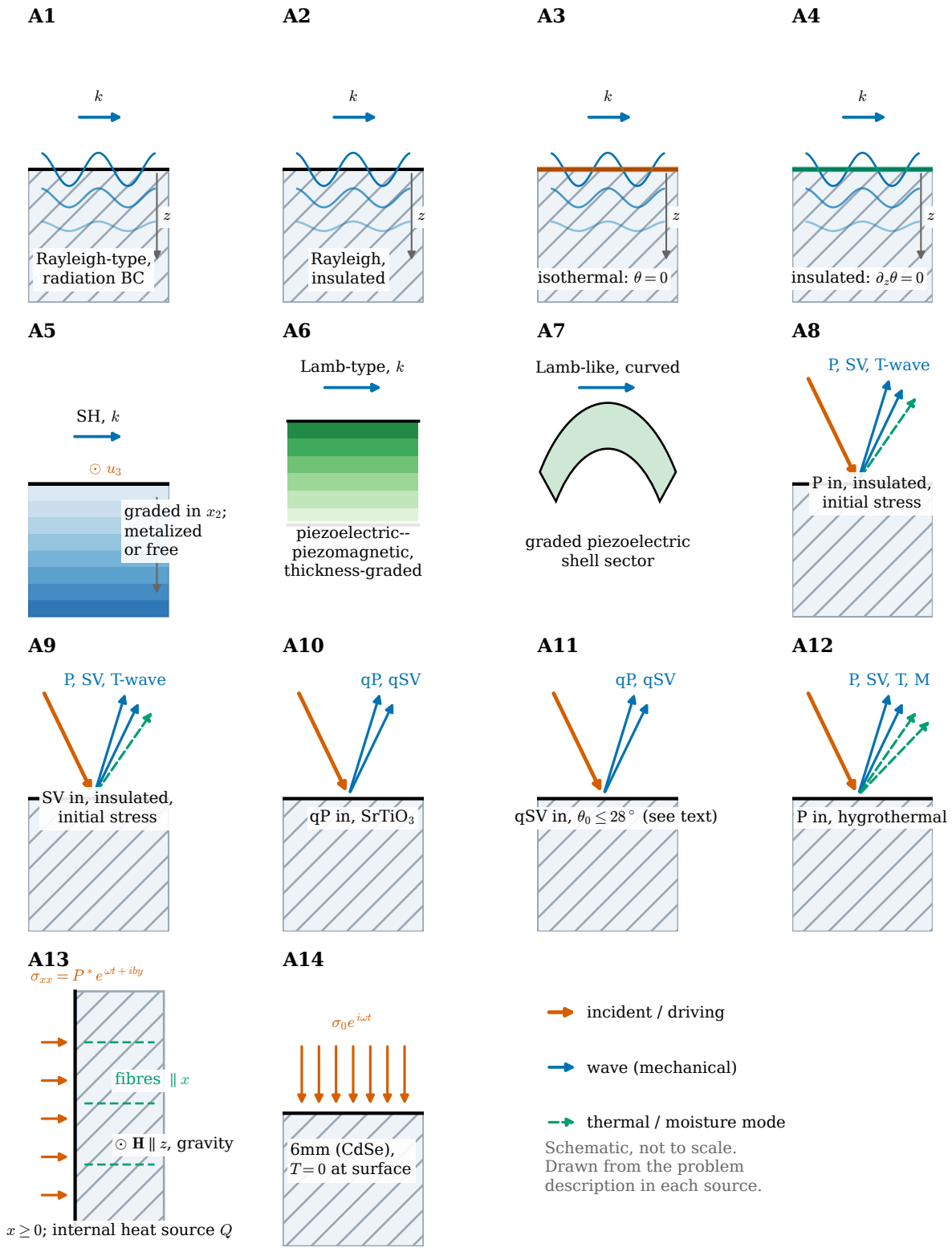



**Figure 41:** Geometry of the problems A1–A14 of Table 23. Schematic drawings made for this review and checked against the problem statement of each source (geometry, boundary conditions, incident and reflected waves); not to scale and not reproduced from the sources.

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